

A Practical Approach
to
Family and Religious Studies
Form 3

Muzondo Godfrey Sidhuna Patience
Takabvirakare Chipso Zivave Wilson

SECONDARY BOOK PRESS
AUTOZONE COMPLEX,
30 KAGUVI STREET,
HARARE, ZIMBABWE
Tel: +263 242 771 406 | +263 712 560 870
Email: sales@secondarybookpress.co.zw
Website: www.secondarybookpress.co.zw

A Practical Approach to Family and Religious Studies | Form 3

ISBN: 978-0-7974-7573-1

First Published in 2019

Copyright © Muzondo Godfrey Sidhuna Patience Takabvirakare Chipso Zivave Wilson

Editor in Chief: Munyaradzi Gunduza
Development Editor: Moreblessing Chigwaza
Text and design layout: Nesbert T. Gotekote
Cover design: Secondary Book Press

Printed by: Secondary Book Press

Every effort has been made to trace the copyright holders. In the event of unintentional omissions or errors, any information that would enable the publisher to make the proper arrangements will be appreciated.

All rights reserved. No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic, mechanical, photocopying, recording or otherwise, without prior permission of the copyright owner.

CONTENTS

Chapter 1: Concept of Religion	1
Unit 1.1 National distribution of religions in Zimbabwe	1
Unit 1.2 Membership of religions in Zimbabwe	5
Chapter 2: Indigenous Religion	10
Unit 2.1 Rituals in Indigenous religion	10
Unit 2.2 Religious practitioners	21
Unit 2.3 Sacred places in Indigenous religion	24
Chapter 3: Judaism	29
Unit 3.1 Rituals in Judaism	29
Unit 3.2 Religious practitioners in Judaism	35
Unit 3.2 Sacred places in Judaism	37
Chapter 4: Christianity	42
Unit 4.1 Rituals in Christianity	42
Unit 4.2 Religious practitioners	49
Unit 4.2 Sacred places in Christianity	51
Chapter 5: Islam	57
Unit 5.1 Rituals in Islam	57
Unit 5.2 Religious practitioners in Islam	63
Unit 5.3 Sacred places in Islam	65
Examination I Paper 1	71
Examination I Paper 2	73
Chapter 6: Religion, Family and Identity	74
Unit 6.1 Inter-dependency of families	74
Unit 6.2 Indigenous religion and Zimbabwean identity	78
Chapter 7: Religion and Education	82
Unit 7.1 Religion in formal education	82
Unit 7.2 Indigenous religion in informal education	84
Chapter 8: Religion and Gender	87
Unit 8.1 Gender in various religions	87
Unit 8.2 Religion and women empowerment	94

Chapter 9: Religion, Ethics, Health and Sexuality	99
Unit 9.1 Indigenous religion, unhu/ubuntu/vumunhu and values and sexuality	99
Unit 9.2 Religious beliefs and chronic conditions.....	106
Chapter 10: Religion and Disability.....	110
Unit 10.1 Religion and perceptions about disability.....	110
Unit 10.2 Religion and marginalisation of persons living with disabilities	115
Chapter 11: Religion and the Natural Environment	121
Unit 11.1 Judaism and the natural environment.....	120
Unit 11.2 Islam and the natural environment.....	123
Chapter 12: Religion, Rights and Social Responsibility	12
Unit 12.1 Rights of the elderly	128
Unit 12.2 Rights of persons with disabilities	131
Unit 12.3 Rights of freedom of worship	133
Examination III Paper 1	137
Examination III Paper 2	139
Chapter 13: Religion and Conflict Management	140
Unit 13.1 Levels of conflict in the community.....	140
Unit 13.2 Causes of religious conflict.....	142
Unit 13.3 Role of religion in conflict management.....	144
Unit 13.4 Impact of conflict.....	146
Chapter 14: Religion and Enterprise.....	150
Unit 14.1 Religion and enterprise	150
Unit 14.2 Technology use and enterprise	153
Chapter 15: Religion and the Liberation Struggle.....	156
Unit 15.1 Role of Indigenous religion in Chimurenga 2.....	156
Unit 15.2 Christian practitioners.....	159
Examination III Paper 1	163
Examination III Paper 2	165
INDEX	166

Chapter

1

CONCEPT OF RELIGION

Chapter objectives

By the end of the chapter, you should be able to:

- show the geographical distribution of religions in Zimbabwe.
- discuss membership of religions in Zimbabwe.

Introduction

This chapter looks at the distribution of various religions in Zimbabwe and these religions include Christianity, Islam, Judaism and Indigenous religions among other religions in the world. The chapter will also account for the reasons why the distribution of various religions varies from one place to the other. Furthermore, the chapter will explain the membership of major religions in Zimbabwe and give reasons for membership.

UNIT 1.1 NATIONAL DISTRIBUTION OF RELIGIONS IN ZIMBABWE

In Zimbabwe, religions are distributed across the nation although some religions dominate in one area while in another area may not be existent. Christianity is the dominant religion in Zimbabwe with an average of 87%, Indigenous religion follows with 4% and is practiced everywhere around the country, Islam has 0.9% of followers and Judaism has 0.1% of followers.

Geographical distribution of religions in Zimbabwe

Geographical distribution of religion refers to the actual places where religions are found. So, geographical distribution of religions in Zimbabwe describes the way in which the religions are spread out across the country in terms of their beliefs and practices. The distribution is viewed as uneven and there are often considerable changes over periods. Zimbabwe enjoys freedom of worship as there are no strict laws against practicing of different religions. This has affected the geographical distribution of religions in Zimbabwe as every religion is represented in almost every locality.

As previously explained, there are a variety of religions in Zimbabwe which include Christianity, Indigenous religion, Judaism, Islam, Hinduism and Buddhism. These religions are not uniformly distributed across Zimbabwe.

1. Indigenous Religion (IR)

Indigenous religion is a religion that originated with the great ancestors of the native land and has been passed down from one generation to the other through oral tradition. Zimbabwe has various indigenous groups of people with different tribes which include Shona, Ndebele, Venda, Tonga, Xangani, Kalanga and Sotho whose religious beliefs and practices were inherited from the ancestors of these tribes. Therefore,

Indigenous religion is widely spread across the country because tribes and clans settled in various places along tribal lines or clan line.

Indigenous religion in Zimbabwe is dominant in most rural areas than in towns. The Xangani are dominant in the south eastern lowveld, the Ndau dominate in the Chipinge area, the Karanga are found in Nyajena, Chivi, Mberengwa, Chirumhanzu, Gutu and Zaka while the Korekore native people are found in Mutoko. The Zezuru people are found in Murehwa, the Ndebele are dominating in the whole of Matabeleland region and some parts of Midlands like Mberengwa, the Sotho are found in Plumtree while the Venda people are found dominating in Beitbridge. The Tonga people are found along the Zambezi basin in Binga.



Fig. 1.1 People celebrating in Indigenous religion

The dominance of Indigenous religion along tribal lines in different areas shows that in every community where the African clan is found, there is Indigenous religion. Indigenous religion is under the custodianship of religious practitioners like diviners or healers (*n'anga*), chiefs (*mambo/nkosi*), headmen, village heads, elders of the society and aunts. They preserve the Indigenous religion through traditional laws, myths and taboos. This religion is found in the people's culture and tradition. It is because of this that the Indigenous religion does not have missionaries and let alone recorded headquarters like other religions. To add on, Indigenous religion is based on oral tradition. It is spread and conserved through oral tradition.

2. Christianity

Christianity is widely spread in Zimbabwe. The churches (Christian places of worship) are found in almost every Zimbabwean community. This has led Zimbabwe to be dominated by Christianity as a result of colonialism which used Christianity as a mechanism to colonise the indigenous people. Colonialism was further strengthened by the legislative framework which emphasised freedom of worship which led to the propagation of Christianity in every corner of Zimbabwe.

It is dominant in urban areas than rural areas where people cherish their indigenous religious practices. However, Christian flags have been raised in many areas as evidenced by the construction of schools, colleges and universities in the country by various denominations. For example, the church institutions include Mukaro Mission of the Catholic Church, Solusi University of the Seventh Day Adventist Church, Chegato of the Evangelical Lutheran church, Africa University of the United Methodist Church, Howard Mission of the Salvation Army Church as well as Gutu Mission of the Reformed Church in Zimbabwe.

In terms of distribution, the Reformed Church in Zimbabwe dominates Masvingo province. This is evidenced by the presence of missionary centres established by the Reformed Church in Zimbabwe like Pamushana mission in Bikita, Jichidza Mission in Zaka, Gutu Mission in Gutu, Mogernster Mission in Masvingo and Zimuto Mission in Masvingo. This shows that Masvingo is the stronghold of the Reformed Church in Zimbabwe although it is found in other areas. The Roman Catholic Church is a church which dominates in every corner of the country as compared to other churches. In Masvingo there is Gokomere mission, Berejena Mission, Serima, Silveira Mission and Musiso Mission while in the Midlands province there is Hama Mission. In Mashonaland West there is Kutama Mission.

In Mashonaland West there is also Chegutu Primary School, St Dominic High School in Chishawasha. In Bulawayo there is St Bernard High School in Pumula and Christian Brothers College. In Harare there is Dominican Convent in Harare. It is because of this reason that one may say the Roman Catholic Church

is well distributed in Zimbabwe possibly because it is the richest church which had enough resources to establish its churches and missionary centres in every corner of the country.

The Seventh Day Adventist Church dominates mainly in Midlands and Matabeleland region. Solusi is the citadel of the Adventist church in Zimbabwe. However, it is spread out in various places in Zimbabwe although Matabeleland and Midlands remain dominating areas for Seventh Day Adventist. In Masvingo they dominate Mashapa area in Renco Mine, Mafuba and Mundondo area. In these areas the church has managed to construct schools.

The Lutheran Evangelical Mission Church in Zimbabwe dominates some areas in Matabeleland South and Midlands region like Mberengwa where they have established mission schools like Chegato Mission in Mberengwa, Munene Mission in Mberengwa, Masase Mission in Mberengwa, Musume Mission in Mberengwa and Manama Mission in Gwanda.

The Church of Christ is a church which is also found in Masvingo mainly. It has Dewure Mission, Mashoko Mission, Chiredzi Christian College and Masvingo Christian College. The Church also dominates in the Midlands area around Zvishavane like Dayadaya where they have a mission school.



Fig. 1.2 Members of an apostolic sect

The Marange Apostolic Church dominates some parts of Manicaland like Buhera in Bocha where the founder of the church came from. Although the church is found in every part of Zimbabwe, it is heavily concentrated in Buhera. They have established Saint Noah Mission School in Bocha. The Johane Masowe apostolic church is found in some parts of the country. Although the church has split into several sects, it is now dominating in many towns because of its ability to diagnose and solve human problems like bareness, illness which comes through witchcraft and other problems. The African apostolic Sabbath church is another church which is found mainly in Gutu area as well as other places.

The Zion Christian Church (ZCC) is another church that is found in Zimbabwe and it dominates mostly in rural places. Its headquarters is at Mbungu and this makes the church more dominant in Bikita and Zaka. The church also dominates in the midlands area particularly in Gokwe where the founder of the church relocated to. The places surrounding Defe are dominated by followers of this church.

The Salvation Army dominates in Mashonaland West in Sanyati area as well as Mashonaland Central in places like Mazowe. They have established mission schools which include Howard, Bradley and Mazowe. This is because the first missionary from that church settled in Mashonaland central. Guta Ra Jehovha is another church which is found dominating in Zvimba, Zimunya, Mhondoro, Harare, Bulawayo and many other places. Guta Ra Jehovha was founded by Mai Chaza and the church later split to form Guta Ra Mwari in 1961.

3. Judaism

Jews who first settled in Zimbabwe were merchants and captains of industry. These people settled in cities for the support of their businesses that is why today Jewish communities are mostly found in and around cities. They are mainly found in cities like Harare, Bulawayo, Kwekwe and Gweru because of economic reasons. This is substantiated by the fact that the first Jewish synagogues were built in Harare and Bulawayo respectively.

The head offices of the Jewish religion in Zimbabwe are in Harare. This is where the offices of their leader or director are located. There are also some scattered synagogues in these cities and towns where the Jews meet and worship Yahweh.

However, Judaism is also found in rural areas like Mberengwa in the Midlands where the Remba people who are believed to be the lost tribe of Israel are found. As such, they dominate in the Midlands region where Judaism is not only a religion but a culture. Furthermore, Judaism is also found concentrating in Mapakomhere in Masvingo as well as in Chinyika area in Gutu. This is because the Remba people are settled there. Judaism has been spreading to various places because of evangelism.



Fig. 1.3 Some of the Jews in Zimbabwe

4. Islam

Just like the Jews, most Muslims are business people and are found in big cities near their businesses. In Zimbabwe, towns and cities are the strongholds of Islam because mosques are located near these towns. These cities and towns include Harare, Bulawayo, Kwekwe, Chiredzi, Masvingo and Gweru. Islam is also witnessed in Chinhoyi, there are about six mosques in Chinhoyi. This clearly shows the penetration of Islam in the area. Both Muslims of Arab and African origin are found in these areas because they came for business creation and seeking employment respectively. Some of the prominent Muslims in the business sector in major towns are Ali and Khan of Masvingo, Muhammad Musa of Harare and many others.

It should be noted that, many indigenous followers of Islam in Zimbabwe are of Malawian origin who were mainly employed in mining towns. It is because of this reason that Islam is found heavily concentrated in mining towns like Mhangura, Renco mine, Zvishavane, Bindura and Buchwa area among other places.

Although Islam dominates in most mining towns, it has also been spreading into rural areas. Islam is making inroads in rural areas such as Chinyika in Gutu where they have constructed a school. Zaka in Masvingo has also an Islamic centre which shows the influence of Islam in Masvingo rural. In Mvurwi, Islam has also made some inroads where they have constructed schools, an orphanage centre and a youth training centre. Mosques have been built in the areas where Islam has been launched. Evangelism has played a major role in the distribution of Islam in rural areas. In Goromonzi, Islam is also having an impact as evidenced by the construction of a mosque.



Fig. 1.4 A Mosque in Kwekwe

Activity 1.1 Interview

Conduct an interview with fellow students who represent the four religions. Ask your teacher to give you names of students belonging to different religions.

Activity 1.3 Presentations

In groups, choose a leader for your group. Then present to the class the reasons for the distribution of religions in Zimbabwe.

Activity 1.4 Discussion

Discuss the geographical distribution of religions in Zimbabwe. Suggest reasons for the distribution of religions in Zimbabwe.

Exercise 1.1

Religions are distributed unevenly across the nation.

- | | |
|--|-----|
| (a) Define religion. | [2] |
| (b) List any four religions found in Zimbabwe. | [4] |
| (c) Describe the distribution of Islam Zimbabwe. | [6] |
| (d) Explain the distribution of various Christian denominations in Zimbabwe. | [8] |

UNIT 1.2 MEMBERSHIP OF RELIGIONS IN ZIMBABWE

The membership of religions has fluctuated over the years. Some membership has risen whilst others have declined. Political changes have also contributed to the rise and decline of these religions.

(a) Indigenous religion

Many reasons have attributed to the decline of IR membership since 1980:

- The school curriculum on Religious Studies had been side-lining IR, as it was not adequately covered. This is largely because the Zimbabwean government inherited a colonial religious studies curriculum which was Christ centred and denigrated African spirituality and religiosity.
- The interaction between Zimbabwe and the world has led to the erosion of indigenous religious beliefs. People tend to ignore and do away with indigenous beliefs. Some now view indigenous beliefs as primitive and archaic.
- Some people have even left their rural homes in search for greener pastures where they have interacted with other religions. This has led to the abandonment of indigenous practices and beliefs as people embrace new religions found away from home.
- Colonisation of the mind has led to the total abandonment of Indigenous religion. Indigenous people have been socialised to condemn everything that is African especially African beliefs as evil, fetish or magical as a result of colonial indoctrination.

Indigenous religion is not a monolithic body as it has various dimensions which are clan based or tribal based. As such, Indigenous religion in the Zimbabwean context refers to the religious beliefs and practices of the Karanga, Zezuru, Ndau, Tonga, Venda, Xangani, Ndebele, Sotho, Tswana and other people found in Zimbabwe. These people have unique religious beliefs and practices although they all believe in ancestors.

It is important to note that Africans have become more syncretic as they practice Indigenous religion and Christianity side by side. This has led to the mixing of religious beliefs and practices thereby leading to dual

membership of Indigenous religion and Christianity respectively. This is evidenced by the belief in the existence of spirits like avenging spirits, the practises of bringing back ritual (*kurova guva* or *umbuyiso*). This is common in African Independent Churches which do not condemn the indigenous religious and cultural practises.

There are some who are conservative as they believe that embracing other religions is denying one's own identity. African identity is at the centre of this conservatism and religion plays an important role in shaping and maintaining African identity. Furthermore, the coming of the new curriculum is meant to reclaim the lost African identity which has been institutionalised from independence. The New Curriculum through learning areas which include Family and Religious Studies and Heritage Studies has led to the appreciation of indigenous religious and cultural practises.

(b) Christianity

Christianity has the largest membership in Zimbabwe. It is composed of Catholics, Protestants who include the Anglicans, Salvation Army, Seventh Day Adventist church, the Lutherans and Reformist and African Initiated churches like ZAOGA FIF, Zion Christian Church, Johanne Masowe, Johanne Marange, African Apostolic Sabbath church (Mwazha) and Guta RaJehova. The last group of Christians are the new religious movements which include the Prophetic Healing deliverance Ministries of Walter Magaya, The United Family International Church of Prophet Emmanuel Makandiwa and The Goodness and Mercy Ministries of Prophet T. Freddy among others.

There is about 10 million members to date. Between the years 2000 -2009, there was a decrease due to migration to other neighbouring countries in search of greener pastures. The removal of restrictions on registration of churches saw an increase in registered Christian denominations. This has seen a wave of new Christian movements being formed by various Christian leaders across the country. The right to freedom of worship which is enshrined in the Zimbabwean Constitution has also played a crucial role in the rise of many churches in the Christian circles. People have the freedom to belong to any religion, as such, it has given Christianity and other religions an opportunity to expand their religious horizons. This in turn has increased membership of Christianity across the country.

From another perspective, some Christian denominations are preaching messages known as the gospel of prosperity. This gospel addresses the challenges which most people would be facing. At the same time, it will be offering solutions to these

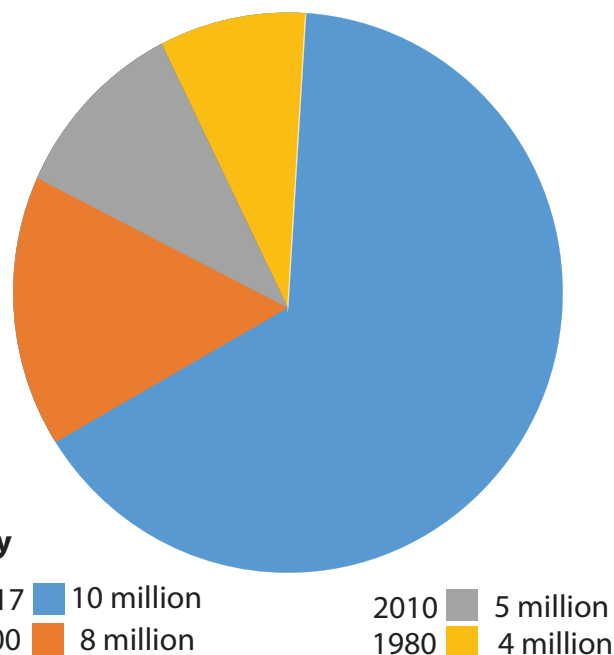


Fig. 1.6 Pie chart of Christian membership in Zimbabwe



Fig. 1.7 Christians worshipping

problems. Most people have been converted to different Christian sects. Therefore, there has been an increase in membership in Christianity.

New strategies have been put in place by different Christian denominations for example the media. The radio, television and social media has aided Christian denominations to boost their membership. New radio programmes giving testimonies of people receiving different kinds of healing have also aided in the increase of Christian membership for example on Radio Zimbabwe and Star FM. New television channels have been introduced to spread the Christian message for instance, Christ TV, Yadah TV and Christian Television Network among others.

(c) Judaism

In Zimbabwe, the Jewish community once had a population which reached about 7 000 members. However, there has been a decrease in the number of members due to migration which has witnessed the number of members reducing to a few hundreds. Jews are known to be business people and have migrated for business opportunities and studies. Some Jews have migrated to Israel for marriage purposes and cultural reasons. Failure to conduct outreach programs has also led to the decline of membership in Judaism as they are failing to recruit new members. More than two-thirds of the Jewish community are 65 years or older. The religious practices of Judaism are also a hindrance for many people joining the religion, for instance the practice of circumcision. It is this reason that so many black people shun joining this religion because one has to be circumcised first.

Members of Judaism are largely distributed in Harare and Bulawayo in Zimbabwe. There are communal centers in Harare and Bulawayo which are being led by the Jewish Board of Deputies. The Jewish community has established schools, Carmel in Bulawayo and Sharon in Harare. However, despite the implementation of the schools, the number of Jews enrolled at these schools remains very low.

(d) Islam

The Muslims arrived in Zimbabwe and settled around mining areas and some have settled in towns and cities like Harare, Bulawayo, Kwekwe, Chiredzi and Masvingo just to mention a few. It is slowly infiltrating rural areas like Gutu, Zaka and Mvurwi. There are about 50 000 - 500 000 Muslims in Zimbabwe. Islam is recorded as the third largest religion after Christianity and IR in terms of membership.

Worldwide, Islam is growing but membership in Zimbabwe is not growing as fast as in other countries. This maybe a result of stiff competition from IR and Christianity.

The other reason for slow infiltration is because of negative attitude towards Islam because of its fundamentalism which lead to Holy wars (Jihads). As a mitigation measure, Islam has established schools in various communities like Chinyika and Mvurwi to make people appreciate its religious values and practices.

Furthermore, information centres have been established to educate people about Islam and vocational training centres have also been established through the Direct Aid Africa Muslim Agency in places like Gumbo in Zaka and Mvurwi to increase membership of Muslims in Zimbabwe. This shows that Islam is a religion like any other religion which does not only cater for spiritual needs of people but also for the development of the society in which it operates in.



Fig. 1.9 Muslims in a mosque

Activity 1.5 Research work

Research on the distribution of religions in your area. Identify the most common religions and give reasons on their distribution.

Activity 1.6 Discussion

Discuss the reasons for the low membership of Judaism in Zimbabwe. Suggest solutions to these challenges.

Exercise 1.2

1. Discuss the factors which affect membership of various religions in Zimbabwe.

[15]

Interesting facts

1. Religion has no fixed definition, it can be explained differently by different people in different places and at different times. Globalisation has led to the decrease in membership of believers in Indigenous religion.

Summary of the chapter

- This chapter focused on the concept of religion.
- Indigenous religion is the religion of the Zimbabwean natives.
- Many Zimbabweans believe in both Christianity and Indigenous religion.
- There are many Christian denominations in Zimbabwe.
- The Remba tribe in Zimbabwe has Jewish origin.
- The Muslim community is seen helping the poor in different communities.
- Zimbabwe has various religions showing freedom of worship.
- The national distribution of the four major religions was described and explained.
- The membership of religions in Zimbabwe was also given.

Glossary of terms

Archaic	– something which is very old.
Curriculum	– is the course of subjects that are taught and learned in a country or at a school.
Globalisation	– this is whereby the world has been reduced to become a small community where there is sharing of cultures and ideas.
Muslim	– is person who is a follower of Islam.
National distribution	– describes the way in which people are spread out across the nation.
Palestine	– is the country of origin of the Jews also known as Israel.
Protestants	– these are Christians who opposed the Roman Catholicism due to its deviation from the church doctrine in the early stages of Christianity.
Rabbi	– is a Jewish teacher who teaches about Jewish religion.
Sycretism	– combining different things such as culture and traditions.
Taboos	– these are restrictions or forbidden activities.

Revision Exercises

Structured Questions

1. Zimbabwe is home to various religions.

- (a) Define religion. [2]
- (b) State four religions found in Zimbabwe. [4]
- (c) Describe how Indigenous religion is distributed in Zimbabwe. [6]
- (d) Give reasons why Indigenous religion is found dominating in rural areas than in towns. [8]

2. Christian religion has different dimensions.

- (a) Define Christianity. [2]
- (b) List any four Christian denominations that you know. [4]
- (c) Explain the distribution of the Roman Catholic Church in Zimbabwe. [6]
- (d) Suggest reasons for the geographical distribution of the Roman Catholic Church in Zimbabwe. [8]

3. Most religions have headquarters in urban areas.

- (a) Mention any two religions in Zimbabwe with headquarters in urban areas. [2]
- (b) Give reasons why headquarters of religions are in towns. [4]
- (c) What caused religions to be distributed the way they are in Zimbabwe? [6]
- (d) Draw a map showing the distribution of religions in Zimbabwe. [8]

4. Christianity is one of the major religions that is practised in Zimbabwe.

- (a) What does distribution of a religion mean? [2]
- (b) List any **four** beliefs in Christianity. [4]
- (c) Explain any **three** attributes of God in Christianity. [6]
- (d) Describe how your society benefit from the different religions in your society. [8]

Essay Questions

- 1. Describe the membership of four major religions in Zimbabwe. [25]
- 2. Explain the factors that led to the distribution of Christianity in Zimbabwe. [25]
- 3. Explain how the major religions in Zimbabwe are geographically distributed? [25]
- 4. Give similarities and differences of the four religions you have studied. [25]
- 5. Suggest the factors influencing geographical distribution of religions in Zimbabwe. [25]

Chapter

2

INDIGENOUS RELIGION

Chapter objectives

By the end of this chapter, you should be able to:

- describe rituals in Indigenous religion.
- explain various myths in Indigenous religion.
- identify religious practitioners in Indigenous religion.
- state the roles of religious practitioners.
- identify sacred places in Indigenous religion.
- describe the importance of sacred places in Indigenous religion.

Introduction

This chapter deals with rituals in Indigenous religion. There will be a look at various myths found in Indigenous religion as well as identifying religious practitioners in Indigenous religion and describing roles of these religious practitioners. The chapter concludes by identifying sacred places in Indigenous religion and describe the importance of sacred places in Indigenous religion.

UNIT 2.1 RITUALS IN INDIGENOUS RELIGION

A ritual is an action of religious significance that has a prescribed way of doing it. This implies that a ritual is a set of action that is repeated according to a fixed pattern using symbols which are derived from and related to myths associated with that particular religion. Rituals are done for specific purposes and many religions have different rituals that are done as a religious expression. As such, there are several categories of rituals done to solve a particular problem. These rituals are done at different intervals in the indigenous communities. Rituals in the indigenous communities can be classified into different categories such as calendric rituals, life cycle rituals and situational rituals.

Types of rituals in Indigenous religion

There are different types of rituals which are common in Indigenous religion. These include; birth rituals, puberty rituals, marriage rituals, situational and death rituals.

1. Birth rituals

Indigenous religion believes that a child is a blessing from the spirit world bringing with it gifts and talents to offer to the community. A birth ritual is the first initiation rite marking the entrance or acceptance of the new born child to the family and the community. Birth rituals start before a child is born (during pregnancy) up to a period the child has been born. These rituals differ from one area to the other across different geographical locations in Zimbabwe.

(a) *Masungiro* or *Ukubotshelwa*

This ritual is usually done for and during the first pregnancy. It is done to protect the mother and the unborn child from evil. It is known as *masungiro* or *ukubotshelwa*. The expecting mother at six months would be taken back to her parents' home for the ritual. Two goats, a male and female, rapoko or millet sadza and indigenous print fabric are important for this ritual. The indigenous print fabric would be placed on the door and the daughter and her mother would step over as they walk past each other.

After that, the husband's family would be asked to slaughter the male goat which is served with rapoko or millet sadza. Elderly women who have reached menopause are given another meat portion which is cooked with herbs. The rest of the meat is cooked and given to the members of the two-families gathered. The female goat will remain the property of the mother-in-law. The daughter will remain at her parents' home, and her mother will prepare her for safe delivery by giving her herbs to open the birth canal.

Importance of *masungiro*

- To seek protection for the unborn child from evil forces.
- To give blessings to the expecting mother.
- To ensure safe delivery of the child. Indigenous people believe that every good thing which happens in people's life is hampered by outside forces like witchcraft which may harm the baby and the mother during delivery. *Masungiro* is a precautionary measure to ensure that the baby is delivered safely. Furthermore, there are herbs that are given to the pregnant mother to ensure that the baby is delivered safely.
- The mother of the pregnant woman confirms to her ancestors that she is happy and appeal to them to guide her daughter in giving birth safely. This is the reason why maternal ancestors are valued in Indigenous religion because they protect.
- The ceremony gives expectant mothers a chance to be taught by their mothers on pre and post-natal care of the baby.

(b) Seclusion

This practice is common among the Shona, Ndebele, the Venda and other people. Among the Ndebele, when a woman is about to give birth, she is secluded from other people. She lives in her own room which is polished by the cow dung. No one is allowed to enter into this room so that there is safe delivery of the baby. Only the mother, grandmother and midwife are allowed in this secluded room. All this is done to ensure that the baby is safely delivered. When the baby is born, women ululate to announce the birth and sex of the baby. Soon after birth until the umbilical cord drops both the mother and child are in a secluded hut protecting the infant from evil spirits as well as strengthening him or her against evil forces when he or she finally leaves the hut. A pit is dug near the door to dispose the bath water and the pit is covered to protect the infant from witchcraft. The placenta is carefully disposed to guard it against evil and ensure continued fertility. Secretly, the infant's birth water would be thrown away. Both the mother and the child are shaved to mark the end of seclusion.

(c) The cutting and disposal of the umbilical cord

When the umbilical cord drops, it is disposed by the grandmother. She digs a hole at a fire place or behind the door to dispose the umbilical cord. It must be disposed carefully. In some societies the umbilical cord is disposed of ceremoniously, while in some it is dried up and kept for a long time. In some societies, the umbilical cord is disposed underground especially at a bathing place or river. This means that the newly born baby has been connected with his or her ancestral land.

The importance of disposing the umbilical cord carefully

Among the indigenous people the disposal of umbilical cord is important and should be done carefully for various reasons. These include:

- to avoid the exposure of the child to various harms like bewitchment.
- to connect the child with the ancestors.
- to mark the identity of the person hence it is buried safely.
- it is a form of thanksgiving to the ancestors since it is disposed within a native place.
- it is also a way of asking for protection from the ancestors who are the owners of the land in which the umbilical cord is disposed.

(c) Naming ritual

This ritual is done to give a new born child a name which would give identity of the child to the family, community and ancestors. In Indigenous religion, names of people have meaning and giving a new born baby a name was to be given due consideration. A name defines the character of the child in the near future. The Indigenous religion name babies according to family totems. A totemic name expresses tribal pride and unification. A token of appreciation is to be given by those who will want their names to be given to the new born baby. The infant's name is given after the determination of the mission and is a reflection of the infant's personality or the life mission itself. The naming of the child links the family and ancestors. This is done as soon as the umbilical cord drops off from the baby. The father, the grandparents and family elders have a prerogative of naming the child. The naming of the child could be done during seclusion.

Importance of the naming ritual

- To give identity to the child.
- To link the child with the family and ancestors.
- To seek protection from ancestors.
- It afforded the child the opportunity to be welcomed as a member of the community and family with gifts as well as presents.

2. Puberty rituals

The puberty ritual is done at a stage of physical maturity and this is common among the Xangani people. Both boys and girls are taken away from the community to teach them adulthood life including rules and taboos of the society, moral instruction and social responsibility. Circumcision is a ritual which is common among the Xangani, the Remba and Venda people in Zimbabwe. When the boy reaches the teenage age, the circumcision ritual is done where the cutting of the foreskin of the male reproductive organ is done for religious purposes. It is a rite which marks the great transition from childhood to physical maturity.



Fig. 2.1 The Xangani boys after undergoing the initiation process in Indigenous religion

Boys and girls are separately taken to a secluded place like a bush for four weeks. The male circumcision together with other initiation rites are conducted by traditional leaders and is usually done in winter between June and July so that boys would become physically fit. During this initiation period, boys are educated on how to be good men who provide for the family and make their wives happy. Boys are also taught about the traditional history and cultural songs. Before the completion of the initiation rituals, boys are circumcised

using razor blades and knives. After the healing of the circumcised wound boys are taught traditional education, various skills like hunting, thatching and blacksmith. After the completion of the circumcision, people gather to celebrate male circumcision and this celebration is known as *hoko* in Xangani. The boy will have a new identity as he is given a new name.

Importance of puberty ritual

- To ensure the shaping of productive community-oriented responsible adults.
- To prepare for adulthood.
- To promote good morals in the society.
- So that the boy could now be given a Xangani name, own wealth like cattle in his name, sit at community court as well as participate in family ritual activities.

3. Death rituals

Death in Indigenous religion is the transition or continuation of life from the physical world to the spiritual world. The indigenous people believe in life after death, therefore death rituals are done in preparation of the dead for the next life. There are lots of rituals performed and needed to be followed lest the spirit of the dead would be trapped between this life and the spirit world. These rituals differ from one sub ethnic group to another.

Death among the indigenous people is accompanied by a lot of rituals which are necessary for one to become an ancestor as well as help the living. These rituals start right away when one is terminally ill until one graduates to become an ancestor if he or she was an adult.

(i) Seclusion

This is a ritual that is done prior to the death of the person when the person who is bedridden is moved away from home because illness without recuperation is attributed to the witches who may be found in the area where the ill person is found. They believe that the witch would have set his or her harmful charms in the home of the sick person and for her to recuperate the ill-person is moved away from his or her home area. So, this ritual is done to save a person from death caused by the witch.

(ii) Folding of the deceased

This is done soon after the death of the person when the blood is still warm. Eyes and mouth are closed. It is not allowed to bury someone with unclosed eyes and mouth because the deceased will be angry and will cause one of the family members to fall ill. The deceased will not be accepted into the spiritual realm of ancestors if buried with open eyes and mouth. Hands and legs are straightened and placed in the right posture for burial. This is done by close relatives of the deceased.

(iii) Washing of the body

The body is ritually washed by close relatives and anointed with oil after which it is ceremoniously wrapped in a new cloth or blanket and then laid on a reed mat or in a coffin. In modern day, elders still see to it that a ritual bathing is done though it may not be the whole body but the face only. After this the body is dressed in best attire. This is done because the indigenous people believe that death is a journey and for the deceased to be welcomed into the spiritual realm, one has to be presentable hence they wash the body. The body is put into the coffin and mourners spend the whole night singing and dancing in memory of the deceased. All this is done in a kitchen hut because of its link with ancestors.

(iv) Wailing

Women wail to announce the death of a person. This is done by women. Meanwhile the death is announced to every relative. Among the Manyika people, it is customary that if the deceased was a male head in the

family, relatives are informed of the death by a ritual beating of the drum. Close relatives are supposed to be notified as soon as possible so that they will not encounter mystical misfortunes. It is the duty of elders to confirm death before it is announced. During the funeral, there is constant communication with the dead in every decision made. A beast is slaughtered to accompany the deceased. In indigenous culture, when a person dies money is collected from community members as a sign of bereavement. The money collected is called *chema* or *inyembesi*.

(v) Imitation of the deceased

A family friend imitates the deceased's behaviour, sharing jokes and even revealing secrets as a way of lightening the moment. It is believed that this would assist the deceased's spirit to be purified. If it is the husband, daughters-in-law perform what they call *nzveura* imitating the deceased's behaviour and sharing jokes. The ritual also affords the family friend an opportunity to divulge secrets and sensitive information to the family members.

(vi) Marking of the grave site

Marking of the grave is done by relatives or one who shares the same totem with the deceased. The reason behind appointing a relative to mark the grave site is the understanding that no one is given a 'house' by a foreigner. Ancestors are also informed that this is where the deceased would be placed. While others will be busy digging the grave after it is marked some will be gathering stones to be used on the grave. If it is done by a foreigner it is believed that it will cause misfortunes to the family of the foreigner who would have marked the grave.

(vii) Procession

On the day of burial, a funeral procession is done. The ancestors are informed that they are now taking out their child for burial so they should receive him or her. Close relatives help in carrying the coffin to the graveyard with the eldest member of the family leading the procession. During the procession, people will be singing songs to celebrate the legacy of the deceased. They stop at intervals and this shows that the dead are not dead but are the living dead who can also get tired. In modern day, some will be carrying umbrellas which provides shade to the coffin as a sign of respecting the dead. In some cultures, they conduct body viewing before the procession begins.

(viii) Burial

Speeches are made at the grave site and preparations are made to lay the coffin into the grave. A reed mat is cut into two halves and laid on the floor of the grave as bedding for the corpse because it is the most descent sleeping place. When being buried the corpse faces upwards so as to continue having communication with the living dead. In some communities, the deceased is buried with utensils for use in the spiritual world. The reed mat of the deceased is used for comfort in the spirit world.



Fig. 2.2 Burial proceedings

Relatives who are elders of the family throw a handful of soil into the grave as a way of casting away evil saying "rest in peace". After this, the grave is filled with soil with men exchanging shovels in the process. When the filling in of the grave is over, the grave site is carefully swept with a branch of a special tree like Mutarara and Chizhuzhu which are considered as sacred so that any foot prints indicating violation of the grave by witches at night is caught.

(ix) Grave inspection

The following day, early morning, elders and close relatives go to inspect and to greet the deceased in the new home. The grave area is usually isolated and only relatives are buried around the same anthill. The purpose of the rituals is to see if witches did not tamper with the grave.

(x) Cleansing ritual

This is a ritual done to purify those who would have helped in the burial of the deceased and it is done after two weeks from burial. In Indigenous religion, contact with the deceased person's body and even his spirit before it has been laid to rest can lead to the contamination of the person who would have come in contact with the deceased's body. The indigenous people perform a ritual that is meant to cleanse those who helped in the burial of the deceased. This is usually done using a Muzeze branch which is put in water to make it medicated water. The cleansing ritual is done among the Shona because they believe death defiles the living for it is evil. Anyone who comes into contact with the corpse should be ritually cleansed. After the cleansing ceremony or ritual, the deceased's possessions like axes, hoes, spears, bows and arrows and staff are stored in a granary until the disbursement ritual.

(xi) *Kurova guva* or *Ukubuyisa* (Bringing back ceremony)

It is a bringing back home ceremony of the spirit of the deceased from the grave to the home to guard and protect his family. Traditional beer is brewed and the ceremony is accompanied with drums, singing and dancing. A nephew known as *muzukuru* in Shona officiates at the ceremony. Early morning the procession goes to the grave led by elders, prayers are made and ancestors are informed to bring back the child. The elder of the family takes a branch which he will drag from the grave to the kitchen without lifting it up. This branch symbolises the person.

The ritual will end when they go back home with the spirit. Beer is poured on the head of the bull which will eventually become the bull of the family and it is said it should shake to show acceptance. The celebration continues welcoming the spirit home. This marked the end of the ritual and the family has a new ancestral spirit. *Kurova guva* or *ukubuyisa* marks the end of mourning and a ritual of inheritance ceremony is performed.

Importance of bringing back ceremony

- Spirits of the deceased if they are not tamed are dangerous. As a result, *kurova guva* or *ukubuyisa* gives the family hope and confidence of protection from spirits which are dangerous to the living.
- It marks the end of the bereavement period in the homestead and inaugurates a new era of enjoying life than mourning.
- It allows one of the most important rituals to take place like the inheritance ceremony.
- The ceremony unites the living and encourage family interdependence as relatives of the deceased meet at this ritual and unite for the same cause.

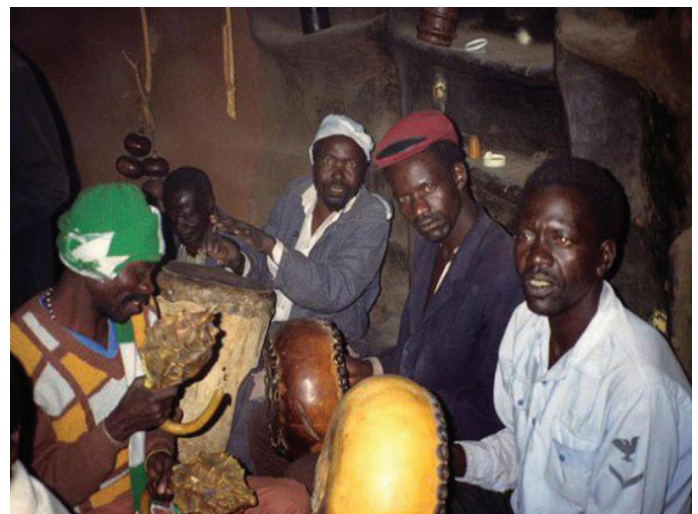


Fig. 2.3 People gathered at a *kurova guva/ukubuyisa* ceremony in Indigenous religion

Importance of death rituals

- To prepare the dead for the next life.
- To comfort, encourage and heal those who are hurt.
- To find the cause of death.
- To mark the end of mourning.
- To reunite people to the fundamental tradition of their culture.
- To achieve continuity of protection of the family by the deceased.

4. Community rituals

Community rituals involve the community and festivals accompany all major rituals in the community. Among these rituals are farming rituals, health rituals and marriage rituals. Such rituals bring about oneness through eating, rejoicing and dancing together.

(i) Rain-asking ceremony

Rain-making ritual refers to a religious practice which modifies weather in order to invoke rain to come in time as well as during the times of erratic rainfall. It is a cyclical ritual done every year to request for rain. The chief would consult a rain asking messenger who would officiate during this ritual. The indigenous community believes that rain comes from the Supreme Being. Failure of rain is attributed to the anger of the spirits of the land as well as God and rain-asking ritual is done not only to ask for rain but as a form of recognition that rain comes from the spirit world or will of the Supreme Being.

To prepare for summer cropping season people in Indigenous religion hold a rain asking ceremony. Sacrifices and offerings are made to the ancestors. Beer is brewed using rapoko by women on the menopause stage. Each household will bring rapoko to the king's homestead or at the spirit medium's home. The spirit medium will consult the ancestors before the rapoko is placed in a dry whole found at a whaleback. As soon as the rapoko is placed in the whole, rain would fall to soak the rapoko. After that the rapoko is dried and grinded, then beer is brewed. A small pot would be given to the king who would commit it to the spirit medium. A date would be set to for people to gather for the ceremony.



Fig. 2.4 A rain-asking ceremony in Indigenous religion

The place in which the ceremony takes place differs, some use sacred trees like Muhacha or Mumvee or caves. The spirit medium and the king will lead the procession to the sacred tree. Those carrying pots of beer will be behind. Singing and dancing will accompany the ritual. When they arrive on the sacred tree people will sit around the tree which is fenced around.

The spirit medium will appease ancestors and pour libation saying out names of the ancestors. The beer will then be shared among the people, as they will be drinking, they will pour some on the ground for ancestors to drink also. A small pot is to be left inside the fenced tree and after some days it will dry. Before they depart the spirit medium will be possessed warning people to reach their homes quickly because the rain was coming. In most cases as they leave the place, rain would fall.

The rain asking ceremony is done in Indigenous religion in Zimbabwe in different parts of the country. The way it is done differs but the aim is the same. Sometimes the ancestors would advise on low rainfall so that people will plant drought resistant crops.

(ii) Clearing lands for new fields

Such rituals are done when people clear land for cultivation. The owner of the field would brew traditional beer and invite relatives and the community. Sacrifices and prayers would be done to the ancestors asking for protection from any danger to ensure good harvest to support the family.

(iii) Planting

When people are about to plant, they would bring their seeds to the ancestors as a way of seeking blessings on the seeds preparing for planting. Followers of Indigenous religion believe that ancestors affect every part of their lives. It is important to seek their blessings even before planting.

(iv) Harvesting rituals

After harvesting, beer is brewed to give thanks to the ancestors for a good harvest. In Indigenous religion, people believe that ancestors provide for the people and brings fertility to the soil. Celebrations are made and traditional beer is served. Sacrifices are made to the ancestors thanking them for giving them food. People perform this ritual as a way of enjoying fruits of their labour.

(v) Livestock rituals

In Indigenous religion the wealth of a man is reckoned by livestock especially cattle. When livestock do not multiply there is need to consult the ancestors and seek for fertility. A ritual is also done by indigenous people to thank the ancestors and God for good livestock. This is accompanied by prayers and sacrifices.

Importance of farming rituals

- To ask ancestors to give rain for the people to plant and harvest and to provide for their families.
- To avoid drought.
- To appease ancestors if any wrong was done to frustrate them, a sacrifice would be made.
- People remain morally upright as deeds such as adultery, incest, murder and theft are wrongs that would stop the rains from coming.
- The sacred tree (*Muchakata*) is preserved and it is one of the trees that produced fruits during drought so in case of a drought people would survive on its fruits.
- Sustain ecological balance.
- To thank the ancestors for the blessing of a good harvest.
- To show the importance of rain and water as a source of life.

5. Marriage rituals

In Indigenous religion, marriage is a rite of passage. Steps are followed to preserve solemnity of marriage and a good image of the community. It is not a one day event but a process. A marriage ritual involves the paying of dowry by the man's family which is intended to build and strengthen relationships between two families and their ancestors. Among the Zezuru people, the bridegroom may not be present for the ritual. The service of a go between *munyai, abakhongi* or *dombo* is required. Led by an aunt he would come to the woman's home to ask for her hand in marriage.



Fig. 2.5 People gathered for payment of dowry, lobola or roora in Indigenous religion

He would request for a plate and a wooden plate is used. It is this plate that would be used throughout the ritual. Being given a wooden plate would enable the go between to introduce his story and the procedures continue.

The woman's relatives gather to witness the marriage just in case of any dispute later on. The woman's aunt plays an important role and so is the uncle who would lead the marriage procedures. Payments were made for instance, *isivulamlomo* or *vhuramuromo*, *kangaziwe* or *makandinzwanani*, *mafukidzadumbu*, *matekenyandebvu*, *rusambo* and *danga*.

Each payment had a specific meaning. For a man to complete the marriage, followers of Indigenous religion believe that all payments given to the mother, for example, the cow of motherhood should be paid first to avoid a curse to the marriage. Sacrifices were made to seek blessings from both parents and ancestors. A new wife is introduced to the elders and ancestors for protection as a new member of the family.

On the first night, the Shona tradition holds that the girl should prove that she is a virgin. This is seen by a blood-stained white cloth. Women would ululate and celebrate if one was found a virgin. It is a disgrace to the family as well as the community to be found not a virgin. To a virgin a cow is paid for she is a chaste wife.

Importance of marriage ritual

- To preserve culture.
- Help to protect and bless family by ancestors.
- To seal the love relationship between the new couple.
- To seek fertility to maintain the rhythm of life.
- Preserve the solemnity of marriage.

6. Health rituals

In Indigenous religion, health in a community is not a physical matter but a religious matter. In case of an epidemic, rituals led by a diviner or a spiritual healer are to be performed. At times these rituals are done as cleansing and witch hunting. The community leader will request a spiritual healer to come and have a cleansing ritual in his community. In some parts of Zimbabwe, they call him *tsikamutanda*.

Importance of health rituals

- To ensure good health.
- To cure barrenness.
- To guard against evil forces.

Myths in Indigenous religion

The word myth means the story concerning gods and superhuman beings. Zimbabwe Indigenous religion myths give ideas, beliefs and experiences of the human past. The sacred stories are passed from one generation to another describing the origins of the universe, purpose of life, problem of evil and essence of death. Socio-moral myths focus on the sacred story of the society. Hero-cultural myths focus on cultural heroes. Myths can be in dances, arts and crafts, carved in wood, clay, ivory and stones. For a story to qualify to be a myth it must:

- tell the story of sacred beings.
- tell the relationship between the sacred and the world.
- provide believers with a picture of the sacred.
- use local stories, divinities and events to point towards a universal reality.

1. Myth of Guruuswa

According to this myth, the Shona people came along as part of the Bantu people to southern Africa from Lake Tanganyika in Kenya at Mt Kilimanjaro where there is a place called *Guruuswa* (a place of reeds or marsh). At this place, it is believed human beings originated from a hole at *Guruuswa*. People and other living creatures emerged from this hole. They migrated from the *Guruuswa* and crossed the Zambezi River to Zimbabwe. *Guruuswa* is connected with Lake Tanganyika in Tanzania. *Tanga* means beginning and *nyika* means world so it means the beginning of the world, so the people originated from this place. *Guruuswa* is the starting point of human life and origin. It is during this migration from *Guruuswa* that the Supreme Being is said to have communicated with the people directly.

According to this myth, Mwari travelled with his people from *Guruuswa* and provided them with food miraculously through a tree known as Mutiusinazita (the nameless tree). The Karanga elders narrate that they were following the voice (*inzwi*) of *Zame* or *Mwari* which was heard through grasses, trees, rocks and birds. Through the guidance of the voice the Karanga people conquered their enemy as well as avoid dangerous routes until they reached Great Zimbabwe where the voice of Mwari was consulted. Finally, the voice of *Zame* left Great Zimbabwe and settled at Mabweadziva popularly known as Matonjeni in the Matopo hills. According to the Karanga elders the voice of *Zame* can be still heard at this sacred shrine today

Guruuswa is the place of origin of man and it is a mythological place in a mythical world. This means that the place does not exist in a real world. The name *Guruuswa* is symbolic, *Guru* means big or great while *Uswa* means grass. It is a place where tall grass is found. The grass is symbolic as it represents the pubic hair of the woman. This means that *Guruuswa* is the female sexual organ which is the source of life for all people. People came from this place that is, female sexual organ. It is the Tanganyika, the source of the human origin.

The *Guruuswa* myth help to understand men originated from sexual relation of the first two created human beings. Furthermore, the myth makes it clear that the creation of men was done together with the creation of nature. This helps to explain kinship with nature which is at the heart of indigenous people's beliefs. The myth makes it clear that all creation in the universe was created by the Supreme-Being.

Significance of the *Guruuswa* myth

- It explains the mysteries of life, it presents the origin of human life.
- It presents fertility and the maternal role of the mother.

2. Mwedzi myth

It has been discovered that the majority of the Karanga believed in this myth and they shared it to their children from one generation to another. This myth has it that in the beginning Mwari created the first human being and a man named Mwedzi. Mwari placed Mwedzi at the bottom of the pool (Dziva) Mwedzi asked to be released on the earth and a bitter debate with Mwari emerged but Mwari warned Mwedzi that he would regret one day.

After a few days wandering at the bottom of the pool, he came back to Mwari and complained that he was feeling lonely. Mwari decided to give him Masase, a woman. In the evening they made a fire to warm their bodies and Mwedzi had a medicine horn known as Gona. He grabbed this gona and rubbed its oil on the index finger as Masasi was sleeping on the other side of the fire place.

Mwedzi jumped over to the side remarking that he was capable of breaking the furnace. He touched Masasi and she became pregnant. She gave birth to cattle, goats, grass and many other living things. The next evening Masasi was taken back to the pool and Mwedzi was left alone. Again, Mwedzi petitioned for another wife and was given Murongo (morning star) and Mwedzi repeated the same act and Murongo gave birth to boys, girls and snakes. As a result, Mwedzi became the great king. However, with the passage of time

Murongo complained and she suggested that since her daughters were grown up it was now a time for her to see them. Murongo started to have a relationship with a snake. One day Mwedzi was bitten by a snake, fell sick and died. For the whole year there was no rain and Murongo and the snake consulted a diviner and finally chose a king who presided over the rain asking ceremony.

Significance of the Myth

- The Mwedzi myth helps us to understand indigenous beliefs like the origins of death.
- The belief in life after death is clearly derived from the myth. Death is not death in Indigenous religion but it is an event which marks the transition from one state to the other.
- The starting of kinship is explained by the myth through the intermarriage of Mwedzi with two wives and his daughters leading to the expansion of his family.
- The myth also explains that all the creation in the universe was created by the Supreme-Being.
- The consultation of the diviner in the myth explains the indigenous beliefs that problems can be solved through intervention of indigenous religious practitioners.
- The myth also explains the practice of polygamy and kingship among the indigenous people.

3. Myth of Kurumbi

This myth of *Gwara rakurumbi* (path of Kurumbi) is common among the Shona particularly the Karanga. The Karanga believed that men came from reeds. The reeds split and there came out humanity. The first people who came out of the reed are *Kurumbi* and a woman called *Dzavana* who was the wife of *Kurumbi*. *Kurumbi* and this woman are called ancestors among the Karanga ethnic group because they are the first ancestors. The Karanga believe that Kurumbi walked on a path which he used after creation which is regarded as *Gwara rakurumbi* (path of kurumbi) which is not found on earth but in the sky where *kurumbi* walked alone in the sky. In Manicaland it is known as *Gwara renzou* while in Gokwe it is called *Nzira yamakombe*.

The Karanga people of Great Zimbabwe believe that there is a mark which shows the state of creation on a rock in form of footprints. There are also marks of hoes, arrows and some other traditional tools. This rock with these marks is not open to visitors because it is sacred. The supreme spirit is said to have walked on this rock when it was soft and left some footprints hence the name *Tsimbabwe*. *Tsimba* means foot print and *-bwe* means stone. This logically translates to footprints on a rock (*Tsimbabwe*). This is where the name *Dzimbabwe* came from. It has a connection with the origins of the people at Great Zimbabwe.

4. The Dzingizi-Rwaivhi Myth of death

This is a myth which tries to explain how death came into being among the indigenous people. In this myth there is contest between a wasp (*dzingidzi*) and chameleon (*rwaivhi*). The myth starts within the context of creation at Guruuswa and the chief of the place who is equated to the Supreme Being sent out a message with two creatures to humanity. The first animal to be sent was chameleon with the message that human beings would die and rise again. The chameleon went with the message but he was slow to deliver the message.

Before the arrival of the chameleon with the message that human beings would die and rise again, the chief (Supreme Being) changed his mind and sent the wasp with the message that human beings would die and not rise again. The wasp was fast in delivering the message and he arrived before the chameleon delivered the message. People accepted the message of the wasp and when the chameleon arrived, they refused to accept the first message brought by wasp and accepted that of chameleon they would die and rise again.

Significance of the myth

- The chief is the Supreme Being (*Mwari*). This myth explains the concept of life after death among the indigenous people.
- This myth explains the issue of deception and unreliability. The chameleon deceives with its ability

to change colour and trick its victim since you cannot easily identify it. It's a symbol of deception and unreliability.

- The myth all in all explains why human beings are subject to death since they accepted the first message.
- The myth also explain that God can express himself through other things like animals. Animals act as a heirophany because the Supreme Being can be identified with the chameleon and the wasp to express the message of life and death to humanity.
- The myth explains that God can change his mind. God is unpredictable, he can change any time.
- The myth explains that death is not final but it helps in a transition into another life.
- The myth also reveals that life is a journey which starts from a point and reaches a destination called death and leads to afterlife. That's why cremation is a taboo; it is a plan by whites to extinguish souls.

Activity 2.1 Group work

In groups, discuss any three rituals in Indigenous religion. List down your points on paper and read out to the class.

Activity 2.2 Research work

Research on how the rain asking ceremony is done in your area. Write a paragraph on your findings.

Activity 2.3 Discussion

Choose one ancient great leader and discuss the myth behind him or her.

Exercise 2.1

1. Describe the one myth of your choice and its significance.

[25]

UNIT 2.2 RELIGIOUS PRACTITIONERS

A religious practitioner is a person who is trained to take a religious office or a person who has a mandate to officiate at certain religious activities. Religious practitioners are important religious figures in the indigenous communities. There are different religious practitioners and they perform different duties according to their religious offices. The practitioners ensure that the religious practices continue in the different indigenous communities. These include; traditional healers, priests, rain messengers and spirit mediums among others.

(a) Rain messengers (*manyusa/amawosana*)

These are important practitioners who officiate at rain asking ceremonies in indigenous communities. The *manyusa* or *amawosana* are responsible for rain, they are the ones who ask for rain from the ancestors through priestly intermediaries. Rain messengers are sent by chiefs to various shrines for instance, most rain makers were sent to Njelele shrine to ask for rain. The main task of the *manyusa* is to lead the rain asking ceremony together with women who have reached menopause. These women are involved in seed fermentation which symbolises the creation of mankind. They also have the ability to stop destructive rain. The *manyusa* or *amawosana* state various morals and problems which will be affecting the chieftdom. They sacrifice on behalf of people and make offerings to appease ancestors if the people have wronged ancestors so that rain can come. They are involved in the rain-asking rituals performing various dances to appease the ancestors.

Various rain messengers include: Mbuya Mavhu who presided over this ritual in Buhera and Mt Darwin. Mkwati is also believed to have been a rain messenger based at Njelele.

(b) Traditional healer

A traditional healer is a vital medical practitioner in the indigenous communities. Traditional healers are responsible for healing and divination in various communities. In contemporary Zimbabwe, there is Zimbabwe National Traditional Healers' Association (ZINATHA) which is an association of the traditional healers. Traditional healers are normally consulted when problems arise. The problems include: misfortunes, mental illness, measles, deaths, sickness and barrenness among other problems. A traditional healer is also consulted at various rituals such as birth, marriage and death.



Fig. 2.6 A Traditional healer

As diviners, they get religious advice and spiritual guidance to assist people. They make use of divination dices (*hakata* or *amathambo*) to know about the issues which need to be addressed. The divination dices reveal the problems and their causes. Divination can also come through ordeals, omens and dreams. As a healer, a traditional healer deals with medicine and offers various prescriptions. The healer uses various methods of healing to effect cure to various diseases which will be affecting people. They also use herbs to cure diseases, these herbs include *chifumuro*, *gavakava* (aloe), *mubvamaropa* and *chifuro-furo*. The traditional healers are also consulted on some rituals such as birth and death rites.

Some roles of the traditional healers include:

- being involved in community rituals such as rain-making.
- to encounter national diseases and catastrophes such as plagues.
- heals people of the land.
- provides spiritual and physical healing.

(c) Spirit medium (*Svikiro*)

A spirit medium is a person (male or female) who is possessed by the spirit of the dead. The spirit medium is there to mediate between the dead members and the living members of the community. A spirit medium communicates the message from the ancestors to the living descendants of a family or community at large. When possessed the medium acts in strange ways which he or she cannot do if he is not possessed. During that time, the medium communicates with the spirit.



Fig. 2.7 A spirit medium

(d) Priest

A priest is an important figure who officiates at various religious ceremonies which are conducted in the community. Priests are owners of shrines in different communities, most communities have shrines which commemorate the ancestors of the community. This makes priests very important figures in the religious circles in indigenous communities. Priests communicate with the ancestors and they pass everything they hear to the community.

Priests have various religious roles which include:

- offering sacrifices.

- advisers, experts and judges in traditional rituals and rules.
- they intercede for human beings before the Supreme Being, spirits and ancestors.
- they pour libation and thanksgiving to the Supreme Being.
- priests install kings and chiefs symbolising the Supreme Being's presence among the African society.
- they drive away witches, appease spirits, reverse curses and protect people from danger and harm.

(e) Mid-wife

Mid-wives assist in the birth of children in the indigenous communities. Their duties include assisting the pregnant mother to have safe delivery, making incantations to ancestors in the event that giving birth was now becoming difficult. They also encourage confession of sexual offences particularly in the event of difficulties in delivery. Midwives ensure that the child being born is safe and they inform the elders about strange birth. In the contemporary days, the roles of the mid-wives have been substituted by nurses in various hospitals across the country. However, in some conservative areas mid-wives are still doing their duties just like in the old days.

(e) Chief

A chief is a representative of ancestral spirits and he is regarded as the figurehead and a leader of a particular area. A chief is considered as a custodian of the indigenous culture in various communities. The chief has several important roles which he plays in the life of the indigenous people. Their roles in Indigenous religion involve safeguarding holy days (*chisi* or *amalanga okuzila*), distributing land, communicating with ancestors on behalf of the people, carry out instructions given by the ancestors, solving social problems like divorce and defending the territory from invaders.



Fig. 2.8 Chiefs in modern day Zimbabwe

Activity 2.4 Interviews

Find out if there are any religious practitioners in your community and organise a visit there. Conduct interviews with them on their roles in the society.

Exercise 2.3

1. Discuss the significance of religious practitioners in Indigenous religion in Zimbabwe. [25]

UNIT 2.3 SACRED PLACES IN INDIGENOUS RELIGION

A sacred place is an area which is set apart from the ordinary world. A sacred place refers to a place that is dedicated to some religious purpose and has been made holy by association with a god or other objects of worship. In Indigenous religion, there are various sacred places which are supposed to be respected. These sacred places can either be natural or man-made. There are various taboos which are associated with different sacred places in the indigenous communities in Zimbabwe.

(a) Shrine

There are family and community shrines which are supposed to be used by people in a community when conducting rituals or sacrifices. Family shrines are made and used at family level. They can be a small hut or place in the homestead. Family shrines are used for making offerings, sacrifices and rituals at family levels. People make sacrifices at the shrines and leave some symbolic offerings of food and drinks such as beer at the shrine.

Community shrines are those shrines which have been set aside for religious purposes by the whole community. These shrines can be built under sacred trees such as *Muhacha* or *Muchakata* or they can be built near or in some sacred places such as caves and mountains. For instance, Njelele shrine at Matopo is where rain asking ceremonies in indigenous communities were conducted. People offer various sacrifices, rituals and offerings at these places. People are therefore supposed to respect these places as they are important for communication with the ancestors. Failure to respect these places can lead to punishment by the ancestors.

(b) Graveyard

A graveyard is an area which is set aside for graves. Graveyards are also considered as sacred places in the indigenous communities. The graveyard is considered as a resting place for the ancestors of the community. Therefore, people are supposed to respect it and not disturb the ancestors from resting. People must not act as they wish in this area, various activities such as farming for either commercial and family consumption is prohibited in the graveyard. Herding the cattle in the graveyard is also prohibited. In indigenous communities, there are both family and communal graveyards. The value



Fig. 2.9 A grave yard

(c) Mountains

Mountains are domains of the spirits in Indigenous religion. Indigenous people believe that some mountains are residence of the spirits. As such, there are several taboos associated with these sacred mountains in Indigenous religion. These taboos include avoiding making comments about fruits, having sex in that mountain as well as cutting down trees and extracting minerals from the mountain. If people misbehave in the sacred mountains, various misfortunes may befall upon them for instance, one can disappear in the mountain. There are various sacred mountains across the Zimbabwean communities which include Chemanyoka Mountain which is 20 km from Masvingo, Nyangani Mountain, Ngomakurira, Domboramwari and Buchwa Mountain.

Importance of sacred mountains

- Venue for cleansing ceremonies which are held in mountains.
- They are a habitat for wildlife including sacred animals.

- They are a source of life and where people communicate with the spirits.
- Mountains play a significant role in informing the community that the spirits need to be appeased. Certain signs such as the mountain burning by itself meant that it was time to prepare for the next cropping season.
- During the liberation struggle sacred mountains sheltered the freedom fighters.
- They are venues for rain asking ceremonies, for example Matobo hills in Matabeleland South.
- Nharira hills is also a burial ground for the members of the Nyamweda clan.

(d) Caves

Caves are also considered as sacred in indigenous communities and are supposed to be respected by all people in the community. Caves are also considered as the resting place for the ancestors and some spirits of different clans. Sacred caves in indigenous communities include Chinhoyi caves and Matonjeni caves at Matopo hills. Caves are important for various reasons in the local communities. These include being used as burial places for chiefs, carrying out various rituals and hideout in times of trouble. For instance, during the Second Chimurenga in Zimbabwe, the fighters of the war used to hide in the caves when the battle was intense.



Fig. 2.10 Matonjeni caves

(e) Forests

Sacred forests in various indigenous communities are also considered as the residence of the ancestral spirits. These sacred forests include Nemuredzo forest in Bikita and Chiroro forest along Gutu-Chiredzi high way. People are encouraged to respect these sacred forests to avoid misfortune to befall upon them or the community. There are various taboos which are associated with these sacred forests. These include cutting down trees, defecating in the forest, engaging in sexual activities and passing bad comments regarding certain things which are seen in the forest.

Importance of sacred forests

- Nature is conserved in forests. The forests are saved from defilement and deforestation by certain binding taboos.
- War fighters used such forests as hideouts while they planned the war against Rhodesian forces.
- Some rituals are undertaken in sacred forests for example rain asking ceremonies. Such forests include *Ndambakurimwa* sacred forest in Domboshava.
- They are dwelling places of ancestral spirits.
- Provided food for animals since several things occurred that discouraged people from harvesting wild fruits during their season.

(f) Water bodies

There are certain water bodies which are considered as sacred in various indigenous communities in Zimbabwe. These include lakes, rivers, waterfalls and pools among other water bodies. Among the Venda people, they link all the water bodies to the Divine Being who is the provider. The Tonga people also regard Zambezi river as a sacred river which is the home of a river god known as Nyami-Nyami. It is also believed that, some water bodies are also the residence of the water spirits called mermaids (*njuzu*).

For the Xangani, Mashawi is a sacred spring which is found in Makanani in Chikombedzi. This spring never dries up and is regarded as home to mermaids. There are taboos associated with this sacred spring like prohibition of bathing and washing. To add on, Nyavasikana pool or dam in Chikombedzi is also a sacred water body for the Xangani people. The pool is associated with marine spirits as voices of people are heard and also many people who have tried to profane the pool have disappeared.

Some rivers provide the national spirits (*mhondoro*) resting places and a source for life in the spirit world. For instance, Save river is a sacred river which provide the national spirits with water to drink. This is portrayed in a Shona song which says, "*Dzinonwa muna Save mhondoro*" (national spirits drink from Save).

There are some pools that are considered sacred in Indigenous religion, these include; Mana pools, Nyanyadzi hot spring and Chirorodziva found in Chinhoyi caves. These pools are said to provide some healing waters for various diseases and they are associated with taboos like avoidance of washing clay pots with charcoal and use of modern detergents. People in various communities are therefore supposed to respect these various water bodies. Failure to respect these water bodies may lead to various misfortunes. The misfortunes include; being taken by the mermaid, drying up of the water bodies or drought.

(g) Traditional kitchen

The traditional kitchen hut is considered sacred among the indigenous people especially the *chikuva* or *emsamo* area. Even in Ndebele a hut is a sacred place as it acts as place for connecting the living with their ancestors. When one dies, the body of the deceased is placed in the traditional Shona hut particularly at the *chikuva* or *emsamo* so that there is the link between the dead person and his or her ancestors. The *chikuva* or *emsamo* constitutes the most sacred part of the hut. *Chikuva* or *emsamo* acts as a religious sanctuary for people. The raised position of *chikuva* or *emsamo* symbolises the dignity of ancestral spirits.



Fig. 2.11 Chirorodziva (sleeping pool) at Chinhoyi caves



Fig. 2.12 Chikuva or emsamo area in kitchen

Activity 2.5 Research Assignment

Find out sacred places in your area. Compile a report of your findings.

Activity 2.6 Discussion

Discuss the sacred places and their importance in Indigenous religion.

Activity 2.7 Drawing

Sketch a drawing of a natural sacred place you know and write a paragraph about the place.

Exercise 2.3

1. State any 5 sacred places in indigenous communities. [5]
2. Discuss the importance of the sacred places in Indigenous religion. [25]

Interesting facts

1. Mermaids are water spirits which are important in the lives of the indigenous people.

Summary of the chapter

- This chapter focused on different rituals in Indigenous religion.
- Rituals are prescribed by the traditions of a community.
- Rituals are to be done accordingly lest people anger ancestors.
- There are personal rituals which are pregnancy ritual, birth ritual, puberty ritual and death ritual.
- Community rituals include marriage ritual, farming ritual and health ritual.
- Religious practitioners act as intermediates between people and ancestors and are experts in religious matters.
- Sacred places are holy. They are dwelling places of ancestral spirits.
- Certain prohibitions are placed on natural sacred places which include hunting, fetching water, fetching firewood, cultivating near the area and use of vulgar language.

Glossary of terms

Ancestral spirits	– the living dead who still have an influence in the life of the living.
Divination	– the practice of seeking knowledge of the future or the unknown by supernatural means.
Ethnic group	– a group of people who share a common cultural background.
Medicine man	– a person who possess supernatural powers that can heal illnesses and keep away evil spirits.
Myth	– is a means of explaining some actual or imaginary reality which is not adequately understood and so cannot be explained through normal description.
Pouring Libation	– the act of pouring a liquid on the ground when offering sacrifices.
Prohibition	– an act of forbidding or disallowing something.
Religious practitioner	– is a leader, expert and specialist in religious matters.
Ritual	– is a fundamental act performed according to prescribed social rules and customs.
Sacred places	– a sacred place is a holy place where religious practitioners communicate with ancestors.
Shrine	– a holy or sacred place which is dedicated to a specific deity or ancestor.
Taboo	– an inhibition or ban that results from social custom.
Traditionalist	– a person who adheres to tradition especially in cultural or religious practices.
ZINATHA	– Zimbabwe National Traditional Healers Association. It is an association for n'angas

Revision Exercises

Structured Questions

1. Rituals are prescribed by the traditions of a community.

- (a) What is a ritual? [2]
- (b) Identify four rituals in Indigenous religion. [4]
- (c) Describe three rituals. [6]
- (d) Explain the importance of rituals you mentioned above. [8]

2. Religious practitioners are highly respected because of their expertise.

- (a) Define a religious practitioner. [2]
- (b) List four religious practitioners you know. [4]
- (c) Explain the roles of any three religious practitioners you mentioned above. [6]
- (d) Describe the importance of religious practitioners in Indigenous religion. [8]

3. Sacred places are used for religious activities.

- (a) What is a sacred place? [2]
- (b) Identify two natural sacred places and two man-made sacred places in Zimbabwe. [4]
- (c) Name one man-made sacred place and briefly explain its significance. [6]
- (d) Explain the importance of natural sacred places.. [6]

4. Diviners use a method of divination.

- (a) What is divination? [2]
- (b) What methods are used by a diviner in divination? [4]
- (c) Explain the roles of a diviner in Indigenous religion. [6]
- (d) What is the importance of a diviner in Indigenous religion? [8]

5. Socio-moral myth focuses on the sacred story of the society.

- (a) What is a myth? [2]
- (b) How are myths portrayed in Indigenous religion? [4]
- (c) Identify one myth and explain it. [6]
- (d) Explain the importance of myths in Indigenous religion. [8]

Essay Questions

- 6. Discuss the importance of rituals in Indigenous religion. [25]
- 7. Explain the roles of religious practitioners in Indigenous religion. [25]
- 8. Give explanatory notes on the significance of natural sacred places in Indigenous religion. [25]
- 9. Discuss the significance of man-made sacred places in Indigenous religion. [25]
- 10. Explain the importance of sacred places in Indigenous religion. [25]

Chapter

3

JUDAISM

Chapter objectives

By the end of this chapter, you should be able to:

- describe rituals in Judaism.
- identify religious practitioners in Judaism.
- state the roles of religious practitioners in Judaism.
- identify sacred places in Judaism.
- describe the importance of sacred places in Judaism.

Introduction

Judaism is a religion which originated with Abraham and was perpetuated by the patriarchs. It is a religion which believes in one God called Yahweh. As an Abrahamic religion, Judaism has unique rituals, religious practitioners and sacred places. This chapter discusses Judaism by focusing on rituals, identifying religious practitioners, explaining roles of religious practitioners, identifying sacred places and describing the importance of sacred places.

UNIT 3.1 RITUALS IN JUDAISM

A ritual can be defined as a religious ceremony or ceremonies that are often repeated in the same form. Judaism has elaborated religious ceremonies that are based on the Jewish law "*halakhah*" which is the path one has to follow in Judaism. Rituals are guided halakhah as it stipulates what is supposed to be eaten and put on when performing rituals. Furthermore, rituals in Judaism help in expressing gratitude, exhibiting Jewish identity and bringing in the sacredness of God in daily life. As such, there are rituals associated with birth, worship, prayer and death in Judaism. Rituals in Judaism are in two categories namely, daily rituals and life cycle rituals.

1. Daily rituals

These are rituals which are done daily and they include prayer in the morning, afternoon and evening. Prayer encompasses recitation of *Kadoish* which reaffirms faith in God. God is at the centre of Jewish life and should be worshipped wholeheartedly. Morning prayers (*Shacharat*) are held every day, early in the morning, normally during the first three or four hours of the day. The afternoon prayers (*Minchah*), are held by mid-day and there are also evening prayers (*Maariv*). These prayer rituals are adhered to by all Jews in Judaism.

Importance of the daily prayer ritual

- Ritual prayer services are substitutes for temple sacrifices (*Tamid*).
- Prayer rituals were introduced by the Patriarchal fathers of the Jewish nation. Morning, afternoon and evening prayers were commonly done by Abraham (Genesis 22:3), Isaac (Genesis 24:63) and Jacob (Genesis 28:11).
- Daily prayer rituals are in keeping with the Torah expectations, as Jews are strict followers of the Torah.



Fig. 3.1 Jews praying

2. Birth rituals (Leviticus 12)

The first ritual in Judaism is the birth ritual in which the child is given a name and blessed in the synagogue. According to Genesis chapter 1:28, when a child is born in a Jewish family, there is jubilation that comes with the, “be fruitful and multiply” instruction from God (Yahweh). In Judaism, the birth of a child is celebrated joyously in accordance with the dictates of the Torah that Jews should increase in numbers. The born child is given a Hebrew or a Jewish name or is named after his or her family ancestry.

The name of the child is supposed to connect with the people, events and stories of the time. Most male children are named after their male forefathers. The newly born child is usually taken into the synagogue for prayer and thanksgiving, including offerings, conducted by the Priest. The woman who has given birth is ritually unclean for 40 days for the birth of the son and 80 days for the birth of the daughter.

Importance of the birth ritual

- Usually the birth ritual is done to accept the child into the Jewish community. Upon birth, the child becomes a member of the community, hence, the joyous rituals carried out at birth.
- The naming of the child gives him or her a Jewish identity. The child is identified with the Jewish genealogy.
- Presentation of the child in the synagogue by a priest is a way of blessing the child. The prayer and the offering are a way of thanking God for the child.
- Naming is done to convert the newly born child to Judaism.

(a) Circumcision (Brit Milah)

Circumcision is the removal of the foreskin of the male sexual organ. It is a sign of identity that one is a Jew. Therefore, all Jews who are descendants of Abraham, believe that they are God’s elect through the covenant made between God and Abraham in which Abraham was made to circumcise himself by God (Genesis 17:10-11) are circumcised. Every male child is circumcised on the 8th day from the day of birth.

This circumcision is carried out by a *mohel* which means a circumciser who is pious and educated Jew in the law and surgical techniques. When the circumcision is done, the child is held by a person



Fig. 3.2 A child being circumcised

called a *sandek* which literally means a godfather who is usually a grandparent or a family rabbi. During circumcision, various blessings are recited and the child is given a formal Hebrew name. Circumcision is the initial phase which makes one part of the Jewish religion. In some Jewish communities, the ritual of male circumcision is done together with the naming of the child. In Judaism, uncircumcised males are forbidden to take part in all religious activities, let alone, participate in the temple services.

Circumcision is a binding legal requirement for both the father and the son. If the father fails to make his son circumcised, it is the duty of the son to make sure that he fulfils this religious obligation by being circumcised. The person who fails to be circumcised is guilty of the sin of *kareit* meaning spiritual excision.

Importance of the circumcision ritual in Judaism

- The ritual is done to signify that the child is a true son of the lineage of Abraham who introduced the traditional rite of circumcision.
- Circumcision marks entry by the male child into the Jewish community, hence, the ritual is a form of identification for the child who has to be identified with the rest of the Jews.
- The ritual of circumcision in Judaism has become law for all Jews to follow. Jews are very strict observers of the Torah and therefore, adhere to all statutes including the circumcision ritual.
- Since the circumcision ritual was first performed by Abraham as part of his covenant with God, it is done as a sign that the Jews are God's chosen people, descendants of Abraham. The ritual of circumcision is seen by the Jews as a mark of distinction between the Jews and other nationalities.
- So that the child can be given a Jewish name.

(b) Redemption of the first-born son

In Judaism, the first and best things belong to God. As such, first born children belong to God. It is widely believed that the first son would serve as a priest and temple religious practitioner. This made first sons sacred and therefore belong to God. First sons in the line of Aaron and the Levites are supposed to take full time jobs as temple attendants. When a first born son is 31 days old, it is normal practice for the father to, 'buy back' or redeem the son from the temple by paying a silver coin or a shekel as according to the Torah as stated in Numbers 18:15. The first born son is predestined to serve in the temple as a priest (*kohen*), a family representative to the Holy Temple (Exodus 13:1-2).

The father has to redeem the first-born son in order to retain him instead of leaving him to be given to the temple as full-time temple attendant. In Judaism, this ritual practice is called the '*Pidyon Haben*'. After paying a price for the first-born son, the father then recites two blessings for the boy. The shekels or silver coins are taken by the priest who then places them on the boy's head and blesses the boy.

Importance of the Redemption of the firstborn son

- The redemption of the first-born son is important to the Jews as it is a reminder of the Exodus events when God spared the Hebrew first born sons from the wrath of the tenth plague that destroyed the Egyptian first-born sons.
- All first born Jewish sons, therefore, belong to God and the father of the son has to 'buy him back' from God.
- The ritual is also done as a gesture of love for the first-born son.
- The first-born son receives some blessings from the Priest in the temple.

(c) Bar mitzvah (Son of Commandment)/Bat – mitzvah (Daughter of commandment)

This ritual is done for boys and girls upon reaching the age of 13. Bar means, 'Son of Commandments or the law', therefore, bar mitzvah means, 'Son of the law.' For girls, bat stands for 'Daughter', meaning, 'Daughter of the law.' At the age of thirteen (13), both boys and girls are considered responsible for their actions. It is

at this age that boys can start to participate in ritual law, ethics and traditions in Judaism.

Preparation for marriage begins at this stage. They can begin to possess property. Boys, at this age, are eligible to wear the *tallith*, showing that they are now bound by the law and also eligible to read the Torah in the synagogue. The boy undergoing this ritual has to attend a minimum number of prayer services, (Shabbat) and studies in the synagogue. After all these processes, the boy or girl can take on charity and community service projects.

Importance of the ritual

- The ritual is a process of preparing boys and girls for adulthood.
- The ritual enables boys and girls to be responsible after going through the maturation process.
- The boys and girls begin to participate in community services as adults.
- They would be grown up to the stage where they can read the law in the synagogue and even attend the Passover commemorations.

3. Marriage ritual

Marriage rituals are so many in Judaism and these include circling the bride, veiling of the bride, betrothal and wedding ritual.

(a) Veiling the bride (Bedeken)

This is done only for a bride's first marriage. The bride is veiled in the morning before the evening wedding. It was done by the groom and in some cases where the groom is not present, the rabbi ceremonially veiled the bride. The practice of veiling is derived from the Bible. According to Genesis 38:14, Tamar veils herself before Judah approaches. The purpose of veiling is hiding the identity of the bride from her father-in-law. The other example is that of Rebecca who veiled herself as she was told that Isaac is approaching (Genesis 24:64). According to the Jewish custom, veiling is not a mere social formality but a legal requirement which is a concluding procedure before the wedding. A veil carries various symbols like being a symbol of being married as well as a symbol of unapproachability to others and a symbol of modest.

(b) Betrothal (Kiddushin)

According to the Jewish law, marriage is a two-way process. The first step is *kiddushin* (betrothal) and the second is *nisuin* (actual wedding). Betrothal rendered the bride and groom as full-fledged husband and wife. The groom betroths the bride by giving her a ring and this is preceded by a blessing from the priest recited by the rabbi. When the two are betrothed, they cannot divorce because they are considered as husband and wife. The two are not allowed to engage in a sexual relationship before the second step (*nusuin*) is completed.

Since rituals in Judaism emanate from the Torah, marriage is considered an important ritual in line



Fig. 3.3 A Jewish boy going through the bar mitzvah ritual in the synagogue, reading the Torah



Fig. 3.4 A Jewish marriage ritual

with Genesis 1:20-28 where instructions regarding the union of male and female were given to the Jews by God during the Adam and Eve era. The marriage ritual is usually done in the synagogue and conducted by a priest. It begins with the recitation of the *sheva Brachot* (seven benedictions). The bride circles the groom seven times, a ritual of blessing denoting the seven days of God's creation. The bride and the groom sign the '*ketuba*', a contract of responsibilities for both parties who are wedding. The wedding concludes with the groom breaking the glass.

Importance of the marriage ritual in Judaism

- The ritual is carried out in respect of God's command in Genesis 1:28, 'be fruitful and multiply.'
- The marriage ritual secures a union between male and female to share life experiences such as pleasures, hardships and the rearing of children born within the wedlock.
- Families are joined together through the marriage ritual.
- The blessings conducted by a Priest in the synagogue during the marriage ritual offer protection from evil for the newly weds.
- Marriage is done within the Jewish community, not outside, the practice maintains Jewish culture and identity.
- Marrying a foreigner, that is someone from another tribe, brings foreign beliefs and practices that are forbidden in Judaism, a monotheist religion and so cannot be part of the ritual.

4. Menstrual purification ritual for women (Leviticus 15)

The ritual, which is called, '*Mikvah*' in Judaism, is a bath ritual done after a woman's menstrual cycle. The ritual bathing takes place one full week after the menstruation has stopped. It is also called ritual immersion done to achieve ritual purity. '*Mikvah*' is a pool for dipping by a woman at the end of a menstrual period. The Torah commands a woman to purify herself after a menstrual period. Women are regarded as unclean when they are in their menstruation period and there is need for ritual cleansing.

Importance of the ritual

- The bath ritual is to cleanse the woman before she could, once again, sleep with her husband.
- The ritual is a ceremonial cleansing in keeping with Jewish customs that have to be adhered to.

5. Passover rituals (Numbers 28:16)

Events of the Passover commemorations are rituals carried out in Judaism. Lambs are slaughtered and roasted meat is consumed as part of peace offerings. Unleavened bread is consumed during the ritual. Jews also take wine and some bitter herbs as part of remembrance of the exodus events when God delivered them from Egyptian bondage to the promised land of Canaan and the hardships which they encountered during the exodus wanderings.



Fig. 3.5 Jews participating in Passover rituals

Importance of the Passover rituals

- Remembrance of the crossing over of the Red sea.
- The Passover rituals are a reminder of the deliverance of the Jews from Egypt.
- The rituals are part of thanksgiving to their God for being the chosen people of God and God's offer of the Promised Land.

6. Pentecost rituals (Numbers 28:26 and Leviticus 23:15)

The rituals are done every fifty days after the Passover ceremony. These are rituals that are done during the harvest of the first and last fruits of crops. The ceremony is marked with offerings of portions of one's crop yields to the disadvantaged and the marginalised such as the poor, the widows and orphans. Offerings are also done to the temple.

Importance of the rituals

- Rituals are done as part of thanksgiving for the harvest and good yields.
- The rituals are part of offerings to the needy, where one gives out part of one's yield.

7. Death and funeral rites

In Judaism, death is accepted as reality, hence, there are preparations that are done for this ultimate reality, death. The dead body is cleansed by the 'Holy Society', an organisation of volunteers from the community known as, '*Chevra kadisha*'. The Jewish custom is that burial of the dead takes place in less than 24 hours. Mourning the dead goes on up to a week, normally by the relatives of the deceased.

(a) Tearing of the garment

When a Jew dies, a custom of tearing the garment is done. This is because tearing of the garment is an expression of pain and sorrow over the passing on of a close relative or beloved one. It is part of the mourning process. This tearing of a garment has a deeper meaning. Death is viewed as tragedy in Judaism and a loss shows the feeling of separation. The Jews mourn for seven days followed by a year of mourning. Tearing of the garment is done with a dual symbolism. Firstly, it shows great loss and that the hearts of the mourners are torn. Secondly, the body is a garment which the souls wears and death strip off the soul of its clothes hence the tearing of the garment to show the separation of the body and the soul.

(b) Shiva ritual

Shiva is a seven days period of mourning for close relatives like parents, spouses, children and siblings of the person who has died. It is the third stage in the stages of mourning in Judaism. It's a stage where individuals within the family can start to discuss the loss and accept the comfort of others. At the funeral, mourners wear an outer garment or ribbon that is torn during the procession (*keriah*). This garment is worn throughout Shiva and mourners remain at home while friends and relatives visit mourners to pay their condolences and give them comfort. Shiva is a ritual which allows mourners to express their sorrow, discuss the loss of their beloved one and provide the opportunity to join the wider society.

(c) Shloshim ritual

The period of thirty days following the burial and period of mourning by all relatives other than the father and mother is called Shloshim. During this bereavement period, the mourner is not allowed to marry or attend a religious festival meal. Men are also not permitted to shave or have haircuts during this period. During Shloshim the following practices are done:

- sitting on a low stool.
- remaining indoors.
- wearing non-leather shoes.
- abstaining from marital relations.
- prohibition of work.
- prohibition of the studying of the Torah.

(d) Shaving of the hair ritual

Shaving hair is a ritual that is conducted in Judaism. When mourning the loss of relatives who are not parents,

haircuts are not permitted until the end of the Shloshim while mourning of a parent prohibits the cutting of hair for twelve months. The non-removal of hair in Judaism is a sign of mourning.

Importance of death rituals

- Death rituals are done to give a befitting send-off to the deceased.
- Jews believe that death rituals sustain the spirit of the bereaved.
- Rituals are done in anticipation of the resurrection.

Activity 3.1 Group discussion

In groups, show the importance of each and every ritual in Judaism. Allow a group presenter to highlight the importance of the rituals in Judaism to the whole class.

Activity 3.2 Simulation

Divide the class into four groups. Allow each and every group to prepare for and perform a simulation of each of the following;

Marriage ritual, redemption of the first-born son, Passover rituals and Pentecost rituals.

Exercise 3.1

Menstrual purification is important in Judaism.

- | | |
|--|-----|
| (a) Define menstrual purification. | [2] |
| (b) Outline any other four life cycle rituals in Judaism besides menstrual purification. | [4] |
| (d) Explain the importance of any two life cycle rituals in Judaism. | [8] |

UNIT 3.2 RELIGIOUS PRACTITIONERS IN JUDAISM

Religious practitioners are leaders of a particular religion. In Judaism, religious practitioners date back to the period of the prophets such as Moses, the founder of the Israelite (Jewish) prophecy. Modern Jewish religious practitioners are found all over the world where they are representatives of the Jewish community there. They are referred to as 'Rabbis', which means teachers of the Torah. Judaism worldwide is comprised of several different religious practitioners. However, the branches of Judaism active today are not the same as those seen in the Bible especially during the Old Testament period. The religious practitioners have to be understood separately noting the stages in Jewish history. There are early Jewish religious practitioners and late Jewish religious practitioners.

(a) Rabbi

A Rabbi is a teacher who teaches matters of religious law. He had a special authority in overseeing matters of religious law. A rabbi is simply a teacher who is educated in *halakah* and is responsible for answering questions and resolving problems arising from religious law (*Halakah*). A Rabbi performs a number of responsibilities, among them providing education to both young and adults, interpreting the Torah for the ordinary Jew, conducting religious ceremonies and rites, leading in charitable works and match making of boys and girls because marriage is an arranged process in Judaism. Rabbis are role models to the Jewish community through their conduct and deportment.

(b) Chazzan (A cantor)

Is a person who leads the congregation in prayer in Judaism. He is supposed to be a person with good moral character and have knowledge of prayer and songs of praise so that he could lead prayer in temple and

synagogue. In smaller congregations he can serve as both a chazzan and a Rabbi. A chazzan would lead a Sabbath service and would also conduct weddings and funeral services. He could also visit sick congregants and teach adult education classes.

(c) Gabbai

The term “*Gabbai*” means a caretaker or man of all work. A Gabbai is a lay person who volunteers to perform various duties in connection with the Torah and also religious services. A Gabbai is a person who is thoroughly versed in the Torah. A Gabbai volunteers to perform duties that have to do with the Torah at various religious functions. He chooses the right people to read the Torah and reciting blessings over it. Though it is voluntary to work as a Gabbai, serving as a Gabbai is considered a great honour as one has to monitor the reading and chanting of the Torah by a selected reader.

Functions of Gabbai

- Choose people who receive an Aliyah (the honour of reciting blessings over a Torah herding).
- reads the Torah.
- To stand next to the person who is reading from the Torah checking the reader’s pronunciation and correcting any mistakes in the reading.
- Maintains a Jewish cemetery.
- Manages financial affairs at a local synagogue.

(d) Kohein (High Priest)

These were descendants of Aaron. Aaron was a High Priest by virtue of having been chosen by God to perform animal sacrifices and rituals in order to atone for the Golden Calf incident. They were responsible for receiving sacrifices offered by the people and performing rituals in the temple. Priest performs a lot of Rabbi duties including receiving an Aliya task of reciting a blessing over a Torah reading or over a congregation at certain times of the year. He also kept Urim and Thumim, officiated at sacrifices and was also a leader of the Sanhedrin council.



Fig. 3.7 A Jewish High Priest

(e) Levites

These were descendants of Levi. They were responsible for helping priests. They were responsible for dressing a high priest and maintain order in the temple. A Levite is known to serve particular religious duties in Judaism. They also carry out some educational responsibilities as well. In return, Jews pay them through tithes. Originally, Levites were assistants to priests who assigned them to choral music in the temple and being temple guards.

(f) Prophets

Prophets were religious practitioners of Judaism as they acted as intermediators between God and the Israelites. They acted as custodians of God’s sacred laws as well as foretelling the future.

Activity 3.3 Educational tour

Carry out an educational tour to a Jewish temple or synagogue. Find out religious activities at the centre and note down duties of religious practitioners at the centre.

Activity 3.4 Research assignment

In groups, research on the roles of religious practitioners in Judaism operating in Zimbabwe. Present your findings to the class.

Exercise 3.2

1. Describe the roles of any four Jewish religious practitioners.

[25]

UNIT 3.3 SACRED PLACES IN JUDAISM

In Judaism, there are places that are considered holy because of their religious significance. These places are as old as the Old Testament times but Jews still treat them with a lot of reverence and respect. The places remind the Jews of their origins, history, covenants and punishments from Yahweh their God. All these form the basis of their existence.

1. The Jewish Temple

The Jerusalem temple is considered as sacred in Judaism. This is where the tabernacle or the ark of covenant in which the Ten Commandments were stored in the Holy of holies found in the temple. Jerusalem has a historical, religious and spiritual significance for Jews. It is the holiest structure in Judaism where Jews perform sacrifices at least three times a year in fulfilment of the commandment of God. It is a place where Jews had direct communication with their God. This temple was built by Solomon after his father had been instructed not to build the temple by Prophet Nathan.

Structure of the temple

(a) castle of Antonia

This is an apartment where the High Priest's robes were kept.

(b) Court of gentiles

This is the court which was open to all races. It also acted as a market place.

(c) Court of women

It was open to Jewish women. Women were not allowed to go beyond this court.

(d) court of Israel

This is the place which was open to ordinary Jewish men who were not priests. They were not allowed to go beyond this court unless if there was a festival.

(e) Court of Priests

This was open to Jewish priests and the main altar was in this place. The court of priests had an altar of incense and an altar of burnt offerings. Sacrifices were conducted in this court.

(f) Holy of Holies

This was the most sacred part of the temple. Jews had a strong conviction that Yahweh their God was found in this place because of the Ark of the Covenant which was housed in this place. It marked the distinction

between the holiness of God and the sinful people. The High Priest entered into this place once a year on the Day of Atonement. The place was covered by a curtain which demarcated the inner most court and the Holy of Holies.

2. The Western Wall

The Western Wall was constructed as a support wall of the Temple Mount. It surrounded the Jewish temple which was built by Herod the Great and later destroyed by the Roman legions in A.D. 70. The wall is commonly referred to as the, 'Wailing Wall', a remnant of the destruction inflicted by the Roman legions that left the Jews wailing for their sacred place, the temple. Jews strongly believe that the temple is the holiest place on earth, the divine presence did not leave the place even after the destruction. The Western Wall was built by poor people who gave their whole to put it up despite lack of resources and this is why it is regarded as a sacred place in Judaism.



Fig. 3.8 The Western Wall is key to Jewish religious customs and beliefs

Importance of the sacred Western Wall

- The Western Wall has become a famous world religious tourist destination. Jews across the world gather there as part of their pilgrimage.
- The wall has become a focal point for prayer which is uniquely holy. All prayers throughout the world are believed to ascend to the Western Wall first before ascending to heaven.
- According to Genesis 17:7, God promised the Jews divine protection against their enemies. Jews were regularly attacked and even exiled, but never destroyed just like the Western Wall that remained intact despite efforts to destroy it. The wall also signifies protection of God on the Jews.
- Despite it being the, 'Wailing Wall', the Western Wall has become a symbol of devastation and hope. Pilgrims get there to weep over their afflictions with the hope and belief that they will be redeemed.
- Angels of God are believed to have spread their wings in protection of the wall during the destruction. It is for this reason that the wall is endowed with everlasting sanctity even when desolate.

3. Synagogue

A synagogue is a house of prayer in Judaism which is consecrated. This means that it is a holy place as sacred texts are read in this house as well as worshiping. Sacred items like the skull cup and prayer shawl are put on when entering into the synagogue. This is done to show reverence to God and to show that God is sacred. All this points to the sacredness of the synagogue. Unlike the temple, the synagogue is found in every community as a place of prayer. It was built where Jewish men are found.

4. The Temple Mount

This place is also called the Noble Sanctuary which is within the Old City of Jerusalem. It is considered one of the holiest sites in Judaism. It is believed to be the location where Adam was created. It is the same place where Isaac was bound for sacrifice by his father Abraham. This is where the first and the second temples stood. Jews skirt around the mount to avoid getting closer to the Holy of Holies of the temple which houses the Ark of the Covenant that contains the Decalogue. To the Jews, the Holy of Holies is God's place of residence.

Importance of the Temple Mount

- The Temple Mount is regarded as God's choice of divine presence in Jewish belief.
- The Mount is sacrosanct due to the Holy of Holies of the temple where there is the Ark of the Covenant, which is the epicentre of the Jewish belief.
- The temple Mount is considered noble, hence the title given to it – Noble Sanctuary.
- It is at the Temple Mount where Jews turn to during prayer.



Fig. 3.9 The area around the Temple Mount is considered sacrosanct

5. Israel

The name of the nation of Israel was derived from Jacob who had wrestled with an angel. Jacob cried for blessings from the angel before its departure from the wrestling scene. Israel became the nation comprising all the twelve tribes of Jacob's sons, blessed by God. The land of Israel is now the Promised Land, a land of the covenant given to them by God. Jews believe that they are the chosen people of God, blessed with the land of Israel. That is why Israel is considered a sacred and holy place.

Importance of Israel

- Israel is a holy land, given to the Jews by God, from the period of the patriarchs like Abraham, Isaac and Jacob.
- Israel is home to the chosen people of God, who are highly blessed through their covenant relationship with God.

6. Mount Sinai

The Ten Commandments were given to Moses by God on Mount Sinai. A cloud (*Shekinah*) symbolised God's divine presence. God is known in Exodus 19 to have descended to speak to the Israelites (Jews). For that reason, Jews consider Mount Sinai as God's place of visit and therefore, sacred. God regularly talked with Moses on Mount Sinai, holding face-to-face dialogue. Moses is one among a few who could claim that he 'saw' God and lived, for Jews believe that no one can see God and live, because Moses was shown God's back at Mount Sinai. That is why Mount Sinai is considered sacred to this day.

Importance of Mount Sinai in Judaism

- It was a meeting place for God and Moses, who was a great prophet for the Jews. This is where the Ten Commandments were received by Moses, and the covenant between God and Israel sealed. As such, it shows the origin of when the Jews were chosen to be God's people.
- Mount Sinai, to the Jews, is God's dwelling place.

Activity 3.5 Research work

Divide your class into five groups. Each group should look at one sacred place in Judaism. The group should gather information to be used to argue to the rest of the class that their chosen sacred place is the most sacred of all.

Activity 3.6 Educational tour: Visit to a sacred place

Organise an educational tour to a Jewish temple. After the tour, write a report on what you observed in terms of the Jewish religious practices and sacred sites.

Exercise 3.3

Jerusalem is a sacred place in Judaism.

- (a) What is a sacred place? [2]
(b) State any four sacred places in Judaism. [4]
(c) Describe the reasons why Jerusalem is sacred in Judaism. [6]

Interesting facts

1. The Western Wall attracts pilgrims from all over the world who strongly believe that it is the centre of worship where prayers throughout the world reach first before they ascend to heaven.
2. Hebron city plays second fiddle to Jerusalem, yet it is the burial shrine for Jewish patriarchs and matriarchs.

Summary of the chapter

- This chapter has looked at various rituals that are performed in Judaism.
- The general importance of each ritual has been highlighted, such as circumcision and the blessing of the first-born sons.
- Active religious practitioners in Judaism have been identified, particularly those working in Zimbabwe and some parts of Africa.
- Notable titles of religious practitioners have been highlighted and discussed, such as Chazan, Gabbai, Levi and priest, to mention a few.
- Stated in this chapter are the roles of the religious practitioners in Judaism.
- Spiritual leadership, custodians of holy places and also interpreters and tutors of the law are some of the notable roles of religious practitioners in Judaism.
- Various sacred places in Judaism were discussed in this chapter.
- A list of the sacred places such as the Western Wall, the Temple Mount and the holy city of Jerusalem, among other sacred places were stated.
- The importance of each sacred place in Judaism were highlighted.
- Most of the sacred places are key religious centres in Judaism and are a reflection of the Jewish history and religion.

Glossary of terms

Circumcision	– the cutting-off of the foreskin of the penis for religious identity.
Covenant	– an agreement between God and His people in which God makes promises to His people, requiring a certain conduct from them.
Exodus	– the journey taken by the Hebrews (Israelites) from Egyptian bondage to the promised land of Canaan.
Decalogue	– the Ten Commandments.
Legion	– a group of about five thousand soldiers in the Roman army.
Pentateuch	– the first five books of the Old Testament, the books of the law.
Rabbi	– a Jewish religious instructor or teacher.
Ritual	– a religious or solemn ceremony consisting of a series of actions performed according to a prescribed order.
Sacrosanct	– a principle or a place which is regarded too important or valuable to be interfered with.
Synagogue	– a Jewish consecrated place of assembly or a house of prayer.

Revision Exercises

Structured Questions

1. Rituals are an integral part of Judaism.

- (a) Define the term ritual. [2]
- (b) List any four rituals in Judaism. [4]
- (c) Explain any three rituals in Judaism. [6]
- (d) Examine the significance of rituals in Judaism. [8]

2. Most religious practitioners in Judaism are 'Rabbis'.

- (a) What is a religious practitioner? [2]
- (b) State any four religious practitioners in Judaism. [4]
- (c) Mention the roles of any three Jewish religious practitioners in Zimbabwe. [6]
- (d) Describe the importance of religious practitioners in Judaism. [8]

3. Jews have holy places that they treat with reverence and respect.

- (a) Define a sacred place. [2]
- (b) Mention four sacred places in Judaism. [4]
- (c) Explain three sacred places in Judaism. [6]
- (d) Demonstrate the significance of any four sacred places in Judaism. [8]

4. Rabbis are religious practitioners in Judaism.

- (a) What is a Rabbi? [2]
- (b) List any four religious practitioners in Judaism. [4]
- (c) Describe the role of Pharisees in the life of the Jews. [6]
- (d) Compare the roles of early Jewish religious practitioners and late Jewish religious practitioners. [8]

5. The Temple Mount is considered as sacred in Jerusalem.

- (a) Define the word sacred. [2]
- (b) Mention four things that are key aspects of the Temple Mount. [4]
- (c) Explain three key aspects of the Temple Mount. [6]
- (d) Write explanatory notes on the importance of the Temple Mount in Judaism. [8]

Essay Questions

- 1. Identify common rituals in Judaism and show how important they are to the Jews. [25]
- 2. Illustrate how religious practitioners in Judaism promote ethical values among the Jewish communities. [25]
- 3. Write notes on the following sacred places in Judaism.
 - (a) Jerusalem
 - (b) The Temple
 - (c) Israel
 - (d) The Temple Mount
 - (e) Mount Sinai [25]
- 4. Discuss the roles of modern-day Jewish religious practitioners in Zimbabwe. [25]
- 5. Explain the advantages and disadvantages of freedom of worship in Judaism. [25]

Chapter

4

CHRISTIANITY

Chapter objectives

By the end of this chapter, you should be able to:

- describe religious rituals in Christianity.
- identify religious practitioners in Christianity.
- state the roles of religious practitioners in Christianity.
- identify sacred places in Christianity.
- describe the importance of sacred places in Christianity.

Introduction

Christianity is a religion that is based on the person and teachings of Jesus Christ. It is derived from Jesus Christ and He is its founder. It is based on the Bible as the sacred literature. The term 'Christian' was first used at Antioch of Syria around AD35-AD40. It was a new religious community that emerged at Antioch. Christianity is a religion whose founder is Jesus Christ. It believes in one God with Jesus Christ as the link between humanity and God. Christianity is a religion which believes in the holy trinity that is, the Father, the Son and the Holy Spirit. This chapter focuses on religious rituals, religious practitioners and sacred places in Christianity. These three components of Christianity, rituals, religious practitioners and sacred places make Christianity a unique religion.

UNIT 4.1 RITUALS IN CHRISTIANITY

A ritual can be defined as a set of action that is repeated according to a fixed pattern using symbols which are derived from and related to myths associated with that particular religion. Rituals are done for specific purposes and many religions have different rituals that are done as a religious expression. Christianity has many rituals which include; baptism, Eucharist, marriage rituals, anointing of the sick and death rituals. The most important Christian rituals are called sacraments or sacred rites because they transmit God's power and grace. As such, baptism and the Eucharist are the most important rituals in Christianity, hence they are sacraments. However, in some churches like protestant churches they are not sacraments but they are called ordinances.

Religious rituals in Christianity

Christian rituals make Christianity a religion. They include personal and community rituals which are done as a form of religious expression and religious identity. Christians find their identity through performing rituals. It should be noted that rituals are part of Christian life as they are in every transition that happens in human life from birth to death. They introduce a person to new responsibilities and new way of life. In Christianity,

these rituals contain an invisible and spiritual grace. However, the Christian rituals are different as there are different Christian denominations. There are slight differences. These rituals are known as sacraments, meaning observances showing grace. This is something physical and visible.

1. Birth rituals

There are several rituals that are performed in Christianity that are associated with the birth of a child. These include child naming ritual, child benediction and child baptism. However, the way these rituals are done vary from one denomination to the other.

(a) Child naming ritual

This is the initial stage of the Christian ritual in Christianity. The main aim of this ritual is not only to give identity but to give a Christian identity. In the Roman Catholic Church for example, the naming ritual is done in the presence of family members and close relatives in a church. This ritual involves celebration of life given to the baby. Prayer service is led by the priest and reading of scriptures is done.

(b) Child dedication and benediction ritual

The second birth ritual in Christianity is child dedication and benediction in which the child is presented to God and blessed by the priest or pastor. The baby's future life is committed into God's hands because in Christianity committing one to God makes that person a child of God who always walk in the path desired by God. Parents will make Christian vows which marks the end of this ritual process. Some Christian denominations like The Seventh Day Adventist, the child is dedicated to the Lord at a ceremony. The pastor or the elder prays for the child (lays hands on the child) and teaches the parents to take care of the child according to the word of God. The child is given a dedication certificate.



Fig. 4.1 Child dedication

(c) Child baptism ritual

The child birth ritual is common among the Roman Catholics, the last step after the birth of a child is baptism. The baby is baptised with consecrated water which is poured three times over the head to signify God, Jesus and the Holy Spirit. Anointing oil or water is used to anoint the baby as a sign that he or she has been set apart by God. The ritual ends with candle lighting to signify that Jesus is the torch bearer of the world. This practice of infant baptism is disputed by some protestant churches which believe that baptism should be voluntary and therefore only adults are baptised. It is done because Christians want to direct the child to God at a tender age. It is not a sign that the child is sinful but a way of surrendering the child to God.

(d) Protection of the baby from malevolent spirits and witches

In most African independent churches, they believe in the existence of dangerous spirits which may haunt the baby. It is these spirits which make the baby cry the whole night and high body temperatures. As such churches like Zion Apostolic Church protects the baby by conducting a ritual which will eventually lead the child to have a bracelet, armlet and anklets which have spiritual powers to protect the child.

(e) Treatment of the fontanelle

In some African Independent churches, the baby has its fontanelle treated. Churches like Johanne Masowe weChishanu Apostolic Church use water to treat the fontanelle. Some use anointing oil and others use salt accompanied by prayer to treat the fontanelle.

Birth ritual case study: Zion Apostolic church

In the Zion Apostolic Church (Z.A.C), the birth of a child has elaborate rituals which are similar to those of Judaism. Soon after the birth of a child a seclusion ritual is done. If the baby is a boy, he stays for eight days before receiving initial prayers in the church. The baby will be prayed for after 8 days followed by the treatment of the fontanelle. Moreover, the baby and the mother undergo a purification ritual for 33 days and they are not allowed to enter into the church and take part in church activities.

If the baby is a female one, she spends fourteen days of seclusion and after fourteen days a prayer ritual is done. This is followed by a purification ritual which lasts 66 days where the baby girl and her mother are prohibited from taking part in church activities. They derive these birth rituals from Leviticus 11 which requires ritual purity after giving birth. After 14 days from the birth of a baby girl, treatment of the fontanelle is done. After 33 days and 66 days of the purification ritual, the baby is welcomed into the church. The parents of the baby offer gifts to the priest and a formal Christian name is given. The baby will be now ready for child baptism after 33 days for the boy and 66 days for a girl. The baby officially becomes a Christian.

The importance of the birth ritual

The birth ritual is necessary for the following reasons:

- To dedicate the child to God. Christians believe that human life is authored by God and destiny is also determined by God. As such Christians dedicate the newly born baby to God as a reflection that human beings have no authority over themselves but God has authority over human life and destiny.
- To protect the child from evil spirits and demons. The Christian worldview underscores the existence of good and bad spirits. It is from this context that bad spirits which manifest themselves in form of demons and other forms need to be kept off guard by protecting the baby from such spirits through child birth rituals. The reason why children are given anointing oil in some churches is because they want to protect the child.
- To bless the child. A baby is blessed during the early stages from birth during the naming ceremony so that the child prospers in life. Prosperity is a blessing from God and it is the desire of every Christian to have his or her child blessed. Rituals enable child blessing to take place so that the child is given prosperity and success through his or her life.
- To show that the child is an offspring of a Christian. Christian rituals make the baby a member of the Christian family and community. The child is confirmed a Christian because of ritual like child baptism which is later confirmed when the child grows into adulthood.
- Giving donations to the parents to help in caring for the child is everyone's responsibility.
- To teach the child's parents the way in which to raise the child. Laws and guidelines which makes one a true Christian are inculcated into the parents' mind and this enables them to guide the child to grow in the Christian way. So, Christian rituals are important in nurturing the child in the Christian way.

2. Adult rites

There are a number of rituals which are done and performed by adults. These rituals include calendrical and transitional rituals.

(a) Baptism ritual

Baptism is a ceremony in which someone is touched or covered with water to initiate them into the Christian religion. It is a Christian ritual of initiation and a cleansing ritual done in Christianity. Baptism



Fig. 4.2 A Christian being baptised in water

was used to initiate non-Jews into Judaism and John the Baptist used this ritual as a sign of repentance of his followers. When Jesus came, he set an example by being baptised and later instructed his followers to baptise others.

Baptism is generally done through immersion in water while other contemporary Christians have adopted sprinkling of the head with water as a symbol of immersion. It represents the death to sin and resurrection as a new sinless creation ready to take up the Lord's work. The believer is made to have an encounter of the death of Jesus. The most important thing before baptism is repentance. The apostolic sects also baptise in water for example, the African Apostolic Church, (Mwazha).

When one realises his or her mistakes and sinfulness then baptism can be done (Matthew 3:2). Water is viewed by Christians as having a purification effect. Baptism is done in the name of The Father, The Son and The Holy Spirit. In some Christian denominations, children are also baptised. They believe that every child is born with sin and need to be baptised, to be cleansed from the natural sin. It is done on the offspring of Christian parents.

However, some Christian denominations like The Seventh Day Adventist do not baptise children before twelve years. It is usually done in public as a full acknowledgement and testimony to others in the community. It symbolises the cleansing of sins and the union of the believer with Christ in His death, burial and resurrection. There is child baptism in the Roman Catholic Church.

Importance of the baptism ritual

The baptism ritual is important because it ensures that:

- One becomes a member of the Christian community. Baptism makes one to be part of the Christian community because before baptism one is not part of that community. One cannot partake in the Holy Communion or have a religious responsibility because he or she is not part of that Christian community. However, through baptism one becomes the member of the Christian community which makes one participate in Christian community activities like the Eucharist as well as holding religious offices.
- Sins are forgiven through the baptismal ritual. For example, in the Roman Catholic Church, children are baptised to remove the sins of their forefathers Adam and Eve. This is because one is believed to be born a sinner because of the sin of inheritance committed by the first created human beings. These sins can only be forgiven through baptism.
- It is a way of acceptance into a new denomination. One is accepted as a member of a particular church because of baptism. For example, when one shifts from the Reformed Church in Zimbabwe to the Zion Christian Church one needs to be baptised in a Zion Christian church for him or her to be recognised as a member of the Zion Christian church. Acceptance into a church is necessitated by baptism.
- The baptised become sons and daughters of the heavenly Father and have a chance of inheriting the Kingdom of God. Baptism is a ritual which enables people to inherit the kingdom of God because it is an initial ritual which makes one a son of God with all the rights to partake in the kingdom of God.
- It proves commitment to a special relationship with God. Baptism bridges the relationship between God and human beings thereby creating a special relationship between the two. Sin strained the relationship between human beings and God but baptism creates a new relationship between the two. The initiative by a Christian to be baptised shows a commitment in reconciling with God as well as in having a special relationship with God.

(b) Marriage ritual

In Christianity marriage is of great significance. It is viewed as the relationship that is holy. It is referred to as the holy matrimony. This is when two people, the man and woman decide to stay together. It is believed

that after marriage no divorce should be done.

The Christian holy book is of the view that God does not approve of divorce. It can only be done in case of infidelity. Marriage is the union between two people who love each other. The couple come before a priest or a church marriage officer who will officiate their marriage. This is done for example in the Jehovah's Witnesses Church. Those from ZAOGA first visit the pastor and his wife to introduce each other to the pastor and for prayers. Then a mother and a father of the couple are given the responsibility to mentor them into this holy matrimony. Engagement and marriage ceremony will later be arranged.

It is usually done in a church with witnesses who can be parents, relatives or friends of the couple. During the ritual the couple is blessed by the priest. The couple is encouraged to be and to remain faithful to one another. In this ritual the man is given the role of a leader and the woman is told to honour, obey and respect the husband.



Fig. 4.4 A Wedding Ceremony of Munhuwei Family village 7 Ndawi in Gutu at Johanne Masowe weChishanu Apostolic church

Importance of the ritual

- It marks the end of youth life and beginning of adult life. Marriage is a ritual which shows that one has passed a youth stage into adulthood life. This is because marriage is not for the young but for adults in Christianity. So, marriage is a ritual which is important in announcing the end of the youth life and commencement of adult life.
- New titles and names are given from that day onwards, the women will become mother and the man will become father showing that they are now attached to someone.
- Gives new responsibilities to the couple, woman care for the home and family, the man provide for the needs of the family. Marriage rituals come with new responsibilities in a Christian community. One behaves responsibly in performing tasks which makes him or her a Christian mother or father.
- It joins the newly weds and protects them from evil spirits.
- Blessing the couple. Marriage rituals necessitate the blessing of the couple by God. Christian marriage is blessed by God through offsprings.

3. Death ritual

Death is when the spirit separates with the body. Christians carry out some procedures on this occasion. Prayers for the dead are carried out. Christians sing and dance at funerals. Some Christians wear their uniforms at funerals. The church pastors or elders lead the proceedings of a Christian funeral. For the Roman Catholic Church a mass is done at a funeral.

The ritual begins by church members bathing the corpse of their fellow Christian with permission of course from the relatives of the deceased. The body is then dressed in the church's attire (his or hers). A sermon is conducted and prayers are done. The pastor or the leaders of the church lead the ceremony. The church members carry the coffin to the grave and they bury the body, the church members are expected to take care of all the activities of the funeral, be it cooking, fetching water among others.

Johanne Masowe eChishanu Apostolic Church: Case Study

Death happens without one knowing. The spirit guides and instruct people of what happens in their lives. As such, death marks the appointed time of God and this is the reason why in Johanne Masowe eChishanu people do not lament strongly upon the death of an individual. Firstly, death in Johanne Masowe is marked by people gathering at the deceased's home. They then sing a song "*hosanna*" to dedicate the dead to God. One of the songs which they sing is *Mutungamiri Gabriel* meaning Gabriel the leader. In Johanne Masowe eChishanu, Gabriel is the arch of angel of God who carries important messages of God concerning human life and destiny.

The body of the deceased is ritually washed by male elders "*vadare*" if he is male and female elder "*Vasadare*" if she is a woman. An unmarried person is not allowed to wash the deceased and carry the coffin. The body is shrouded by a garment called *munembo* which covers all parts of the body.



Fig. 4.5 Madzibaba Razaro (left) a prophet in Johanne Masowe eChishanu Apostolic Church in Gutu accompanied by vadare Madzibaba Erija (centre) and Madzibaba Gebinai (right)

They conduct a night vigil where they sing songs "*mavhesi*" which were liked by the deceased as well as celebrating his or her life. On the day of burial, the deceased is carried to the grave site on a carrying panel known as *banda* by *vadare* which literally means elders. Burial is done without a coffin but they use panel (*banda*) which is derived from the fact that Jesus was never buried with a coffin. The person is buried with a white four cornered garment called *munembo*, white short, white shirt with a belt (*mushwede*) and garments. White is symbolic as it represents purity. *Munembo* is used to cover the whole body. The old garments used by the believer are placed in a *Batimaya* which means a bag used to put clothes to make a pillow. A pillow carries the prayer for the deceased. People who are not part of the belief system are privy of the things which happens from the house to the burial place and burial is done according to instruction from the spirit.

The body is lowered in a grave. If the deceased is a woman, it is placed on the left side enclosure of the grave while a man is placed on the right-side of the enclosure. The reason why men and women are buried on the right side and left side is spiritual as well as giving respect to men and women along gender binaries. There is separation of gender in burial. To add on, the deceased is buried facing upwards to enable to rise when the dead are raised by God in the enclosure found in the grave. The head of the deceased is placed facing towards the west and the legs stretching to the east. Burial ends with the enclosure in the grave being closed with stones as well as filling the grave with soil.

After the burial of the deceased, a memorial (*nyaradzo*) is conducted after three weeks to dispose all the clothes and property which belong to the deceased. It is during this period that one is determined whether he or she has gone to heaven or not. Three weeks gives other people ample time for others to come and mourn the deceased. Three weeks is a religious tradition that had been given by the spirit to all the apostolic followers. During *nyaradzo*, prayers are made to make sure the dead does not come back to haunt the living. It is done to pacify the dead. People do lament because the person is loved by God. Death is a sign of being loved by God. From the day of the passing on of the follower up to the end of the mourning period, Johanne Masowe eChishanu members are not allowed to eat meat. This is because it is prohibited to lose two souls at one time. The animal should not be killed because of the death of a human being but should not die on its own.

Importance of death rituals

- Funeral proceedings give preachers an opportunity to preach. Funeral ritual ensure that the living repent from the preaching done at the funeral. Christians believe that the living can learn from the way one would have died. They make sermons to guide the living to prepare for the next life by making them repent from sin as well as copying the good works that would have been done by the deceased.
- Funeral proceedings comfort of the relatives the deceased. Death is associated with pain and grief. As such, funeral ritual in Christianity enable Christians to comfort those who are mourning and grieving. Comforting those mourning and in pain after losing their beloved one is an attribute of Christian ethics.
- Rituals give hope for the living. Funeral rituals enable Christian leaders to tell those left behind that there is still a chance to see their relatives in the next life. So, funeral rituals give hope to Christians of the unknown future. Christian life is characterised by uncertainties of the future which are only cleared by funeral rituals. Funeral rituals give hope to the living on the possibilities of meeting their beloved one lost through death. This shows that death is not final but passing phase which enables Christians to graduate into the next life.
- Funeral rituals enable the burial of the deceased to commence. Burying the deceased can only be done after proper Christian funeral rituals have been done. Without proper funeral rituals burial cannot commence because this ritual enables the dead to rest in peace as well as giving the living hope for the life to come.



Fig. 4.6 A grave of a follower of Johane Masowe Vadzidzi VaJesu

Some denominations like the Johanne Masowe Vadzidzi VaJesu led by the late Aaron Mhukuta known as Madzibaba Wimbo, also has a type of a grave that the deceased follower should have.

Activity 4.1 Research

Choose one Christian ritual and research on how different Christian denominations carry out the ritual. Present your group research to the class.

Exercise 4.1

1. Describe any 5 rituals in Christianity.

[25]

UNIT 4.2 RELIGIOUS PRACTITIONERS

There are religious practitioners in Christianity just like in other religions. These people are very important in the day to day practices in different Christian sects. In Christianity at large, the practitioners include bishops, pastors, prophets, apostles, teachers, priests and evangelists.

(a) Bishop

Bishops have huge tasks which they are supposed to perform in churches. A bishop is an ordained Pastor who has the role to supervise or oversee the whole church. A bishop is also known as “chief pastor” or “overseer”. A bishop gives spiritual supervision to the church. In some churches, a Bishop has authority which is above that of priests. Some of the bishops in Zimbabwe include Bishop Chad Gandiya of the Anglican Church, Bishop Samuel Mutendi of the Zion Christian Church and Bishop Manhango of Bethsaida Apostolic Church.

The bishop has roles which include:

- oversee a group of priests or pastors and their congregations.
- in churches like the Anglican, they are seen as the successors of the twelve apostles. They are entrusted with care of a local church (diocese).
- they teach their congregations as principal teachers of the word of God.
- they also govern the local church that is meeting their needs and ensuring that church laws are observed.
- they also make church laws (in some cases).
- they can ordain pastors and priests.
- they baptise people.
- they control church finances.
- they solve disputes which take place in church.

(b) Pastor

A Pastor is an ordained spiritual Christian leader of a Church or congregation. There are female and male Pastors depending with the church or denomination. The term pastor is taken from a Latin word which means “shepherd”. In this sense a pastor is regarded as a shepherd and the congregation is the sheep. Pastors are supposed to live a way of life which must be emulated by the people they lead.

A pastor has a duty of taking care of the congregation giving it spiritual guidance. Pastors are responsible of giving sermons in church. They provide religious, moral and emotional support to the people they lead. They pray for the sick and exorcise demons. Pastors carry out ceremonies such as baptism, weddings and funerals among others. Pastors also have administrative roles such as helping church finance departments (this may differ with denominations).



Fig. 4.7 Pastors Charles and Olivia Charamba of Rooted in Christ Ministries

(c) Prophet and Prophetess

In Christianity, a prophet or prophetess is someone who is called by God to proclaim the message of God. He or she is considered as the spokesperson of God. For one to be a prophet or prophetess, he or she is supposed to be called by God. This follows the calling of prophets in the Bible such as Moses and Samuel. The issue of calling is another way which people can use to distinguish true and false prophets.

Whatever the prophet or prophetess proclaims is considered as the pure word from God which must be followed by congregants. The message which is proclaimed by the prophet is known as prophecy. He or she has the gift of prophecy which enables him or her to foretell the future. In church, a prophet can guide people with the word which he hears from God or help because of what he can foresee.



Fig. 4.8 Prophet Emmanuel Makandiwa of the United Family International Church

In Zimbabwe there are several prophets who include Prophet Emmanuel Makandiwa of the United Family International Church, Prophet T Freddy of Goodness and Mercy Ministries, Prophet Walter Magaya of Prophetic Healing and Deliverance Ministries, Prophetess Ruth Makandiwa of United Family International Church, Prophetess Beullah Machiri of Champions Royal Assembly Zimbabwe.

Prophets have different roles which they play in church which include:

- giving prophecies to guide people.
- praying for the people.
- performing miracles. Performing miracles is one of the duties which was done by prophets who are reflected in the Bible. Prophets in the Bible who performed various miracles include; Elijah, Elisha and Moses.
- preaching the word of God to the people.
- giving advice to the congregants. Prophets give advice to the congregants in various circumstances with the divine word from God.

(d) Evangelist

An evangelist is someone who was called to spread the gospel. An evangelist acts in the public proclaiming the gospel and the teachings of Jesus Christ to those who do not know. An evangelist can move from one place to the other conducting crusades. Evangelists are motivated by the call of the great commission which encourages people to go out and preach the gospel to make disciples of all nations (Mathew 28:19).

The act of spreading the gospel by an evangelist is known as evangelism. Nowadays, evangelists can use media such as television and radio to spread their message. These ones are popularly known as televangelists. Another example of evangelists who are popular are the missionaries. Missionaries who established Christianity in Africa and Zimbabwe in particular came from countries as far as Europe. The early Christian churches established in Zimbabwe were started by the missionaries.

(e) Apostle

The word apostle means “one who is sent”. In Christianity, an apostle is someone who is sent to preach the gospel and establish congregations. The term apostle was first used referring to the disciples of Jesus.

However, in Christianity today it has a different meaning. An apostle is someone who lays a foundation of a church. For example, Apostle Paul in the Book of Acts of Apostles laid foundations of churches in different regions. An apostle is considered as the highest administrative and ministerial officer in Christianity.

The roles of apostles include:

- establishing churches.
- preaching the gospel and spreading Christianity.
- writing biblical commentaries.
- setting up church doctrines.

(f) Teacher

A teacher in Christianity is someone who was called to teach the gospel. A teacher is one of the important ministers of the gospel in the five-fold ministry. Although all other religious practitioners can teach, a teacher has a deeper revelation and understanding. A teacher can help to make it easy to understand scriptures which might be difficult to understand. He or she provides an understanding by imparting knowledge through divine revelation and inspiration.

(g) Deacons and deaconesses

Historically, deacons were appointed when there was disgruntlement among Hellenist widows on the sharing of food during the early church (Acts 6). The apostles wanted to concentrate on evangelism than on the physical needs of the church and they appointed deacons who were men of good repute like Stephen, Nicanor, Phillip, Prochorus and Pamenas among others. The term deacon is derived from Greek word *diakonos* meaning helper.

These are responsible for taking care of the physical needs of the church like giving food. They also help in the preaching of the word of God in the absence of other church leaders. Stephen is one of the early deacons of the primitive Christian church who ended up being an evangelist. There were also female deacons like Phoebe (Romans 16:1-3). In the Seventh Day Church, deacons are responsible for collecting offerings during church services as well as preaching in the church. They help in practical ministry by freeing elders to focus more on the spiritual welfare of the church.

Activity 4.2 Discussion

Discuss about the importance of various roles which are played by the religious practitioners in Christianity.

Exercise 4.2

1. An apostle oversees a group of pastors. **(True or False)** [1]
2. Evangelists ordain pastors. **(True or False)** [1]
3. The message delivered by prophets is called _____. [1]
4. List any 3 roles of bishops. [3]

UNIT 4.3 SACRED PLACES IN CHRISTIANITY

The issue of sacred places in Christianity is very important when taking not of factors which affect Christianity. A sacred place is defined as a place that has a religious significance or where the religion originated or developed. Some places are the places where believers meet, interact and pray to the supernatural being. In Christianity, these sacred places differ from one denomination to the other. Some of the sacred places are man-made whilst others are natural. A close look at different Zimbabwean Christian sects reveals that there are so many sacred places in different Christian sects and denominations such as the Apostolic sects, Pentecostal and Mainline Churches.

(a) Church

It is a building where Christians pray and conduct their worship services in. Churches differ according to the denomination, however, the purpose of the churches remain the same. They can be seen by different religious symbols like a cross. The cross can be at the pinnacle of the church. Some churches have flags, statues of religious saints. The church consists of a pulpit and in some cases inbuilt baptismal pools are also found. People are supposed to respect the church due to the fact that it is a place where people meet and communicate with God.



Fig. 4.11 A church

Importance of a church

- Place for praise and worship.
- Church services are conducted there.
- It is viewed as the house of God.
- Prayers are held there, be it private and public prayers.
- Healing can also happen in the church.
- The Christian rituals can also be conducted in the church for example, child dedication, baptisms, weddings and funeral church services.
- Believers get connected to the divine in the church.
- Nowadays, some churches are used as classrooms.

(b) Masowe (Wilderness)

Unlike some Pentecostal and mainline churches, apostolic churches have their sacred spaces called *Masowe*. *Masowe* is a place of worship and prayer where the apostolic member sects meet for their services. In Johanne Masowe Apostolic Church, *sowe* or *renje* which literally means a wilderness is a sacred place. This is a place out in the bush. They can be in the open, on a rock (*ruware*) or under a tree. In the African Apostolic Church, Chirasauta in Buhera is a wilderness and sacred place. It is a wilderness where Paul Mwazha worshipped God in and it is believed that he was lifted by the Holy Spirit to the top of a high rock. The Holy spirit left Paul Mwazha at the top of the high rock and had no means of coming down from it. He prayed to God on this rock in the wilderness and was lifted down to the foot of this high rock by the Holy Spirit. This makes this wilderness a sacred place up to today for many believers in African Apostolic Church.



Fig. 4.12 People praying at Masowe

Importance of sowe

- Church gatherings are conducted there.
- Some have received their powers of prophecy and healing at these places. In the wilderness, the prophet is believed to have spiritual powers to prophecy and perform healing miracles.

- Prayers and healings are also conducted in the wilderness. These prayers include prayers for the welfare of the members of the church as well people who need spiritual assistance.
- Prophecies are also delivered at these places. Sowe provides a platform for the prophet to reveal the hidden mysteries about people's lives.
- One on one sessions can be done at these *Masowe* (caution should be taken to avoid unfortunate incidents that have been of late recorded like rape and assaults especially on women and children).

(c) Mountains

Mountains are sacred places in Christianity. Mountains are considered as places where people would meet with God, this is evidenced in the Bible where most people who wanted God met Him in the mountains. For instance, in areas such as Nyanga many Christians visit the mountains to pray. Apostle Ezekiel Guti would go and pray in mountains such as Vumba and Bindura Mountains and he received divine visitations.

(d) The place where the founder first encountered divine revelation

In most Christian sects, the places where their founders first encountered divine revelation are also considered as sacred places which must be respected. Among the African Apostolic Church, there is a place called Ndarikure which is in Masvingo. This is a place where Paul Mwazha (founder of the African Apostolic Church) received his calling to be a prophet of God. This place is considered as sacred and people respect the place. In ZAOGA, there is a cottage in Highfield Harare where Apostle Ezekiel Guti used to stay. The apostle used to encounter God in this cottage and he had a lot of divine visitations. He received a call at a gum tree in Bindura. This place was therefore made sacred and is now being used for the purposes of pilgrimage where people can come to pray.

Importance of the sacred place

- The founder of the church received his call at such places.
- Visiting the place makes one closer to the divine.
- This is where the church's norms and values are highly upheld.
- Miracles are believed to take place at these places.

(e) Holy ground as sacred places

A holy ground is an area or ground set apart for divine worship. For example, in the Prophetic, Healing and Deliverance Ministries led by Prophet Walter Magaya, there is a holy ground in Waterfalls in Harare where preaching of the word of God, prophecy, healing and deliverance sessions are done. The idea of the holy ground is borrowed from the Bible in Exodus 3:5 which says, *then he said, "Do not come near, put off your shoes from your feet, for the place on which you are standing is a holy ground"*. Holy ground is a place where there is the presence of the holy God. At the holy grounds, people confess their sins and in some apostolic churches like Johanne Masowe apostolic church and Mwazha they remove shoes and sandals.



Fig. 4.13 People waiting to enter the Holy Ground at Prophetic, Healing and Deliverance Ministries in Waterfalls Harare

(f) Shrine (*Kirawa*) in African Initiated Churches

A *kirawa* is a place chosen by the spirit where the prophet meet with the spirit to communicate with God. This is a shrine used by the African Initiated Churches like Johanne Masowe weChishanu for different Christian rituals. There are many, they are found at the houses of the prophets of the followers and prophets

in various Johanne Masowe apostolic sects. These are also worshipping places for many apostolic sects. *Kirawa* is made up of stones (*matombo*) or reeds (*shanga*) depending on the instruction from the spirit. One has to be religiously pure to visit the *kirawa* and remove shoes when visiting a *kirawa*. Removal of shoes is done as a sign of humility before God where angel Gabriel carries human problems to God.

Importance

- For keeping of holy and religious objects like, clay pots (*mbiya*) and stones (*nhombo*). Religious items are sacred and it is a taboo for them to be carried from the *kirawa*. As such they are kept at a *kirawa*.
- It is the holy place for prayers. A *kirawa* is a sacred altar where prayers and supplications to God are made. It is a place where prayer is used to communicate with God.
- Healing and exorcism can also be conducted at the *kirawa*. People with demonic possessions, illness and other problems receive their deliverance at a *kirawa*.
- One comes into contact and get connected to the divine at the *kirawa*. So, a *kirawa* acts as an axis mundi (connecting link) between the human world and the spirit world.
- One shows his or her submission to the deity as can be seen by the removal of shoes at the *kirawa*. This is because a *kirawa* is a sacred place where God manifests himself and one shows humility before God by removing shoes.
- Prophecies are also delivered there. This implies that prophetic message is delivered on this place.

(g) Rivers

Rivers are sacred places in contemporary Christianity. For example, Shashe river is regarded as sacred among believers of the African Apostolic Church led by Mwazha. Church baptism is done at this river during church meetings at Ndarikure. The river is associated with taboos such as avoiding bathing and washing in the river. One has to take water from the river and bath or wash himself or herself away from the river. Failure to do so will make one be punished by God through mermaids. It should be noted that Shashe River is a sacred place in Indigenous religion and in Christianity.

(h) The place where a religious leader is buried

Places where Christian leaders are buried or places where Christian martyrs are buried are also considered as sacred. For example, Defe in Gokwe is a place where Samuel Mutendi the leader of the Zion Christian church was buried. It is a sacred place for his followers and pilgrimage is conducted to this place because it is regarded as sacred. Furthermore, Bernard Mzeki's place of burial in Marondera is regarded as a sacred place for the Anglicans. It's now a religious shrine for the Anglicans. These places are visited by followers of the departed religious leader and they eventually become a religious tourist centre.

Activity 4.3 Research work

Visit one sacred place in Christianity. Write down what you observe there. Present your findings to the class.

Activity 4.4 Educational tour visit a sacred place

Organise an educational tour to a church. After the tour, write a report on what you observed in terms of Christian religious practices and sacred sites.

Exercise 4.3

1. Describe any four sacred places in contemporary Christianity.

[25]

Interesting facts

1. The word “Christian” was derived from a word which means “Christ-like”. Therefore Christians are expected to imitate the life of Jesus Christ.

Summary of the chapter

- There are many rituals in Christianity, birth rituals, baptism rituals, Lord’s Supper, wedding rituals and funeral rituals.
- The rituals can be known as the rites of passage.
- These are carried out differently in different Christian denominations.
- There are many Christian denominations like, Seventh Day Adventist.
- Their roles include praying for the nation and teaching the law of God.
- Sacred places have significant uses in Christianity, these usually have connection with the origins and development of different religious denominations.
- Sacred places are where believers get in conduct with the divine.
- Healing can also happen at different religious and sacred places.

Glossary of terms

Axis mundi	– it is the connection between the heaven and earth.
Baptism	– a ritual of admission to the church, symbolised by the pouring or sprinkling of water on the head or by immersion in water.
Child dedication	– presentation of an infant to the divine.
Christianity	– a religion that has beliefs in Jesus Christ.
Eucharist	– a Christian ritual where there is eating of bread and wine in remembrance of Jesus.
Pilgrim	– one who travels on religious grounds.
Religious practitioner	– a person who has a role in a particular religion.
Rites	– practices done or followed.
Rituals	– these are practises that characterises a religion.
Sacred place	– a place with a religious significance.

Revision Exercises

Structured Questions

1. Rituals are important in Christianity.

- (a) Define the term ritual. [2]
- (b) List four rituals associated with birth in Christianity. [4]
- (c) Explain the significance of birth rituals in Christianity. [6]
- (d) Explain how any two Christian rituals are performed. [8]

2. There are many religious practitioners in Christianity.

- (a) Define religious practitioner. [2]
- (b) State any four religious practitioners in Christianity. [4]
- (c) Explain the roles of religious practitioners. [6]
- (d) Describe the roles of colonial day religious practitioners. [8]

3. There are many Christian sacred places.

- (a) What is a sacred place in Christianity? [2]
- (b) Identify any four sacred places in Christianity. [4]

- (c) Explain any three uses of a church in Christianity. [6]
(d) Describe the significance of sacred places in Christianity. [8]

4. Pilgrimage is important in Christianity.

- (a) Define pilgrimage. [2]
(b) List four reasons for pilgrimage. [4]
(c) Explain what a Christian does when on pilgrimage. [6]
(d) Explain activities done by pilgrims at a holy place. [8]

5. Prayer is an important Christian ritual.

- (a) Define prayer. [2]
(b) Mention four occasions when Christians can pray. [4]
(c) Explain the importance of prayer as a Christian ritual. [6]
(d) How has your society has benefited from prayers? [8]

Essay Questions

6. Explain **five** Christian rituals. [25]
7. How did the religious practitioners help during the colonial era in Zimbabwe? [25]
8. Write notes on any five sacred places of your choice. [25]
9. Explain the significance of sacred practitioners to their communities. [25]

Chapter

5

ISLAM

Chapter objectives

By the end of this chapter, you should be able to:

- describe religious rituals in Islam.
- identify religious practitioners in Islam.
- describe the roles of religious practitioners in Islam.
- identify sacred places.
- describe the importance of sacred places in Islam.

Introduction

This chapter discusses various issues in Islam. This chapter focuses on the rituals in Islam, religious practitioners in Islam and sacred places in Islam. The chapter highlights different Islamic rituals from birth, up to death. The chapter looks at the roles of the religious practitioners in Islam. Sacred places are also important in Islam, so the chapter looks at various sacred places in Islam.

UNIT 5.1 RITUALS IN ISLAM

Islamic rituals are a significant part of Islamic beliefs. These beliefs are based on the Quran and the teachings of Muhammad. Rituals in Islam follow a written procedure for every ceremony.

1. Birth rituals

Birth rituals in Islam are so many and they include; *adhan*, *tanheek*, *Aqiqah* and removal of the hair.

(a) The Adhan (call to prayer)

Muslims believe that when a child is born, the child is a Muslim. When a child is born, the father whispers in the right ear of the child the words, "There is no God but Allah and Muhammad is his prophet."

(b) The Tahneek (putting something sweet on the mouth of the infant)

This is a ritual in which the baby's first taste should be something sweet. Parents chew a piece of honey and rub the juice along the baby's gums. This practice is believed to have been carried out by the Prophet Muhammad and is believed to help tiny digestive systems to kick.

(c) Aqiqah (sacrifice of an animal)

This is a ritual which is done when the baby is born and is a celebration which involves the slaughtering of sheep or goat. The sheep is sacrificed and the meat is distributed to relatives and neighbours and also given

to the poor. On the seventh day, a child is given a name. The baby is named after one of the prophets or one of the great men or women of early Islam.

(d) Shaving ritual

This is a ritual ceremony where the removal of hair is done. It symbolises the cleansing of the baby from impurities and the start of life afresh in the presence of Allah. The shaved hair is weighed and the equivalent weight in silver is given to charity.

(e) Circumcision ritual

Circumcision is done soon after the child is born to allow healing process which is faster when one is young. Once a child is purified by *Aqiqah*, he or she should try to stay faithful to Allah and the teachings of the Prophet Muhammad.

(f) Taweez

This is a ritual when a black piece of string with a pouch of prayers is tied around the wrist of the baby.

(g) Naming ritual

The baby is named on the seventh day by the father. The father decides the name of the child. In most cases the name is chosen by the parents in presence of an Islamic religious practitioner in the community. The name chosen is an Islamic one like Abdullah, Fathima, Ali and Khadijah. The name should have a positive meaning like Karim meaning kind and Jamilah meaning beautiful.

Importance of birth ritual

- To bless and protect the child from evil spirits.
- To give identity to the child.
- To welcome the child into the community.

2. Marriage ritual

Marriage is the foundation of society and family life. Marriage rituals are done according to the laws of the Quran and the teachings of Muhammad. These are;

(a) Salatul Ishtikara (Prayer seeking for guidance)

Families arrange marriages for their children. Once the match is finalised, the Imam of the nearby mosque is invited to perform a special prayer where he seeks Allah's consent for the intended union and asks Him to bless the future couple. This marks the official announcement of the marriage to the community.

(b) Imam Zamin

The groom's mother will take with her sweets and gifts to the bride's house. She also carries a gold or silver coin wrapped inside a silk scarf which she ties around her future daughter-in-law's wrists. This ritual signifies the formal acceptance of the bride into her future family.

(c) Mangni (Engagement)

This ritual marks the official engagement ceremony between the bride and groom and their respective families. Relatives and close friends gather to witness the bride and groom exchanging rings. Each family



Fig. 5.1 The Nikkah ceremony

showers the other with gifts of sweets, fruits, dry fruits, clothes and sometimes cash. In the eyes of the society the two are betrothed.

(d) Manjha (Place of rescue)

A day or two before the actual marriage (*Nikkah*) ceremony, the bride is dressed up in yellow finery. The women of the family gather for the occasion. A turmeric paste is applied to the bride after she takes a bath. After this the bride is not to leave the house till her wedding day. The same event is observed at the groom's house as well.

(e) Mehendi (Decorating the body)

The day before the wedding, the women of the family gather for the ritual involving henna paste known as Mehendi. The most artistic lady in the family applies henna paste in unique, elaborate designs on the bride's hands and feet. It is customary to include the groom's initials within the bride's henna designs which he has to discern on their first night together.

(f) Sanchaq (pre-wedding ritual)

Members of the groom family visit the bride's place with gifts for the bride. These include the bridal outfit to be won at the time of the *Nikkah* with matching jewellery and other accessories.

(g) Nikkah ceremony

The ceremony is officiated by a religious priest or Maulvi. Men and women sit in separate groups for the ceremony, women around the bride and males around the groom. The bride's father is appointed the guardian to look after the bride's interests. The groom's family presents the bride with Meher which is an amount of money to seek her consent for marrying the groom.

The Maulvi begins the ceremony with a prayer from the Quran. Vows are made and the marriage contract is signed in the presence of two observers from each side. The marriage contract outlines all possible duties and rights of both the bride and the groom as decreed by the Quran. After this, the family members shower their blessings on the newly wed couple.

(h) Rukhast (Departing)

The bride after *Nikkah* ceremony bids farewell to her family and sets off for her husband's home. On arrival she is welcomed by her mother-in-law and the Holy Quran is placed on her head to remind her of her duties.



Fig. 5.2 The new couple showing their rings after engagement



Fig. 5.3 The Manjha ceremony



Fig. 5.4 The Mehendi ceremony



Fig. 5.5 The newly wed couple seeking blessings from family members

(i) Walimah (Gathering)

This ceremony marks the public declaration of the marriage accompanied by a great feast. The new couple sit on a throne on the top of the stage greeting all members of both families.

(j) Chauthi (fourth day from wedding ceremony)

On the fourth day from the wedding ceremony, the bride accompanied by her husband visit her parent's home. There they will be fed with a lavish lunch and given gifts. This ritual marks the end of the Muslim wedding.

Importance of marriage rituals

- To seek the bride and family's consent on the marriage as well as announcing the marriage to the community.
- To seek marriage blessings from Allah.
- To outline duties and rights of both the bride and groom as decreed by the Quran.
- To introduce the new couple to both families.
- The *rhukast* is the send-off by the girl's family showering blessings for a new marriage and a happy stay in her new home.
- The *mangni* ritual marks the official engagement ceremony between the bride and groom and their respective families.
- To declare the marriage publicly to the community.
- To sign the marriage contract.
- To exchange marriage vows before the people and Allah that would tie the couple forever in their lifetime.

3. Death ritual

Death among the Muslims is the end of life on earth but not the end of a person's existence. When a person dies certain rituals are to be followed showing that they believe in life after death and judgement day. The body has to be buried as soon as possible. When a person is dying, if he or she is able to, he or she should proclaim the *Shahadah*. The rituals include;

(i) Mourning

A three-day mourning period is observed but for a woman who has lost a husband, she will have a special mourning called the *Iddah* which lasts for four months and ten days. Weeping is acceptable, but the Islamic faith discourages loud crying and acting out during the mourning period. It is believed that the person's spirit can hear these cries and they cause the spirit to anguish.

(ii) Washing of the body of dead

The dead body is bathed by relatives of the same gender as the deceased is bathed three times to seven times until the body is clean. The body is placed on a table and after saying, "In the name of Allah," the washers will use cloths to clean the body from top to bottom and left to right till the body is clean.



Fig. 5.6 A funeral procession in the Islamic religion

(iii) Shrouding the body (*Kaffin*)

Shrouding for a male and female Muslim has different rules. When wrapping a male Muslim corpse, three sheets and four ropes are used. After placing the man's hands on his chest, right hand on top of left hand, each sheet is wrapped on the right side over the body. Two ropes are tied just above the head and just below the feet and the other two ropes are to secure the sheets around the body.

For women, the wrappings are much more intricate. The corpse wears a loose-fitting, sleeveless dress, a head veil and a loin cloth. Just like a male Muslim corpse, three sheets and four ropes are used. Each sheet is wrapped right side first over the body. Two ropes are tied just above the head and just below the feet and the other two ropes are to secure the sheets around the body.

(iv) Funeral prayer

Soon after shrouding is done, a prayer should be done. The body is taken to an outdoor location sometimes near the mosque where Muslims will stand and offer prayers for the forgiveness of the deceased that the deceased may find peace and happiness in the world to come.

(v) The funeral

Funeral attendees stand in three horizontal lines facing Mecca outside the mosque; men in the front row, children in the second row and women in the third row. Silently, they recite the *Fatihah*, the first section of the Quran asking for Allah's mercy and guidance. Four more prayers are done and before each prayer they say "*Allahu Akbar*" which means "Allah is good." The four prayers are *Tahahood*, a prayer to the prophet Muhammad, and the three personal prayers for the deceased. For a child's funeral, the third personal prayer is often for the child's parents.

(vi) Transporting the body

Traditionally, several men carry the body to the cemetery on foot. A procession follows and no discussion, photos or videos at the time of burial are allowed but only prayers for the soul of the departed. There should also be no incense or candles in the funeral procession.

(vii) Burial

A Muslim body should be buried in a Muslim cemetery, and no women or children are allowed at the grave site during the burial. Mourners are required to perform ablutions before the procession begins if prayers are to be said on the grave site. The body is taken out of the coffin and laid on its side with three moulds of soil under the head, the chin and the shoulder. The head faces towards Mecca, the holy city as an imitation of the direction of prayer. The deceased is buried in a deep grave to avoid any bad smell coming out and to stop animals from digging.



Fig. 5.7 People laying the shrouded body to rest in the Islamic religion

(viii) After the funeral

Muslims ritually wash themselves after the funeral is over to purify themselves. Bitter coffee is the traditional Islamic mourning drink which is served to mourners who have come to pay their respects to the dead. It's traditional to reach out to the mourning family with food after the funeral so that they do not have to worry about cooking as they cope with the loss of a loved one.

Importance of the death ritual

- Death rituals give unity to the family and community as they mourn.
- Offering prayers for the forgiveness of the deceased and that they may find peace and happiness in the world to come.
- To prepare the deceased for the judgement day.
- Saying the declaration of faith just before death enables the dying person to go to Jannah (garden of the righteous) after death.
- They are done to prepare the body for the funeral.
- To see to it that the body is buried facing the city of Mecca.
- To show that there is life after death.
- The washing done on the corpse before burial is to purify the body of any sins.
- The wrapping is to be done rightly so that the deceased looks presentable to the angels that escort him or her to heaven.
- For a child's funeral a third personal prayer is done for the parents.
- Washing done after the funeral is to purify them.
- To mark the end of a period of mourning.

Activity 5.1 Group research

In groups, pick a ritual in Islam and discuss procedures done on the ritual. Present your findings to the class.

Activity 5.2 Research assignment

Gather as much information as you can on the importance of Islamic rituals. Make a write-up on your gatherings.

Exercise 5.1

Rituals in Islam show that death is the end of life on earth.

- | | |
|---|-----|
| (a) What is ritual? | [2] |
| (b) List any four death rituals in Islam. | [4] |
| (c) Describe any two death rituals in Islam. | [6] |
| (d) Explore the importance of rituals in Islam. | [8] |

UNIT 5.2 RELIGIOUS PRACTITIONERS IN ISLAM

In Islam just like other religions, there are also various religious practitioners who are important. The religious practitioners in Islam ensure that the traditions in the religion are preserved. They also play an important role in the long life of Islam.

(a) Imam

The term Imam refers to a leader of worship services at a Mosque. The term is more common among the Sunni Muslims. The imam for Sunni Muslims is the one who leads Islamic formal (*Fard*) prayers at Mosques and even in locations outside the mosque. Every prayer session which is done in a group of two or more under the leadership of one person known as the imam and others imitate the Imam's ritual actions of worship. Friday worship services are led by an appointed imam. All mosques have an imam to lead the (congregational) prayers.



Fig. 5.8 An Imam leading a prayer

Some Imams are members from the gathered congregation rather than an officially appointed Imam paid for his job. The position of women as Imams is controversial as they do not occupy that position. An Imam is chosen according to the Hadith and he should be a person who has more knowledge of the Quran and Sunnah (prophetic tradition) and is of good character and of old age.

Roles of Imams

- He must preserve the religion according to its established bases and that on which the *salaf* (predecessors) of the ummah was unanimously agreed. If an innovator, deviant or one who is confused about issues in Islam, he has to explain the proof to him and tell him what is correct, and deal with him according to the set rights and punishments so that the religion will be protected against being undermined and the ummah will be prevented from deviance.
- He must judge between disputing parties and put an end to arguments so that justice and fairness prevails, aggressors will not get carried away and no person who is wronged will feel helpless.
- He must carry out hard punishments so that the sacred limits of Allah will not be transgressed and so that the rights of His slaves will be protected.
- He must collect *zakat* (Alms) and charity money in the manner enjoined by the texts and scholarly consensus without causing fear or being unjust.
- He must appoint people who are honest and sincere to different positions, so that things will be done efficiently and wealth will be kept with trustworthy people.

(b) Muezzin

A muezzin is a person appointed at a mosque to lead and recite the call to prayer for every event of prayer and worship in the mosque. The community depends on him for an accurate prayer schedule. The first muezzin was Bilal ibn Ribah who walked in the streets to call the believers to come to prayer. Nowadays, mosques often have loudspeakers on the top of the minaret and the muezzin recording is played allowing the call to prayer to be heard at great distances without climbing the minaret.



Fig. 5.9 A muezzin calling Muslims for prayer

(c) Ulama

The term *ulama* literally means those who possess knowledge (*ilm*), particularly of Islam. The *ulama* emerged as the first interpreters of the Quran and transmitters of the *hadith* (words and deeds of the prophet Muhammad). These scholars also became the first to outline and elaborate the basic principles of Islamic law (*sharia*). The *ulama* were central to Islamic education in the pre-modern Middle East. They regulated instruction at all levels and were instrumental in the process of training Islamic scholars in *madrasas* (residential colleges), which were established by the eleventh century. These medieval institutions developed a thorough curriculum centered on instruction in the law, training future jurists, theologians, and state functionaries. Members of the *ulama* might also participate in Islamic mysticism as members or even leaders of organised Sufi fraternities.

Ulama is comprised of lawyers and judges because of their legal skills which are critical to the regulation of Islamic society in social and commercial matters such as wills, marriage, and trade. The *ulama* also included theologians, prayer leaders, and teachers, many of whom continued to participate in the economy as traders or artisans.

(d) Caliphs

The word “*caliph*” comes from the Arabic “*Khalifa*,” meaning “*substitute*” or “*successor*.” Caliphs are spiritual, civil and political leaders of Islam who claim succession from Muhammad. A caliph is a religious leader in Islam who is believed to be the successor to Prophet Muhammad and leader of Ummar. The holder of the title “caliph” claims temporal and spiritual authority over all Muslims, but is not regarded as a possessor of a prophetic mission. Some of the caliphs include Abur Bakr, Umar, Uthman and Ali.

Roles of caliphs

Caliphs had various roles in Islam. These roles include:

- Guiding the Muslims to walk in the straight path.
- Caliphs represented the ideals that all Muslims, regardless of race, are equal members of a single, global entity, the ummah.
- They also stood for the integration of the spiritual with the political, ensuring at least in theory harmony between the law of the state and divine law.
- He ensured that the law was more or less the same throughout the territory of which the caliph is the head.
- The caliphs promoted unity by creating a single, God-fearing community of all mankind.

(e) Mufti

A mufti is an Islamic scholar who interprets and expounds Islamic law. Muftis are jurists qualified to give authoritative legal opinions known as fatwas. A mufti assists judges in deciding cases since he deals with the law. His opinions serve as a valuable source of information on the practical application of Islamic law as opposed to its abstract formulation. He is responsible for the body of religious legal scholars and gave rulings on important state policies such as the dethronement of rulers. He undertakes the important responsibilities for the religion and society as a whole. A mufti is someone who is able to solve problems that arise pertaining to the Islamic religion.

(f) Allamah

It is an honorary title carried by scholars of Islamic fiqh (jurisprudence) and philosophy. It is used by both Sunni and Shia Islam. The title is carried by only the very highest scholars of Islamic thought, jurisprudence and philosophy. An Allamah is a leader for the Islamic faith.

Activity 5.3 Research work

Do a research on Islamic religious practitioners operating in your community in groups, and note down their roles. Allow a presenter to present your findings.

Exercise 5.2

Fill in the following gaps.

1. _____ were in charge of religious matters soon after the death of Muhammad.
2. A religious leader at a mosque is known as _____.
3. _____ calls Muslims to prayer.
4. Islamic scholars are called _____.
5. _____ interprets the Koran and the Hadith.
6. _____ is a man who is respected because of his piety or religious learning in Islam.

UNIT 5.3 SACRED PLACES IN ISLAM

Islamic sacred places are regarded as very important to their faith. This is so because these sacred places are associated with sacred stories or very important events that have occurred on such places. A place of worship is a sacred place among the Muslims. In Islam, there are sacred places such as;

(a) Mosque

All mosques by the virtue that they are worshipping places are holy places. Muslims worship, study and discuss Islam in a mosque. Religious festivals and gatherings are held in mosques for example weddings. Mosques should appeal to the community they serve. Facilities such as health clinics, libraries and sports halls are found in a mosque. Some mosques often invite poor members of the community to meals. Mosques offer special optional prayers done after the last required prayer of the day.



Fig. 5.10 The mosque in the Islamic institute in Harare

A mosque has a minaret from which the muezzin calls worshippers to prayer. A dome in a mosque help the imam be heard as the sound waves would bounce in and then out of the dome making the voice louder. A prayer hall called musalla has no furniture except for prayer mats or rugs since Islamic prayer is usually done kneeling.

Rules in a mosque

- No shoes should be worn in the prayer hall.
- Believers should step inside using their right foot only.
- Before Muslims pray, they perform wudu, a washing ritual.
- Believers to wear clothes that show modesty. Men to come to the mosque wearing loose and clean clothes that do not show the shape of the body. Women are expected to wear loose clothing and cover their heads with a hijab.
- Men and women pray apart; men at the front and women in a separate area either at the back or upstairs so as not to disturb the men.
- Loud talking or discussion of topics that could be disrespectful is forbidden in areas where people are praying.

- It is considered rude to walk in front of Muslims in prayer.
- Visiting a mosque is allowed only between prayers; visitors must wear long trousers and take off their shoes. Women must cover their heads, no photos, no loud talk is allowed.

Importance of a mosque

- It is a place of worship. Muslims come together for worship for it is the very purpose of their existence. It makes the prayers of Muslims as perfect as possible so that they worship with a clear conscience and confidence of doing the right thing in prayers.
- It brings the community together as it acts as many things, a social centre, a community centre and an educational centre.
- Mosques are study centres for new comers of the faith to come and learn about the teachings of the holy Quran, learn how to read it and pronounce.
- Islamic prayers learnt in a mosque will strengthen truly human values and sharpen human character so that Muslims can hope to attain perfection.
- Mosques are centres of Islamic life inculcating values onto Muslims seeking to imbibe Islamic cultural and religious ethos in order to live as genuine Muslims.
- It is a treasury from which charity work is done. The care of the needy, orphans and the sick is done in a mosque.
- Mosques can attract non-Muslims to Islam by showing them some of the religious activities of the Muslims such as the prayer, making them curious about Islam and its beliefs and giving them an opportunity to find out more.
- Events during the holiest month of Ramadan are held in a mosque.
- It is a meeting place for the community where they are informed of important religious events and duties.

(b) The city of Mecca or Mekkah

The city of Mecca is the most sacred place in Islam located in the western part of Saudi Arabia about 75 miles inland from the port city of Jidda in the Hejaz province. The focal point of Mecca is the Kaaba.

The Kaaba is centred in the city of Mecca in Saudi Arabia. It is the most sacred and holiest place in Islam. According to Islamic tradition, Prophet Abraham and his son Ishmael built the Kaaba as a symbol of the house of God. Every year millions of Muslims travel to Mecca to perform the pilgrimage. Once a believer has made the pilgrimage to Mecca, men may add the title al-Hajji to their name, hajjiyah for females. Many Muslims pray in the direction of the Kaaba five times a day no matter where they are. Mecca is the birthplace of the Prophet Muhammad and the Islamic faith.



Fig. 5.12 The great Kaaba mosque in Mecca

Religious significance of Mecca

- The city's sacredness in Islam derives primarily from the fact that it was the prophet's birthplace.
- A pilgrimage to Mecca is required of every Muslim who can afford it as one of the five pillars of faith.

- Mecca is a worldwide place of pilgrimage. It is a place brimming with spirituality and sacredness.
- The prophet Muhammad designated Mecca as the holy city of Islam in which all Muslims should offer their prayers. The direction of prayer is known as the qibla.
- It was in Mecca that Muhammad began to receive revelations from God via the angel Gabriel.
- It is in Mecca that Muhammad began to preach his new faith.
- The Kaaba contains the black stone which is believed to have been given by the Angel Gabriel to Abraham and which pilgrims come to kiss on the Hajj.

(c) Medina – The city of the Prophet

Medina is the second holiest city in Islam with significant religious and historical significance to Muslims. It is also known as Madinah An Nabi (The city of the prophet). When prophet Muhammad and his followers faced persecution in Mecca, they were offered refuge by the main tribe of Yathrib. Here the small and persecuted Muslim community was able to become established, administrate their own community and implement elements of religious life that they were unable to do under Makkan persecution. Medina thrived and became the centre of the growing Islamic nation.

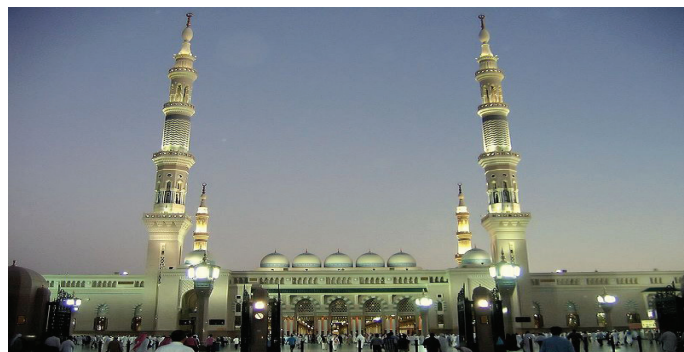


Fig. 5.13 The Prophet's Mosque (Masjid Al Nabawi)

The Prophet's mosque in Medina is called Masjid Al Nabawi. It is the second in sanctity in Islam. Prophet Muhammad was instructed to build the mosque by Allah. Medina is the first capital in Islam since it is where the first Muslim community flourished. Muhammad was laid to rest in this mosque. Muslims usually visit the mosque during their Hajj journey. It is believed that one prayer at the Prophet's Mosque is equivalent to one thousand prayers.

Religious significance of Medina

- It was in Medina where Islam first flourished, allowing Muhammad to gain a large following and subdue pagan antagonism from Mecca to solidify Islam's hold across Arabia.
- The city holds the first mosque in the world, the mosque where Muhammad switched the Muslim direction of prayer from Jerusalem to Mecca.
- It is believed that one prayer at the Prophet's Mosque is equivalent to one thousand prayers.
- The prophet's mosque became the centre of the city's religious, political and economic life.
- Medina remained Muhammad's home for the rest of his life.
- The city holds the mosque of the prophet where Muhammad is buried.

(d) Mount Arafat

Mount Arafat or Mount Arafah is a granite hill east of Mecca in the plain of Arafat. Arafat is a plain about 20 km southeast of Mecca. Mount Arafat reaches about 70 m in height. This mount is often referred to as the Hill of Mercy because it was where Adam and Eve reconciled after separation.

(e) Zam-zam

Zamzam is name derived from *zome-zome* which means stop. The sacred well is found in Mecca. It is

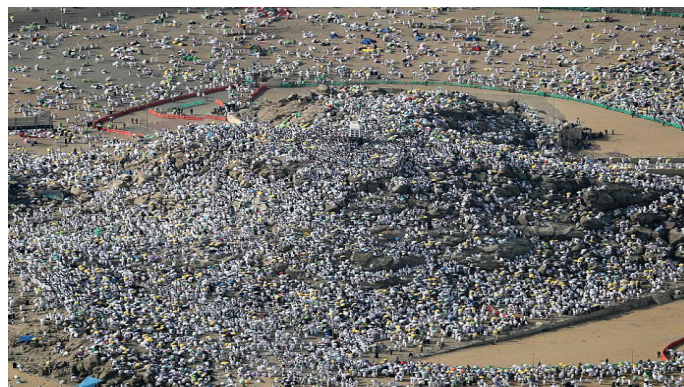


Fig. 5.14 Mount Arafat

the one Ishmael and Hagar drank from after they were sent off by Abraham (Genesis 21:19-20). Hagar is believed to have run seven times between the hills of Safa and Marwah looking for water to give to Ishmael. That's when Ishmael started scraping the land with his feet and water suddenly gushed out of the ground. Water from this well is regarded as holy. Muslims believe that the well miraculously generated water from Allah.

(f) Any other Place of prayer

Prayer is done at designated times. Any place that one carries out prayer is ritually clean. These places include the battlefield which can be turned into a sacred place. Salvation can be attained at war because in launching a Jihad the place is turned to a sacred space.



Fig. 5.15 The sacred well Zam-zam

Activity 5.4 Educational tour

Organise a trip to any mosque in Zimbabwe and after the trip, compile a report on your observations.

Exercise 5.3

Answer the following questions with True or False

1. Islam has sacred places.
2. Weddings are not conducted in a mosque in Islam.
3. A mosque has a minaret from which a muezzin calls Muslims to prayer.
4. A washing ritual is called a *wudu* in Islam.
5. Expensive clothes are part of the religious attire required in a mosque.
6. Mecca is found outside Saudi Arabia.
7. Medina is the city of the prophet.
8. Jerusalem is a sacred place for Judaism, Christianity and Islam.

Interesting facts

1. A dead corpse is washed and shrouded before burial which is done in silence, no music, photos or videos but should be accompanied by prayers for the soul of the departed.

Summary of the chapter

- This chapter has looked at the four rituals in Islam highlighting the importance of blessing a newly born child seeking protection against evil spirits from Allah, circumcision which is aimed at cleanliness, marriage as the foundation of society and family life and death as preparation of the judgement day.
- Death among the Muslims is the end of life on earth but not the end of a person's existence.
- When a person dies certain rituals are to be followed showing that they believe in life after death and the judgement day.
- An Imam is a leader. Each mosque has its leader who has various roles including leading the worship services and interpreting the Quran. Religious practitioners in Islam date back to Prophet Muhammad.
- Muslims once in a lifetime have to embark on a pilgrimage to Mecca, the most holy place in Islam. Only Muslims are allowed in the city.
- Medina is the place where prophet Muhammad spent the rest of his life and was even buried there in the mosque.
- The city of Mecca is the most sacred place in Islam and it is the birthplace of prophet Muhammad. Muslims pray facing towards the city of Mecca.
- Wudu is a washing ritual observed before Muslims pray. Every mosque has an area set aside for wudu.
- A muezzin is a religious practitioner appointed at a mosque to lead and recite the call to prayer for every event of prayer and worship in the mosque.
- The community depends on him for an accurate prayer schedule.
- Most Muslims harbour a deep hope that Jerusalem and the rest of the holy land will be restored to a land of peace where all religious believers can exist in harmony.

Glossary of terms

Aqiqah	– a welcoming celebration for a new baby.
Date	– a sweet fruit with shaped like an olive.
Imam	– a Muslim leader who leads prayers in a mosque.
Jurisprudence	– the philosophy, science and study of law and decisions based on the interpretation thereof.
Mehar	– money paid by the groom to the bride asking for her consent in marriage.
Mosque	– a place of worship for Muslims.
Nikkah	– a wedding ceremony where a marriage contract is signed.
Pilgrimage	– a religious journey to a sacred place.
Shahadah	– is the central Muslim statement of faith.
Shrouding	– the process of dressing the dead.

Revision Exercises

Structured Questions

1. Rituals in Islam are based on the Quran and the teachings of Muhammad.

- (a) What is a ritual? [2]
- (b) List four rituals in Islam. [4]
- (c) Explain the significance of the rituals stated above. [6]
- (d) Describe the importance of rituals in the Islamic religion. [8]

2. Each mosque has a leader who leads the worship services.

- (a) What is an Imam? [2]
- (b) Identify four Islamic religious practitioners. [4]
- (c) Explain the roles of any three of the religious practitioners mentioned above. [6]
- (d) Describe the importance of religious practitioners in the Islamic religion. [8]

3. Muslims believe that Mecca is the most holy place on earth.

- (a) What is a sacred place? [2]
- (b) List four places considered holy by Muslims. [4]
- (c) Explain any three uses of the Mosque in Islam. [6]
- (d) Describe the importance of the three most holy places in Islam. [8]

4. Before Muslims pray, they perform a washing ritual.

- (a) What is the name given to the ritual? [2]
- (b) List at least four rules to be observed in a mosque. [4]
- (c) Explain the structure of a mosque. [6]
- (d) Describe the importance of a mosque. [8]

Essay Questions

- 1. Discuss the importance of rituals in Islam. [25]
- 2. Describe the roles of religious practitioners in Islam. [25]
- 3. Write notes on the following sacred places in Islam.
 - (a) Mosque. [5]
 - (b) Mecca. [5]
 - (c) Medina. [5]
 - (d) Jerusalem. [5]
- 4. Describe the importance of a Mosque to Muslims. [25]
- 5. Discuss the marriage rituals in Islam. [25]

EXAMINATION I

PAPER 1: STRUCTURED QUESTIONS 2 hours 30 minutes

Answer **five** questions.

Choose at least **one** question from each section.

Each question carries (20) marks.

SECTION A: INDIGENOUS RELIGION

1. Rituals form the core of Indigenous religion.

- (a) What is a ritual? [2]
- (b) Identify any four examples of rituals in Indigenous religion. [4]
- (c) Describe any three rituals in Indigenous religion. [6]
- (d) Explain the importance of any four personal rituals in Indigenous religion. [8]

2. Sacred places in Indigenous religion are either natural or man-made.

- (a) Define a sacred place in Indigenous religion. [2]
- (b) List four examples of man-made sacred places in Indigenous religion. [4]
- (c) Describe any three sacred places in Indigenous religion. [6]
- (d) Explain the importance of man-made sacred places in Indigenous religion. [8]

3. Religious practitioners play a significant role in Indigenous religion.

- (a) What is a religious practitioner? [2]
- (b) Identify any four religious practitioners in Indigenous religion. [4]
- (c) State the roles of any three religious practitioners in Indigenous religion during the liberation struggle. [6]
- (d) Describe two roles played by any four religious practitioners in Indigenous religion. [8]

SECTION B: JUDAISM

4. Jewish rituals are formally and strictly followed as prescribed in the Torah.

- (a) What is the Torah? [2]
- (b) List four rituals in Judaism. [4]
- (c) Explain the term, 'be fruitful and multiply'. [6]
- (d) Describe the significance of any other four rituals in Judaism. [8]

5. Most of the Jewish religious practitioners are called "Rabbis".

- (a) What is a Rabbi? [2]
- (b) List four religious practitioners in Judaism. [4]
- (c) Explain the roles of any three religious practitioners in Judaism. [6]
- (d) Discuss the significance of any four roles of Jewish religious practitioners in Zimbabwe today. [8]

6. Sacred places remind Jews of their forefathers and the very founders of their religion.

- (a) What are sacred places in Judaism? [2]
- (b) Mention any four sacred places in Judaism. [4]
- (c) Explain the importance of any three sacred places in Judaism. [6]
- (d) Demonstrate how the Western Wall and the City of Jerusalem have become the pillars of Jewish religion. [8]

SECTION C: CHRISTIANITY

7. Christian rituals are formally referred to as, “Sacraments”.

- (a) What is a sacrament in Christianity? [2]
- (b) List any four rituals in Christianity. [4]
- (c) Give details about any three rituals in Christianity. [6]
- (d) Explain the significance of the Eucharist or The Lord’s supper and the Extreme Unction in Christianity. [8]

8. Religious practitioners in Christianity are known from their religious denominations.

- (a) What is a religious denomination in Christianity? [2]
- (b) List four religious denominations in Christianity. [4]
- (c) Name any three present-day religious practitioners in Christianity. [6]
- (d) Explain four roles of present-day religious practitioners in Christianity. [8]

9. Most sacred places in Christianity are places where church founders received their call.

- (a) What is a call? [2]
- (b) List four places where some Christian church founders received their call. [4]
- (c) Describe any three sacred places in Christianity. [6]
- (d) Explain the significance of any two sacred places in Christianity. [8]

SECTION D: ISLAM

10. Rituals in Islam are based on the Quran and the teaching of Muhammad.

- (a) What is the Quran? [2]
- (b) State four rituals in Islam. [4]
- (c) Describe any three rituals in Islam. [6]
- (d) Explain the importance of four rituals in Islam. [8]

11. An Imam is a religious practitioner in Islam.

- (a) What does “Imam” mean? [2]
- (b) Mention two names of religious practitioners in Islam. [4]
- (c) Describe what you know about Muhammad. [6]
- (d) Explain any four roles and duties of Islamic religious practitioners in Zimbabwe. [8]

12. Every Mosque is considered Holy in Islam.

- (a) What is a Mosque? [2]
- (b) Mention four main sacred places in Islam. [4]
- (c) Describe any three sacred places in Islam. [6]
- (d) Demonstrate the importance of four sacred places in Islam. [8]

PAPER 2 ESSAY QUESTIONS

2 hours

Answer **four** questions.

Choose **one** question from each section.

SECTION A: INDIGENOUS RELIGION

1. Write explanatory notes on the geographical distribution of religions in Zimbabwe. [25]
2. Describe the importance of personal and community rituals in Indigenous religion. [25]
3. Discuss the significance of natural sacred places in Indigenous religion. [25]

SECTION B: JUDAISM

4. Write explanatory notes on the significance of the marriage rituals in Judaism. [25]
5. Explain the significance of modern-day religious practitioners in Judaism. [25]
6. Discuss the significance of five major sacred places in Judaism. [25]

SECTION C: CHRISTIANITY

7. Explain the significance of any five rituals in Christianity. [25]
8. Discuss the roles of Christian religious practitioners in the war of liberation in Zimbabwe. [25]
9. Outline the five major sacred places in Christianity and explain their significance to Christians. [25]

SECTION D: ISLAM

10. Explain the significance of major rituals in Islam. [25]
11. Describe the role of the Islamic religious practitioners operating in Zimbabwe. [25]
12. Outline the main functions of the Islamic sacred places. [25]

Chapter

6

RELIGION, FAMILY AND IDENTITY

Chapter objectives

By the end of this chapter, you should be able to:

- illustrate ways in which religion encourages families to depend on each other.
- show how IR through *Unhu/Ubuntu/Vumunhu* shapes Zimbabwean Identity.

Introduction

The family plays an integral part in many societies as it shapes values and norms which are important in instilling good behaviour. It is an agent of socialisation. This chapter focuses on ways in which religion encourages families to depend on each other by looking at the contribution of Indigenous religion and Christianity in encouraging interdependence. The chapter concludes by explaining how Indigenous religion shapes Zimbabwean identity through the concept of *unhu* or *ubuntu*.

UNIT 6.1 INTER-DEPENDENCY OF FAMILIES

Families comprise of father, mother and children. It can also be a grandfather and a grandmother and grandchildren. A family can also comprise of a father and children or a mother and children. Family structures differ from one society to the other. A family cannot live in isolation. It has to depend on other families for its existence. Inter-dependency of families is an interwoven system of relations which are inseparable. Various religions promote inter-dependency among families.

Inter-dependency is the state of being dependent upon one another. Families rely on each other for survival. No single family can operate on its own, without the need to incorporate values, views, material things, and so forth, from other families, hence the concept of inter-dependency.

How religion encourages family inter-dependency

Various religions in the Zimbabwean communities have ways in which they foster inter-dependency among families. There are various traditions, sayings and taboos which encourage inter-dependency.

Indigenous religion

There are several ways used in Indigenous religion to promote interdependence among families. Interdependence is important in promoting unity among family members as well as promoting development within the community. These ways include *Zunde ramambo* or *Isiphala senkosi* (chief's farming project), *nhimbe* or *ilima* (communal collaboration), *kuronzera* (lending to others) and rituals.

(a) *Zunde ramambo* (Chief's farming project)

It is the role of chiefs and other traditional leaders to foster a culture of sharing among their subjects. Traditional leaders, as custodians of tradition and culture, take the leading role in assisting the needy and the vulnerable in society, such as orphans, the lame and the elderly, who face challenges in trying to fend for themselves. Chiefs and kings usually have the '*zunde ramambo*' project in which they produce grain through the contributions of their subjects. Proceeds from the project are channelled towards assisting the marginalised in society. The assistance is believed to be key in as far as the appeasement of ancestral spirits in Indigenous religion is concerned.

The chiefs and kings are to defend the rights of the disadvantaged. The idea is to ensure that the poor in general, do not suffer neglect and to allow communities to share resources, yields, labour and even gifts. Those with, say, cattle, for draught power can assist those who do not have.

(b) *Nhimbe* or *Ilima* (communal collaboration)

Assistance can also be in the form of '*nhimbe*' or *ilima* (communal collaboration) where the whole community come to work for the needy in return for just some food or some beer. *Nhimbe* or *Ilima* is a practice where the community collaborate in performing tasks which are naturally impossible to be done by one man like tilling large tracts of land, putting manure into the field, harvesting crops as well as thrashing and winnowing of crops. These tasks are done without any monetary payment as people in the community help one another. Beer is provided for those who drink alcohol and *maheu* is provided for non-alcoholics as they perform the task at hand.



Fig. 6.1 Community members working together

Food is provided also during this communal collaboration (*nhimbe* or *ilima*) in form of meat and sadza. Many people in the community and from surrounding areas would come for this event to accomplish the task that would require a long period to be done. Normally *nhimbe* starts early in the morning around 4.00 am and ends around midnight. The rest of the day is spent eating and drinking as well as discussing social issues. *Nhimbe* united people and promoted interdependence between families. Families in Indigenous religion depend on each other.

(c) Cattle loaning (*Kuronzera*)

Indigenous people promoted interdependence upon each other through *kuronzera* (cattle loaning). Those who had many cattle had to give to those with none. The one given cattle would look after them as well as using them to till land as well as getting milk from the beast given to him. This ensured that the poor were empowered to practice their agricultural activities there by alleviating hunger and poverty among those who were poor. Cattle loaning is a way that promoted family interdependence.

(d) Proverbs or indigenous knowledge systems

There are certain proverbs that encourage inter-dependency among families.

- "*Kutsva kwende bvuvu varume vanodzimirana.*" which literally implies that one has to help the other in times of problems or difficulty. This encourages dependency among family members as this proverb inculcates an awareness that problems are part of life and they will come and go. It is through this understanding that indigenous family see problems as part of life and can be encountered by anyone

rich or poor, health or sick, clever or foolish.

- *"Rume rimwe harikombi churu"* which literally means a one person cannot perform surmountable work alone, this encourages family dependency because in indigenous societies people are stronger when they work together and no amount of problem is too big when families depend on each other. This is supported by the Ndebele saying *"izandla ziya gezana"* which literally means hands wash each other. This means that people are supposed to work together to come up with something of great substance.
- *"Tukomo twapedyo napedyo hatwunyimani mhute"* which literally means small hills or mountains close to each share mist. This means that family or people who are close should share and depend on each other in times of need. It is un-African to be stingy especially towards one's own relatives.
- *"Mweni haapedzi dura"* which literally means that a stranger cannot dwindle food stocks and *"Kupa, kukanda tsapo mberi,"* which means giving is investing, this teaches aspects of Unhu in Indigenous religion through hospitality and generosity. The idea of inter-dependency among families is encouraged through hospitality. By helping passers-by, one also expects to be helped when one happens to get to a new place. Shona proverbs also depict aspects of generosity.
- *"Kugara hunzwana"* which literally means good living is when one live peacefully with others. Inter-dependency among families is seen when there is harmonious co-existence as explained in this proverb. It is through co-existence that families are able to depend on each other.
- In Venda the proverb, *"Nanga nthihi a i lidzi tshikana"* which literally means one reed flute does not produce a good sound *"tshikana"* promote collectivism, interdependence and solidarity among family members. One family member cannot succeed alone but can make meaningful contribution to life with the help of others. Indigenous people are a caring society who discourage selfishness and individualism but encourage interdependence on one another.
- *"Mulenzhe muthihi a u tshini tshiimbo"* which literally means one leg cannot dance. This is another Venda proverb which encourage family interdependence. This proverb explains that one man cannot do meaningful things in life. For life to have meaning there is need for interdependence as egocentrism does not make families grow and prosper. It reminds people to live as a social unit particularly in times of troubles so that problems are solved collectively.

(e) Rituals

Many rituals in Indigenous religion promoted interdependency among families. For example, when families were ravaged by avenging spirits (*ngozi*), the exorcising of these spirits required unity among family members. This created interdependence among family members as they united to mitigate effects of avenging spirits. Furthermore, rituals like rain asking ceremony (*mukwerera*) encouraged unity among people hence creating interdependence among family members.



Fig. 6.2 Community members gathered performing rituals

How Christianity encourage inter-dependency among families

Family interdependence is at the heart of Christianity. To be selfish, stingy and greedy is unlike Jesus Christ who is the role model of all Christians. Christianity is a religion that follows the life and teaching of Jesus Christ. Much of the information contained in the gospels reflects interdependence as a true mark of a Christian.

(i) Christian teaching on sharing

The idea of sharing among families and depending on each other is a testimony of faith and fellowship.

This is supported by Matthew 5 verse 42, *"Give to him who begs from you, and do not refuse him who borrows from you."* This shows that Christianity encourages inter-dependency among families. Various Christian organisations such as The Capernaum Trust Fund help fund the education for orphans and assisting them with self-help projects so that they can fend for themselves and their families. Sharing is at the centre of Christian teaching and it is through this teaching on sharing that interdependence is promoted in Christianity.

(ii) Communal sharing

The idea of communal sharing was common during the early church. According to the book of the Acts, early Christians worked together and learnt to share whatever they got. The element of inter-dependency is shown when the Apostles gathered together for the breaking of bread ceremony in Acts 2 verse 44. *"And all who believed were together and had all things in common, and they sold their possessions and goods and distributed them to all, as any had need."* It is from such occasions that Christianity, right from the beginning, encouraged the idea of inter-dependency among families. Congregants at various church gatherings such as the Zion Christian Church often share meals and donate towards the need and the vulnerable.



Fig. 6.3 A Christian organisation sharing with the needy

(iii) Fellowship

The idea of fellowship in Christianity is fully demonstrated in Jesus' feeding miracles, the feeding of the four and the five thousand people. According to Luke 9 verse 14, Jesus said to his disciples, before giving out the five loaves and two fish, *"Make them sit down in companies, about fifty each."* The disciples distributed the food before the five thousand who had gathered and they shared as families, ate and were satisfied. The concept of inter-dependency was cultivated from this incident.

(iv) Offerings

Offerings is another way used in Christianity which promote interdependence among families as it encourages sharing. These offerings like free will offerings help the needy in society and helps in social development. Offerings are a reflection of interdependence in Christianity.

How Judaism encourages inter-dependency among families

From the period of the Exodus, various groups of the Hebrews shared a common objective of reaching the Promised Land of Canaan. During the Exodus, the Israelites encountered a number of challenges, chief among them were food and water problems which they experienced in the wilderness. It was through the exodus experience that interdependence among families was encouraged and is still being encouraged.

(i) Miracles by Moses

Through the inspired leadership of Moses, they were able to get food in the form of manna and water that gushed out of a rock. The great crowd shared what was made available by their God. The idea of inter-dependency among families was cultivated during that period in Judaism.

(ii) Religious feasts

Modern Jews commemorate the Passover. They remember the period of the Exodus. During the Passover

feast, Jews contribute towards the successful holding of the Passover ceremony and share the holy meal. The Passover, the Pentecost and the Tabernacles are feasts where Jews share what they have during the commemorations, encourages inter-dependency among families in Judaism.

How Islam encourages inter-dependency among families

In Islam, the income of an individual in an extended family is not treated as personal property, rather it belongs to the entire family. The system intends to promote togetherness, mutual trust and co-operation among family members. This is a form of inter-dependency among families in Islam.



Fig. 6.4 Young Jews eating together at a religious feast

(i) Caring for the family

The Imam emphasises the need to cater for the needs of one's immediate family as an obligation. As for the relatives, it is still mandatory for a Muslim to show love and care for the relatives. Key among the expected responsibilities are; doing good to one's relatives, doing good to other believers, recommended charity and emancipation of slaves. All these aspects show how Islam encourages inter-dependency among families.

(ii) Almsgiving (*Zakat*)

Islam encourages interdependence among families through almsgiving. Muslims believe that wealth is a blessing from Allah and family members as well as the poor should benefit from the wealth given by Allah. It is a religious obligation to contribute between 2, 5 to 10 % of one's wealth towards the welfare of the poor. This teaching or practice helps family members to depend on each other in society which they live as it pleases Allah. Here in Zimbabwe many Muslim families receive help from other Muslim communities outside the country through faith-based organisations like the Zakat Foundation and Muslim Hand.

Activity 6.1 Research work

In groups, find out how families depend on each other in your local community.

Exercise 6.1

1. Describe how Indigenous religion promote interdependence among families.

[25]

UNIT 6.2 INDIGENOUS RELIGION AND ZIMBABWEAN IDENTITY

Indigenous religion refers to the religion of the native Zimbabwean people, whereas Zimbabwean identity is a concept which is concerned with who a Zimbabwean is as a citizen of a country. It is important to distinguish Zimbabweans from other people of other nations. The culture of the Zimbabwean people which is unique from the others is what Zimbabwean identity is. Zimbabwean identity are features which make a citizen of Zimbabwe unique which have functioned as a symbol of continuity with the past. The features which make the Zimbabwean identity are food, language, behaviour, dressing and beliefs.

Aspects of Indigenous religion which bring out Zimbabwean identity

One of the distinctive features which characterise Zimbabwean identity is *unhu* or *ubuntu*. The Shona aspect

of *Unhu* is synonymous with the Nguni Ubuntu which means the belief in a universal bond of sharing all that which connects humanity. *Unhu, Ubuntu* or *Vumunhu* is an appreciation of traditional beliefs and a constant awareness that an individual's actions are for the good of all. In other words, the behaviour patterns in *Unhu* or *Ubuntu*, must be acceptable to all. The principle of *Unhu* or *Ubuntu* is, "I am because you are." This means that everything that one does in society affects someone else in one way or the other. It is, therefore, important that an individual does what one sees as beneficial to others.

(a) Being hospitable

In Indigenous religion, a person is expected to be hospitable. It is vital to receive visitors in the home and offer them special food and accommodation. The idea is to please *Mwari* or *uMlimo*. The belief is that one would receive similar treatment if one happens to be a visitor in another place one day. Zimbabweans are identified with an attribute of being hospitable people who are guided by elements of *Unhu, Ubuntu* or *Vumunhu*. Visitors should be treated with honour throughout their period of visit. Taking care of visitors is everyone's responsibility in the home, village or community. Displaying natural kindness and politeness are the virtues of *Unhu, Ubuntu* or *Vumunhu* in Indigenous religion.

(b) Respect for the elderly

In Indigenous religion, the elderly people are believed to be closer to the ancestral world of the spirit. It is this age group that takes a leading role in rituals and other important ceremonies such as bringing back home the spirit of the deceased, rain-asking and others. The spirit of *unhu* or *ubuntu* is shown through the respect accorded the elderly folk. Our identity as Zimbabweans is seen through such respect. The elderly people are there to provide spiritual guidance to the young so that they are protected by the ancestral spirits. Respect of elders is shown through helping them to carry their load when you meet them along the road, greeting them, removing the hat when talking to them as well as assisting them in all areas where they need assistance.

(c) Empathy

There are some people in society who fall into various forms of misfortunes. In Indigenous religion, society is duty-bound to show positive feelings towards the unfortunate and demonstrating willingness to assist them. The idea is that one is blessed by empathising with the bereaved, the marginalised and the unfortunate members of the society. If immediate parents of a child pass on, it is the responsibility of the extended family to look after the child or children left behind so that they are brought up well. The idea of *Unhu, Ubuntu* or *Vumunhu* is of the view that parents should be responsible for the upkeep of every child, including the vulnerable ones.

(d) Sharing

The spirit of *unhu* or *ubuntu* is shown through sharing what one has with the others in society. It is not good to be pompous about one's possessions. The spirit of sharing is a key element of *unhu, ubuntu* or *vumunhu* that shapes our identity as Zimbabweans. A person is a person through other people, hence the mantra, 'I am because you are.' A person with *unhu, ubuntu* or *vumunhu* is prepared to share with others, not only material things, but even ideas for progress and development. Shared values have a positive impact on members of one's family, clan, community and the nation.

(e) Social responsibility

A person with *Unhu, Ubuntu* or *Vumunhu* should be responsible. In every society, individuals are responsible for the welfare of others. In Indigenous religion, people believe that they have a duty to actively participate in funeral rites. Failure to do that is considered a misnomer. Assisting the disadvantaged in their fields for them to realise better harvests is everyone's responsibility in society.

Interesting facts

1. Despite modernisation and urbanisation, Zimbabweans are still connected to their tribal backgrounds through Indigenous religion.
2. A sense of national identity is fostered through national events such as the Independence and Heroes Day commemorations.

Summary of the chapter

- Religion is associated with families and the Zimbabwean identity.
- Indigenous religion fosters a spirit of *Unhu* or *ubuntu* through helping one another and sharing with the needy.
- National and local events bring about national identity for Zimbabweans through active participation and involvement.
- Inter-dependency among families differ from one religion to the other.
- Jews were taught from the period of Adam and his helper, Eve, to learn to depend on each other.
- The Passover ceremony is clear testimony of the idea of inter-dependency among Jewish families.
- Christianity encourages the idea of inter-dependency among families through giving and sharing.
- The Imam emphasises the need to support one's immediate family as an obligation.
- Islamic expectations include doing well to relatives, believers and emancipation of slaves.
- The basic principle of *Unhu, Ubuntu* or *Vumunhu* is, "I am because we are."
- The elderly people are there to provide spiritual guidance to the young in Indigenous religion.
- Social responsibility shapes our identity as Zimbabweans.

Glossary of terms

Commemoration	– something that is done to remember officially and give respect to a great person or event.
Exodus	– the departure of the Israelites from Egypt to the Promised Land.
Fellowship	– friendly association, especially with people who share one's interests.
Manna	– an edible substance which god provided the Israelites during the Exodus.
Marginalised	– people who are relegated to the lowest status in society.
Miracle	– an event not explicable by natural or scientific laws, but by the power of God.
Testimony	– a declaration of truth or fact.
Unhu, Ubuntu or Vumunhu	– behaviour patterns that are acceptable to all.
Wilderness	– wild landscape which is uninhabited by humans.

Revision Exercises

Structured Questions

1. Families depend on each other in society.

- (a) What is a family? [2]
- (b) Mention any four characteristic features of a family. [4]
- (c) Explain three characteristics of a family. [6]
- (d) Describe four types of families. [8]

2. Indigenous religion is closely linked to the Zimbabwean identity.

- (a) Define Zimbabwean identity. [2]
- (b) Identify any four national events that foster Zimbabwean identity. [4]
- (c) Explain three of such events. [6]
- (d) Describe the significance of four national events that foster the Zimbabwean identity. [8]

3. Hospitality is a component of Zimbabwean identity.

- (a) What is hospitality? [2]
- (b) Mention any four forms of hospitality in Zimbabwe. [4]
- (c) Explain three forms of hospitality in Zimbabwe. [6]
- (d) Examine four benefits of showing hospitality as Zimbabweans. [8]

4. Respect for the elderly is a virtue in Zimbabwean identity.

- (a) What is a virtue? [2]
- (b) State four ways of showing respect to the elderly in society. [4]
- (c) Explain three ways of showing respect to elders in society. [6]
- (d) Demonstrate four significance of showing respect to the elderly in society. [8]

5. There are a number of aspects in Indigenous religion which bring out Zimbabwean identity.

- (a) Define Indigenous religion. [2]
- (b) Name four aspects of Indigenous religion which bring out the Zimbabwean identity. [4]
- (c) Explain three aspects of Indigenous religion that bring out Zimbabwean identity. [6]
- (d) Show the significance of four aspects that bring out the Zimbabwean identity in Indigenous religion. [8]

Essay Questions

- 1. Explain the role of Indigenous religion in fostering African identity? [25]
- 2. Describe any five aspects of Indigenous religion that help bring out the Zimbabwean identity. [25]
- 3. Discuss various ways in which families depend on each other in Christianity. [25]
- 4. Write explanatory notes on how proverbs encourage family interdependency in Zimbabwe. [25]
- 5. Explain how Indigenous religion promotes inter-dependency among families in Zimbabwe. [25]

Chapter

7

RELIGION AND EDUCATION

Chapter objectives

By the end of this chapter, you should be able to:

- assess the positive and negative impact of religion in formal education.
- demonstrate the role of Indigenous religion in informal education.

Introduction

There are many types of education. There is formal and informal education. Advantages and disadvantages of both formal and informal education have been noted. Many religious factors affect formal and informal education. Indigenous religion plays a pivotal role in promoting informal education among people. This chapter focuses on the positive and negative impact of religion in formal education as well as demonstrating the role of Indigenous religion in informal education.

UNIT 7. 1 RELIGION IN FORMAL EDUCATION

Formal education refers to a systematic, organised education model which is structured and administered according to a given set of laws and norms, presenting a rather rigid curriculum with clear stipulated objectives, content and methodology. Education refers to the acquisition of knowledge and learning of skills. Education helps to shape beliefs and moral values. It can be the influence that is exercised by adults deliberately upon the young.

Education can lead to changes in human skills, lead to change in productivity and social mobility to a considerable extent. It can also be defined as the process of teaching somebody especially in a school, college, or university. In other words, it is the knowledge, skills and understanding that one gets from attending a school or college. Education can change through time. There are many types of education such as formal and non-formal education.

Positive impact of religion on formal education

- Many schools and universities have been built by different religions and bringing education to the people. There are many missionary schools in Zimbabwe like Mukaro Mission which is a Roman Catholic School.
- Familiarisation of world religions has been witnessed in the country. The new curriculum of Zimbabwean schools now teaches Islam, Christianity, Indigenous religion and Judaism.
- This has led to tolerance and acceptance of people with different religious beliefs.
- Religion generally provides counselling and this has helped learners with stress and depression management skills.

- Religiously, bad deeds are viewed as sins and learners avoid them thereby creating a crimeless society.
- Religion has reduced religiously motivated hate crimes. It has been noted that parents whose children attended worship at least weekly were less likely to be contacted by their children's school about behaviour problems than parents whose children worshipped less frequently. Religious practice is a positive force for staying on track in school.
- Religion also promotes social responsibility for example Islam through almsgiving (*Zakat*).
- The greater the parents' religious involvement, the more likely they would have higher educational expectations for their children and communicate with their children about their education.
- Youth participation in religious activities promotes friendships that aid and encourage academic achievement and engagement.
- Structured and well organised after school activities, including religious activities, are also associated with better educational outcomes. Extra-curricular church activities help youths reduce those problem behaviours that put their academic attainment at risk.
- Religiously involved students spend most of their time doing homework, work harder in school and achieve better results. Research done has proved that those who attended religious services do much better in their studies.
- Frequent religious attendance correlates with lower dropout rates and greater school attachment.

Negative effects of religion on formal education

- Causes cultural changes amongst learners. For example, children may end up changing their culture of respecting family members by adopting religious parents like in Christianity where a spiritual father is found.
- Some religions are labelled as evil for example Christians label Indigenous religion as demon worship. This is a negative impact of religion in formal education.
- Labelling believers is noted as some believers are labelled as sinners if they commit sins. This is common in Christianity where there is a lot of stigma on people who are non-believers.
- Some schools are single religion schools and learners end up not having a chance to interact with others from other religions and they end up being monomaniacs or fundamentalists.
- Some students are judged for being different.
- When a student's religion is not shared by the majority of the people at school some religious rights of such students would be violated.

Activity 7.1 Debate

Debate on the topic, "Informal education is better than formal education". Choose one speaker to support this view and one to oppose it.

Activity 7.2 Group discussion

Discuss how informal education has been eroded by modern formal education.

Activity 7.3 Drama

Perform a short play about informal education and values and morals that are instilled amongst the young.

Exercise 7.1

- | | |
|--|-----|
| (a) What is formal education? | [2] |
| (b) List any four characteristics of formal education. | [4] |
| (c) Describe the role of religion in formal education. | [6] |

UNIT 7.2 INDIGENOUS RELIGION IN INFORMAL EDUCATION

In Indigenous religion (IR) informal education has been the source of education to many communities before the advent of formal education in different societies. The child in IR was taught by the elders, they also learnt through experienced and interaction with others. All these for an African child provided the skills, values, attitudes and knowledge that was important in their day to day activities.

The major focus of IR was how an individual survived, that is to hunt, how a female was to behave in the society among other skills. The home in IR is where all the teachings came from. Good acceptable living standards were instilled from a tender age. All these encourages unity among members of a community. The concept of *Unhu*, *Ubuntu* or *Vumunhu* are taught and elaborated in informal education.

Role of Indigenous religion in informal education

Indigenous religion helped in informal education by teaching survival skills through experiences and the young are taught how to adapt to the environment by finding out means of surviving on their own. For example, a young boy is taught fishing by actually participating in fishing by the elders.

- In informal education, IR encouraged children to learn what they lived. For example, a young girl was to learn motherly duties like cooking by observing as well as being taught by the mother.
- In informal education, Indigenous religion encourages togetherness and unity among people.
- It inculcated good morals, these include respecting the elders.
- IR encouraged corporation rather than competition. For example, children's games like *chamuhwande muhwande* (hide and seek game) encourage teamwork and cooperation as children search for each other.
- In IR education was based on the values that reflected the community's aims and objectives. These values include, harmony, generosity, respect for older persons, human life, these values are inseparable.

Activity 7.7 Role play

Divide yourselves into groups of six and come up with some teachings from informal education. Now role play these responsibilities in groups.

Activity 7.8 Research assignment

Find out how students learn their Unhu, Ubuntu or Vumunhu in formal education.

Exercise 7.2

1. Describe the role of the family in informal education in Indigenous religion.

[25]

Interesting facts

1. Informal education existed long before the coming of formal education by the missionaries. The teachers of informal education are not trained; they use experience to teach their learners. There are negative effects of religion on education.

Summary of the chapter

- There are many types of education, they also include formal and informal education.
- Formal education is expensive as fees are paid, and the teachers have formal training.
- There are many formal schools in Zimbabwe.
- Informal education is learnt out of school, the teachers have no formal training.
- Learners are usually taught survival skills and also upholding of *Unhu/Ubuntu/Vumunhu*.
- There are positive effects of religion on education.
- There are also negative effects of religion on education in our society.
- Religion in education can encourage tolerance and acceptance of others.
- Religion has found its way in the school curriculum.
- Religion has helped in the development of the Zimbabwean society.

Glossary of terms

Curriculum	– the set of courses, coursework, and their content, offered at a school
Deed	– an action or act, something that is done.
Education	– refers to the acquisition of knowledge and learning of skills.
Formal education	– classroom based education provided by trained teachers.
Informal education	– education that occurs outside of a structured curriculum.
Monomaniac	– a person who is obsessed with a single thing excluding other concerns.
Myth	– a sacred narrative regarding a hero the origin of the world or of a people, it can also be a story regarding some fact.
Taboo	– an inhibition or ban that results from social custom, excluded or forbidden from use, approach or mention.
Tolerance	– an acceptance or patience with the beliefs, opinions or practices of others.

Revision Exercises

Structured Questions

1. Religion and education cannot be separated.

- (a) Define the term education. [2]
- (b) List **four** characteristics of formal education. [4]
- (c) Explain the roles of religion in informal education. [6]
- (d) Describe how religion has helped in the development of informal education in your society. [8]

2. Formal education is expensive.

- (a) Define formal education. [2]
- (b) List **four** disadvantages of formal education. [4]
- (c) Explain the positive impact of religion on formal education. [6]
- (d) Describe how religion has promoted formal education in Zimbabwe. [8]

3. Informal education is important.

- (a) Define informal education. [2]
- (b) List **four** characteristics of formal education. [4]

- (c) Give the advantages of informal education. [6]
(c) Distinguish informal education from formal education. [8]

4. There are many types of education.

- (a) Give any **two** types of education. [2]
(b) Define the **two** types of education given above. [4]
(c) Give any **three** characteristics of the types you have given above. [6]
(d) Explain how education has helped your society. [8]

5. Indigenous religion has helped in the development of education.

- (a) Define Indigenous religion. [2]
(b) List **four** ways of teaching in Indigenous religion. [4]
(c) Explain how education has helped in the promotion of Unhu or Ubuntu in your society. [6]
(d) How has education been promoted and encouraged in your society? [8]

Essay Questions

6. Discuss the relationship between Indigenous religion and informal education. [25]
7. Discuss the ways in which the students learn in informal education in Zimbabwe. [25]
8. Describe the role of Indigenous religion on informal education. [25]
9. Explain the negative effects of religion on education? [25]

Chapter

8

RELIGION AND GENDER ROLES

Chapter objectives

By the end of this chapter, you should be able to:

- identify what various religions say on gender roles.
- explain gender roles in the above religions.
- demonstrate how religion enhances women empowerment.

Introduction

Both men and women are created in the image of God giving them an equal importance. They are different characteristics that define a person as masculine or feminine. Duties and activities of males and females are shaped by society. Different religions have different perspectives on gender roles. There are many types of women empowerment programmes, which include social, legal, educational, economic and political empowerment. Various religions have enhanced women by giving scholarships to girls and women, giving them financial support to start small and medium enterprises and holding women empowerment campaigns.

UNIT 8.1 GENDER IN VARIOUS RELIGIONS

1. Indigenous religion

In African societies, men and women have specific roles defined by the society and in accordance with Indigenous religion.

Gender roles for women in Indigenous Religion

(a) Household duties

African women do household chores such as cooking, sweeping, fetching firewood and water.

(b) Child bearing and nurturing

Women are responsible for bringing up children in the right path. It is them who spend most of the time with children who will in turn become closer to them. A mother's influence dominates in the house and it is believed that good children reflect a good mother. Mothers teach their children values and ethics.



Fig. 8.1 A woman sweeping the yard

(c) Preserving culture

Aunties preserve culture of respect, honour and dignity through educating girls. It is the duty of women to shape the future of girls according to community's expectations. Women such as aunties educate girls on their future roles.

(d) Religious roles

Some women are religious practitioners such as medicine women, spirit mediums, diviners and traditionalists. Holding such roles, they have a special role in people's lives as they are in connection with the ancestral world. These women relay messages from the other world and are highly respected in the community. Women who are traditionalists play the role of counsellors, judges, advisors, fortune-tellers and revealers of secrets. As ancestors, women are responsible for fertility, good health and protection of the living.



Fig. 8.2 Mbuya Nehanda the spirit medium

(e) Source of wealth

Women are a source of wealth through dowry (*lobola* or *roora*). Women acquire property and gain income through craftwork like basketry, pottery, weaving and farming.

(f) Being submissive

Women are to be subject to their husbands. They depend on males and cannot make decisions without consulting their husbands.

(g) Ritual specialists

Women play important roles in personal rituals associated with birth, puberty and death. At childbirth, women express gratitude to God with prayers and sacrifices and at death they sing dirges to express their sorrow. Being ritual specialists, they are upholders of community norms and traditions. Some women are rain messengers and it is believed women have a special power to bring rain by appeasing the goddess of rain and fertility. Their duties include making sacrifices, offering prayers and conducting private and public rites and ceremonies.

(h) Musical role

A lot of festivals abound in Indigenous religion and there is singing and dancing by well-dressed women during festivals. Some of these festivals are in honour of the most important divinities and ancestors. Women also sing songs during various rituals and ceremonies.

Gender roles of men in Indigenous religion

(a) Decision makers

Men are decision makers; it is their sole responsibility to make all decisions for the good of the family.



Fig. 8.3 Xangani women dancing at a festival

(b) Providers

Men are to love and take good care of their wives. It is their duty to provide food, shelter and clothing to his family. Women are dependent on males.

(c) Head of the family

As the head of the family, a father has a say in everything that happens at his home. He solves problems that arise in the family. He has full control of his homestead.

(d) Ritual specialists

As religious practitioners they conduct ceremonies and rituals. Priesthood is a highly respected office in African societies. Priests give advice and perform judicial and political functions in addition to caring for the temples and shrines to which they are attached. They also intermediate between people and the spirit world.

(e) Traditional doctors

With their expertise as traditional doctors, they symbolise the hopes of their society such as good health, protection and security from evil forces. They cure disease which cannot be cured in the modern hospitals.

(f) Mediums and diviners

As mediums and diviners, they relay messages from the other world and also reveal the secrets of the past, present and the future when they are possessed by their deities. People consult them on private matters and when having a national crisis.



Fig. 8.4 Traditional doctor performing some rituals

- They consult the ancestral spirits for protection of the family and society.
- Indigenous religion believes in life after death and deceased men become ancestors who will protect and guide the living. As ancestors they intermediate between the people and the Supreme Being. They fight evil spirits and drive them away from their family descendants where they once belonged.
- Most leadership positions such as chieftainship and headmen are for men. They have a duty to protect morals and values in Indigenous religion. Through prohibitions on sacred places they do not only conserve the environment but they safeguard the sacred places preserving African culture.
- It is men who pay lobola to bring spiritual union between families of the bride and the groom.

2. Judaism

Judaism has always maintained that God has both masculine and feminine qualities. Women's obligations and responsibilities are different from men but not less important.

Gender roles for women in Judaism

(a) Household keepers

A woman is to be a wife, mother and keeper of the household. It is her who determines the character and atmosphere of the entire home. Her role is to make a home God's sanctuary.

(b) Child nurturing

Women are responsible for nurturing a sense of Jewishness in young children and for the infusion of a Jewish atmosphere and peace into the home.

(c) Spiritual influence over her family

It is the duty of a woman to make the Torah and Jewish traditions a source and guide of her children's lives. She should see to it that rituals and ceremonies are observed. It is her role to preserve Jewish identity and values in her family.



Fig. 8.6 Jewish women reading scripture

(d) Participating in religious activities

Women voluntarily recite certain prayers in the synagogues and voluntarily read the Torah. Traditionally, women are to light Sabbath candles, to separate a portion of the dough when baking the Sabbath loaf and to observe the laws of menstrual or family purity that regulate physical contact between husbands and wives. During biblical times women held important positions such as judges and prophetess. Judges 4:4, Deborah was a judge.

Gender roles for men in Judaism

(a) Bread winners

Men work to provide for the family.

(b) Religious duties

Men hold leadership positions such as being priests and rabbis. As priests they take lead in sacrifices and burnt offerings. Rabbis teach in the synagogue and are consulted on Jewish laws. It is also their role to teach the Torah.

(c) Men lead rituals

This is often commemorated by having the new adults, male only in the Orthodox tradition, lead the congregation in prayer and publicly read a portion of the Torah. They participated in wars to defend the Ark of the Covenant during biblical times. As Levites, in the temple they sang Psalms, assisted the priests and sometimes interpreted the law and Temple ritual to the public.

3. Christianity

Christians believe that both men and women were created in the image of God and this gives them an equal importance. However, men and women are created with different roles in society and in the church.

Gender roles for women in Christianity

(a) Child bearing and nurturing

1 Timothy 2:15 women are to give birth safely if they have faith and love. Women are responsible of bringing up children in a Christian way. They are responsible for the well-being of the family.

(b) Being submissive

Ephesians 5:22 says that women are to submit to their husbands. They are to live under the authority of their husbands. Women must respect men.

(c) Housekeepers

Women are to work in their houses taking care of the household chores. They are household keepers (1 Timothy 5:14). They are managers of the household. The home and children is to be a woman's priority.

(d) To be loving

Women are to love their husbands and children (Titus 2:4).

(e) Fellow workers in church

Women are to use their talents in the Lord's service. Romans 16:2 Phoebe was a deaconess and this role is witnessed in different churches today. Priscilla was a fellow worker in Christ as Paul pointed out in Romans 16:3. Women today teach Sunday school, direct choirs, assist pastors and elders in calling on the sick and also assist in works of charity in the congregation and community. The Seventh Day Adventist has a Women's Ministries department in which women evangelise and do a lot of charity work in communities.

(f) Marital role

A woman must live together with her husband in order to fulfil the purpose of life (Galatians 3:28).

(g) Leadership role

Women today in churches have leadership roles, for instance ZAOGA ordain women as elders. The Family of God Church have female pastors. Women are also prophetesses in some churches like the white garment churches.

Gender roles for men in Christianity

(a) To be good husbands

A man should love his wife and not to be bitter to his wife (Colossians 3:19). This is one of the most important roles of a Christian man.

(b) Head of the family

As a head of the family he makes decisions and has authority (1 Corinthians 11:3). The headship of man in his role of leadership to which the woman is subordinate is therefore God's arrangement for good order.

(c) Bread winners

It is the duty of the man to provide for his family's welfare. Women depend on men.

(d) Disciplining of children

Fathers are to instil discipline in children who are in turn to listen to their parents.

(e) Leading the church

Leadership of the church is ascribed to men in the Bible. The pastoral office has been restricted to men (1 Timothy 2:11-14 and 1 Corinthians 14:34ff). Men are to be deacons in church (Acts 6:2-6) men of good repute, full of wisdom and spirit. They are also elders who teach, preach and instruct on doctrines (Titus 1:5-6). Men are bishops in churches.

4. Islam

According to the Quran, men and women are spiritually equal. Gender roles manifest themselves partially because men and women are sometimes allotted different rights and different cultural expectations.

Gender roles for women in Islam

(a) Social role

- Women are great mothers, obedient daughters, caring wives and equal sisters.
- As a mother she raises children and has control over her children four times more compared to a father. She is a domestic provider that supplies a nurturing environment of unconditional love and devotion.
- A girl child is to be equally educated as a boy child.
- Women are caretakers of men the same way as men are the caretakers of women. Wives are to love and take good care of their husbands for a healthy relationship.



Fig. 8.7 A Muslim mother nurturing the child

(b) Religious role

- Among the Muslims, women are to be virtuous and pious. Muslim women must be righteous and pious out of the fear of God as is a Muslim man.
- Women have to play their role in achieving piety and virtuousness in society and propagate it to others as well.
- Some Islamic communities have appointed women as imams normally with ministries restricted to leading women in prayer and other charitable ministries.



Fig. 8.8 Muslim women praying

(c) Matrimonial role

- A woman has an equal stake in the matrimonial relationship and has her say in matters of the relationship.
- A wife is to work towards the bettering of the matrimonial relationship.
- A woman is to carry her duties of a good wife and to raise the children with devotion and enthusiasm.
- Consent is to be sought from a woman before engaging her into marriage so that she can better play her role.

(d) Educational role

- The Muslim community encourages the role of women in Islam to be well educated and the Islamic world wants them to excel within their areas of interest and expertise.
- Both on academic level and within their culture, a Muslim woman is to educate herself because the Muslim community relies on the next generation to lead them.
- This role of women is considered as vital and honourable.

Gender roles for men in Islam

(a) Provides for the family

- The man provides shelter, food, clothing to the woman according to his capability.
- Men are the maintainers and protectors of women, they provide for women from their wealth.

(b) Guardian of the family

- It is because man's power of logic is stronger than women's that they are guardians of their families.
- A man is to support his family and prepare the grounds for their happiness.
- A guardian has responsibilities towards those under his guardianship which include taking care of his wife and her desires.
- Men are expected to be protectors and caretakers of the family.



Fig. 8.9 A Muslim preacher

(c) Raising the children

- It is the sole responsibility of a father to raise his children though the woman may end up shouldering more of the responsibility.
- It is an ethical, human and Islamic duty of both parents to properly bring up their children in order to raise good Muslims and family members.

(d) Head of the family

- The Quran gives the man superiority over the family structure in order to prevent dissension and friction between the spouses.

(e) Religious role

- Men are expected to offer the five daily prayers at the nearest mosque.
- Leadership roles in the mosque such as the imam are ascribed to men.
- As leaders in the mosque men have a duty to teach and interpret the Quran.

Activity 8.1 Group work

Discuss gender roles in any religion of your choice. List down your points on paper and read out to the class.

Activity 8.2 Research work

Research on the roles of women in Christianity giving examples from different churches where necessary. Write a paragraph on your findings.

Exercise 8.1

Indigenous religion is gender sensitive.

- (a) Define gender. [2]
- (b) State any four roles of women in Indigenous religion. [4]
- (c) Describe the political roles of women in Indigenous religion. [6]

UNIT 8.2 RELIGION AND WOMEN EMPOWERMENT

Almost all religions have empowered women at one point or the other. Women empowerment campaigns have been witnessed in Zimbabwe and the world at large.

Women empowerment

Women empowerment is a process in which women elaborate and recreate what they can be, do and accomplish in various religions. It can also mean to promote women participation in all areas and sectors to build stronger economies, improve quality of life and bring gender equality with equal amount of opportunities. Empowerment involves helping women to take their own decisions by breaking all their personal rules that the society and their family has created for them as well as making them independent in all aspects from thought, mind, decision, wealth and to bring equality in society. Women empowerment is also granting women the freedom to make life choices. There are many types of women empowerment that includes:

(a) Human rights or individual rights - in religions such as Judaism, Islam and Christianity, a woman should be able to express these rights freely, to have self-confidence and power to negotiate and decide.

(b) Social women empowerment – this is the promotion of gender equality. This has been seen in the education sector and various social programs where women's issues have been advanced.

(c) Educational empowerment – empowering women with knowledge, skills and self-confidence making women aware of their rights and having confidence to claim them. In Zimbabwe for example at the University of Zimbabwe's law school girls' cut off points is lower than that of boys and this empowers women.

(d) Economic and occupational empowerment – it means reducing women financial dependence on male counterparts be it father, brother, or husband. In Zimbabwe the Small and Medium Enterprise ministry support women by giving them loans for them to be economically empowered. The Women's Bank has also been established to help empower women. Another example is the churches in Zimbabwe like ZAOGA that encourage women to be entrepreneurs as a way of poverty alleviation.

How religion enhances women empowerment

Many religions have worked hard in trying to empower women. This has been witnessed across the board as women are seen having leadership roles in different religions, many religions are empowering women in different ways.

1. Indigenous religion

Historically, women were given a low status in society. Globalisation and changing of times have positively improved the status of women.

- Indigenous religion is now supporting the rights of women and even women candidates are now seen partaking in national elections.
- There are women who are seen as traditional healers. These women are economically empowered by their religion as they can now have a living out of IR.
- Some women are now inheriting their father's property after his death with some now running their fathers' farms and businesses and this being supported by IR so religion is now empowering women.
- Chiefs are now seen protecting the rights of women and restoring their dignity, chiefs are seen punishing men who take advantage of women by punishing them and even reporting them to law enforcing agents in cases where the rights of women have been violated.
- These leaders are also seen working tirelessly for the protection of girl children, they encourage education of women and protection of girls. At most gatherings chiefs are seen and heard

encouraging people to send their girl children to school and teaching the community the negative effects of marrying off young girls. They also are against the payment of avenging spirits using women and children, they encourage the payment to be done in form of cash or cattle not girls as they too support women empowerment.

All this shows the significant work that IR has done in the emancipation and empowerment of women.

1. Judaism

- Women can now worship together with men. In traditional Jewish religion men did not worship together with women, but there has been changes as men and women can now hold mixed prayers. For example, the Israeli government now allows mixed prayers in the Western wall that was only used by males.
- Women are now also found serving in religious councils and this was unheard of. B'nai Jeshurun became the first woman to sit in a Jewish synagogue board, all this point to women empowerment.
- Women became Rabbis. This was in 1972 and now there are hundreds of women rabbis and this shows that the Jewish religion enhancing women empowerment.
- There is also a number of Jewish women in parliament. A total of 30 women were sworn into Israeli parliament. This is a great achievement for the Jewish religion and that is enhancing the empowerment of women.
- It is now from the kitchen to the boardroom for Jewish women. Many women are now doing carriers that where dominated by males. Women are now in aviation, Smadar Schechter and Merav Schwartz became first Jewish female pilots.

2. Christianity

Christianity is working greatly to enhance the empowerment of women. A lot has been said and done in this regard.

- Leadership positions- many women are now found in many leadership positions. Some women are now pastors. These were male dominated positions and this shows that Christianity has enhanced the status of women.
- Most churches conduct business workshops and church conferences which seek to empower women.
- Most women have started successful business ventures as a result of being empowered by churches.
- Scholarships – Many scholarships have been availed for women. Christianity has made available education for women and girls. This has also been supported by the establishment of girls' schools. This enhances women empowerment, these schools include The Dominican Convent, Bonda among others.
- Preachers and prophets – many women now hold the prophetic office and some have become prophetesses. This all point to the point that there is women empowerment in Christianity.



Fig. 8.10 Apostle Eunah Guti of Zimbabwe Assemblies of God-Africa (ZAOGA)

4. Islam

Women are now being empowered in the Islamic religion. This has been done through a number of notable ways.

- Islamic women who do voluntary work are being acknowledged. In the past these women were

not seen as important people in the community but nowadays these volunteers are being given their significance. This does not only urge them to do more work but it also encourages others to do voluntary work and this has empowered women significantly in Islam. These women who do voluntary work also strive to enlighten their fellow women and this has been for the betterment of the lives of Muslim women.

- Doors have been opened for Islamic women to do jobs that had been mostly done by men for example in the aviation sector like being pilots and some are now working in the army. All this proves the steps that have been done by Islam to enhance women empowerment.
- The Islamic religion has offered so many women and girls scholarships and these have greatly helped in the economic empowerment of women. There are many Islamic schools that support the education of girl children for example Chinyika Primary School in Chitsa, Gutu in Masvingo. Girls are given free education and many have been successful in life because of these scholarships.
- The Islamic religion enhance women empowerment by recognising and validating the traditional women's roles in the society. Historically, the household duties of women were never acknowledged yet women do so much for the family. They do so much for free and Islam is now acknowledging those traditional roles like chores for the family upkeep. This helps so much in the empowerment of women, as women are seen as contributing to the development of the family and in turn development of the nation. By carrying out these duties women have benefited the Muslim families and Muslim communities.
- In Islam there is the Muslim women debate club. This is where women get together and discuss issues. Ideas are shared and this has greatly changed the lives of Muslim women. These clubs debate on many different religious issues and come up with better and applicable religious views for the Islamic women. Here women talk and deliberate on issues that concern and affect them.
- The Islamic religion also addresses the issues of domestic violence and family abuse. The teachings of the prophet Muhammad were also against abuse of women, this can even be seen where the prophet said that in case of polygamy the man was supposed to have only a maximum of four wives. This was to limit the abuse of women. The man was supposed to take these wives only if he could afford to look after the wives. This was a way of enhancing the status of women.

Activity 8.3 Class Presentations

Research on how different religions have enhanced women empowerment. Present your findings to the class.

Activity 8.4 Research work

Choose any religion that you have studied and find out in your community how that religion has improved the status of women.

Exercise 8.2

1. Using examples, describe how Christianity is empowering women in your society.

[15]

Interesting Facts

Gender is a social construct. Society develops gender roles assigned to males and females and how they should act according to sexes.

Summary of the chapter

- Different religions have different perspectives on gender roles.
- Christians believe that men and women are created in the image of God giving them an equal importance.
- In all religions a man is the head of the family and is to be respected.
- According to the Quran men and women are spiritually equal.
- The role of Jewish women is to make her home God's sanctuary.
- In Indigenous religion both men and women can be ancestors who intermediate between people and the Supreme Being.
- Women empowerment involves the upliftment of women in the society. Many religions have so far tried to enhance the empowerment of women. There are many types of women empowerment programmes like, economic, legal and social empowerment.

Glossary of terms

Campaign	– a planned set of activities that people carry out over a period of time.
Dirge	– songs performed as a memorial to a dead person.
Empowerment	– power given to someone to do something, process of gaining freedom.
Enhance	– improve the quality of something.
Feminine	– having qualities or an appearance traditionally associated with women.
Gender	– the state of being male or female in relation to the social and cultural roles.
Gender equality	– sexual equality or the state of equal ease of access to resources and opportunities.
Gender role	– duties and activities expected from a particular gender by the society.
Legislature	– a group of people in a country who have the power to make and pass laws.
Masculine	– possession of the qualities traditionally associated with men.
Submissive	– being obedient and passive.

Structured Questions

1. Society develops gender roles assigned to males and females.

- | | |
|---|-----|
| (a) What is gender? | [2] |
| (b) List four roles of women in Christianity. | [4] |
| (c) Explain any three of the roles you mentioned above. | [6] |
| (d) Discuss the importance of gender roles in your society. | [8] |

2. Women are to be submissive to their husbands.

- | | |
|---|-----|
| (a) Define submissiveness. | [2] |
| (b) State four roles of women in Indigenous religion. | [4] |
| (c) Explain any three roles of men in Indigenous religion. | [6] |
| (d) Suggest four ways gender roles benefit society in Zimbabwe. | [8] |

3. Women empowerment has been a topical issue nowadays in many religions.

- | | |
|--|-----|
| (a) Define women empowerment. | [2] |
| (b) List any four types of women empowerment. | [4] |

- (c) Explain the types mentioned above. [6]
(d) Discuss how different religions have enhanced the empowerment of women. [8]

4. Women have faced so many challenges in the past.

- (a) Define challenge. [2]
(b) List any **four** challenges women faced. [4]
(c) Explain the challenges above. [6]
(d) Discuss how religions have tried to solve these challenges. [8]

Essays

1. Discuss the roles of women in Christianity. [25]
2. Explain gender roles in Indigenous religion. [25]
3. Compare and contrast gender roles of men and women in Judaism. [25]
4. Describe the different types of empowerment that can benefit your society. [25]
5. How have religions helped in enhancing women empowerment in Zimbabwe. [25]

Chapter

9

RELIGION, ETHICS, HEALTH AND SEXUALITY

Chapter objectives

By the end of this chapter, you should be able to:

- discuss morals and values from Indigenous religion and how they shape Zimbabwean identity.
- explain how Indigenous religion beliefs help shape societal attitude on femininity and masculinity.
- assess the contributions of Indigenous religion to *Unhu/Ubuntu*.
- describe how religious beliefs influence people with chronic conditions.

Introduction

This chapter deals with religion, ethics, health and sexuality. Firstly, morals and values from Indigenous religion and how they shape Zimbabwean identity have been discussed. Secondly, the chapter explains how Indigenous religion beliefs help shape societal attitude on femininity and masculinity as well as assess the contributions of Indigenous religion to *Unhu* or *Ubuntu*. Lastly, it focuses on how religious beliefs influence people with chronic conditions.

UNIT 9.1 INDIGENOUS RELIGION AND UNHU/UBUNTU/VUMUNHU, VALUES AND SEXUALITY

Zimbabwean culture's uniqueness is because of its moral values which gives identity to its people. Such values are imparted from childhood by family members so as to bring up an individual with *unhu* or *ubuntu*. A cultured person is needed in every society to maintain peace and unity. No man lives in an island, what one does affect the whole world and through *Unhu* or *Ubuntu*, Zimbabwean culture shapes the behaviour of a person.

Indigenous religion as a source of morals and values in shaping Zimbabwean identity

Morality or morals is a word which can be defined as a set of social rules, principles, norms that guide or are intended to guide the conduct of people in a society, and beliefs about right and wrong conduct as well as good or bad character. Values are defined as important and lasting beliefs or ideals shared by the members of a culture about what is good or bad and desirable or undesirable. Values have a major influence on a person's behaviour and attitude and serve as broad guidelines in all situations.

Moral values mean the ideals that are central to our sense of being a good person. They are the worthy ideals or principles that one follows to distinguish the right from the wrong. These ideals or virtues are considered worthy in building up the character of an individual.

It is important for a child to have a sound base of strong moral values. The future of Zimbabwe depends upon the moral values imparted on a child. The family is a key social engine as it transfers the values of a community to the next generation.

Moral values refer to the good virtues such as honesty, integrity, truthfulness, compassion, helpfulness, love, respectfulness, hard work, justice, rights and responsibilities of both the individual and community. Morality entails the norms and values of any given society.

Values permeate every aspect of human life. They explain what is good or right and what is acceptable in society. Values occupy a central place in people's culture particularly indigenous people. The moral value of Zimbabwean culture is what gives it uniqueness and identity. Zimbabwean moral values hold people together and guarantee their continual existence.

In Zimbabwe, Indigenous religion is the source and foundation of morality. Moral values are entwined with culture which is greatly related to spiritual beliefs. Indigenous religion teaches how to behave and act. It provides a framework within which people can learn the difference between right and wrong shaping the behaviour of a person. In Indigenous religion, the following are some of the values cherished:

- respect:
- love
- honesty
- courtesy
- cooperation
- integrity
- loyalty
- chastity
- hospitality
- unity and solidarity
- tolerance and perseverance

Through such values Indigenous religion helps to shape an individual's identity. Indigenous religion even provides different ways of dealing with moral dilemmas. For example, on murder the guilty family has to pay a compensating fine to avoid avenging spirits.

Sources of *unhu* and their impact on Zimbabwean identity

In Indigenous religion institutions have risen as sources of morals and values as well as safeguarding the life of an individual and the community in which he or she lives. These are:

(a) Marriage

Marriage is considered as the most sacred institution in any society. It is a pillar on which every society gain support. Certain values need to be adhered to and practised so as to have a successful relationship. Such values include honesty, equality, commitment, respect, understanding, discipline and faithfulness. Sharing such moral values is a framework of a healthy marriage which is acceptable in society. Zimbabwean identity is marked by honest, complementarity, equality, respect and faithfulness which are attributes of *unhu* or *ubuntu* derived from marriage. For example, marriage teaches the men and women in marriage to be responsible by providing for the family. Most women work mainly during the rainy season in agricultural production while their male counterparts work in towns and abroad to fend for the family. So, marriage is a source of morals and values which shapes Zimbabwean identity.

(b) Family

The first social relationships are formed in a family. It is the family that shapes a person for it is the foundation of a society. Traditional values of hospitality and social cohesion are manifested in the collective efforts of the family. Children are taught values, ethics, trained on what is right and wrong and how to interact with people. The family shapes Zimbabwean identity through morals and values instilled into Zimbabwean citizens. The young people who have a true mark of Zimbabwean identity respect elders and every elder is treated as a parent. This comes from the family which socialises children that all elders are parents and deserve respect.

(c) Community

The community is the guardian of the individual. Indigenous religion stresses community life and communalism as a living principle of which the fundamental ideology is community identity. The community shapes the behaviour of a person. Good behaviour reflects that the person is coming from a good society. Zimbabwean identity is marked by communalism, a person belongs to the community. There is no individualism among indigenous people in Zimbabwe. No one is treated as the other because of communalism.

People are identified as one at family, community and national level. This is the reason why when one commits a crime is regarded as dangerous to the whole community. Furthermore, because of communalism Zimbabweans have an identity of helping one another in times of happiness and distress. Social gatherings like weddings, funerals and family rituals show the identity of Zimbabweans as one. People unite for one common purpose which makes tasks in the community to be accomplished easily.

(d) Chieftainship

Chieftainship is at the core of our being as an African society. This is so because chiefs play an important role in defining and keeping the people together. They are stewards of the morals and values in Indigenous religion. In other words, they give an identity to a society they are representing. Chiefs are vanguards of cultural values. They have a duty to protect and uphold the country's cultural values. When moral values are not upheld, chiefs intervene to redress the situation either through punishment or paying a fine. Their duty is to curb moral decadence in the society.

Chiefs are religious practitioners in Indigenous religion and they are reservoirs of morals and values that shape Zimbabwean identity. For example, Zimbabweans are identified with good sexual conduct and chiefs as sources of morals and values who punish people who commit sexual offences like bestiality, incest and adultery which are all regarded as taboos in Zimbabwean society. It is because of this reason that chieftainship are a source of morals and values. Chiefs should be the yardstick of morality in the community and morality is what identifies Zimbabweans.

***Unhu or Ubuntu* in Indigenous religion**

Unhu is a way of life which is linked to religion. It embodies all virtues that maintain harmony and the spirit of sharing among members of society. Indigenous religion beliefs show that an individual's actions today are a reflection on the past and will have far reaching consequences for the future. One qualifies to be an ancestor if he has lived a respectable life on earth. Only those who die having upheld the concept of *ubuntu* will join the ancestral world. What an individual does affects the whole family. If one commits murder, the spirit of the murdered victim will return and haunt the clan of the murderer. So, to safe guard the future generation not to have miserable lives it is important for a person to always think of others before one act. Those who uphold the principle of *ubuntu* throughout their lives will in death achieve unity with those living. *Ubuntu* has to be displayed at all times in all circumstances and the idea of ethics.

In Zimbabwe, *ubuntu* maintains peace and harmony in a nation. People know what is good and evil, right and wrong. A violation of morals and values is an offense against all these individuals. Moral and values helps to keep society alive and in harmony with *unhu* or *ubuntu*. *Unhu* is the essence of the African moral system and it's a concept which focuses on the character-based ethics. In Indigenous religion, one has to adhere to values and principles in indigenous society. Some of the aspects of *Unhu* emphasised in Indigenous religion are:

1. Universal human brotherhood (or unity)

The African man is first and foremost a member of his family, the extended family, the community and his

society in that order before being an individual. The African man has a social and communal nature which is based on unity. The African culture can complement the Western culture by integrating individualism with the communal nature of life.

2. Hospitality

At all times, there is always unprompted welcome and accommodation to unfamiliar persons and visitors. Africans effortlessly welcome strangers and offer them where to sleep as well as giving them food.

3. Compassion

An African is supposed to exhibit compassion to the others. This is the reason why there is either extended family system or individualism.

4. Generosity

Unhu entails that one should express sheer generosity to the needy in society. It is because of the attribute of *unhu* that helps in inculcating the belief that we are all human.

5. Fairness

It is a negation of *unhu* to take sides when dealing with others. Fairness involve impartial and just treatment of others. *Unhu* entails that there should be impartiality and equal treatment of others. Every member of society is important and favouritism should be avoided as it is against the spirit of *unhu*.

6. Justice

Unhu means that one has to be just in executing judgements. Every person with *unhu* upholds the spirit of justice. Oppression of the others and social injustice is against the spirit of *unhu* or *ubuntu*.

7. Truth

Lying is against the spirit of *unhu* or *ubuntu*. Truth helps in solving problems of the family, society and nation at large. It is an important attribute of *unhu* necessary for peace and stability of the society.

8. Respect

Unhu or *ubuntu* is exhibited by regarding others with high esteem. Respect involves honouring someone by showing care, concern and consideration of their feelings and needs. It is because of this reason that elders should be respected at all times. For example, the young should show respect and avoid insulting elders and make them feel comfortable especially when they are travelling in a bus. The young should make way for the elders to sit first.

9. Integrity

Integrity is the quality of being honest and having strong moral principles. A person is said to have *unhu* or *ubuntu* when he or she is honest and has good moral principles and values. It is an attribute of *unhu* which reduces promiscuity, corruption and greediness in society.

Religion, femininity and masculinity

Femininity is a characteristic of acting in a female way while masculinity is a characteristic of acting in a male way. Masculinity and femininity are social constructs because women and men are expected to act in a certain way for him and her to be regarded as a man and woman respectively. In simple terms, masculinity is having qualities traditionally associated with men whereas femininity is having qualities or an appearance traditionally associated with women for example prettiness and delicacy. Therefore, society often prescribes that a man is what a woman is not. The other definition of masculinity is those behaviours, languages and practices, existing in specific cultural and organisational locations, which are commonly associated with

males and culturally defined as not feminine.

Religion plays a major role in shaping the expected characteristics of men and women. In many instances, it is religion that shapes the names given to men and women at birth. Also, in many African contexts, it is religion that outlines what a “real man” is supposed to be, spells out his qualities and outlines his roles in the home, in the community, in religion and in the nation. Indigenous religion plays a major role in shaping what a man and woman is in society.

Religion influences and reinforces both positive and negative attitudes, behaviours and practices of men and women in terms of perception on femininity and masculinity. There is a close connection between religion, femininity and masculinity because religion plays a major role in defining the roles and responsibilities of men and women. Religion plays a major role in shaping the roles of men and women in society hence influencing femininity and masculinity. Indigenous religion has influenced or shaped femininity and masculinity because men are regarded as superior in physical strength, firmness, fearlessness, decisiveness, ability to protect the weak, principled, controlling, conquering, risking, leading, being assertive and to enjoy a high social status. Masculinity is also associated with intelligence, bravery, sobriety, unemotionality, and an absence of smiles. On the contrary, femininity is the opposite of this. Femininity and masculinity are not natural attributes but rather social constructions.

- Men are powerful and women are weak. Indigenous religion believes that men are powerful. Men are associated with “strength, vigour, being powerful, courage, self-confidence and the ability to meet the outside world. This is the reason why in indigenous society a man is supposed to do all the work which requires strength like digging, hoeing and lifting heavy things while women are expected to perform household chores which are lighter like sweeping, cleaning and washing. Women played an important role in agriculture and are confined at home because Indigenous religion believes that *Musha mukadzi* meaning a home is best when there is a woman.
- On the contrary, it is a taboo for men to wash, cook and sweep in indigenous society while women who do men’s work are regarded as having a spirit of a man “*shavi rechirume*”. Furthermore, Indigenous religion regard women as lacking courage hence they cannot kill a snake when it invades the homestead. It is regarded as a duty of men hence men are seen as courageous, they defend the family because of their ability of being strong and powerful. It is religion that outlines what a “real man” is supposed to be, spells out his attributes and roles in the home, community, religion and the nation at large.
- Myths in Indigenous religion shape society’s attitude on femininity and masculinity. For example, Indigenous religion through the Mwedzi myth explains that men should have more than one sexual partner. This has shaped men to regard polygamy as good for men while it is a taboo for a woman to have several husbands.
- Leading is a masculinity attribute while subordination is a feminine attribute which has been influenced by religion. Religion has helped in the construction of men as leaders and this has led to the subordination of women in different social and political contexts in indigenous societies. Chiefs, Headman and village heads are men in indigenous communities. The right to leadership is limited to men and women are denied leadership roles because of religion. Indigenous religion believes that leading is an attribute of men and women are subordinate beings.
- Religion has also shaped femininity and masculinity by justifying gender-based violence against women and women are supposed to accept gender-based violence. Women in marriage are made to accept being disciplined by men because of religion while men believe that masculinity involve physical violence against women. It is unfeminine to report a man for domestic violence and women suffer in silence because of femininity. Masculinity relies on religion in supporting violence against women and femininity relies on religion to be submissive and receptive of violence against them.
- Religions socialise men to fulfil the role of fathers. In Indigenous religion they believe that men are

the head of the family. It is vital to observe that the fatherhood role involve physical fatherhood and social fatherhood where a man can mentor the young men. Therefore, religion shapes the belief that men are fathers and women are mothers. In Christianity the same concept is expressed in 1 Corinthians 7:39 which says that, *"A wife is bound to her husband as long as he lives."* This explains the role of men as heads of families and fathers.

- Marriage is also another social institution which has been influenced or shaped by religious teaching and practices in terms of femininity and masculinity. Religion believes that marriage is the solution to sexual immorality. Firstly, Indigenous religion advocates that one should marry a wife to enjoy sexual pleasures and if one is not satisfied with one wife, he can have several wives. Furthermore, the proverbs which state that a man is a bull shapes masculinity in the sense that men are portrayed as sexually strong and women are there to quench the sexual pleasures of men. Women are therefore influenced to accept men when they have several sexual partners. A man in indigenous society is regarded as a real man by having many wives. Sex defines masculinity in Indigenous religion and it is defined not only by having sex but by having many sexual partners.
- In Indigenous religion, an unmarried man is not allowed to take part at the traditional court. This influences femininity and masculinity as women are portrayed as weak in terms of decision making while men are regarded as strong in terms of their decision making abilities.

1. The Indigenous religion

- Women are viewed as weak and are given light duties such as household duties. They are to cook and to bring up children. Their position is in the house, they are supposed to act as domestic workers.
- Women are docile, they are to be submissive to their husbands and to depend on males.
- Women are sexy and should always keep themselves attractive.
- Women should have a nurturing characteristic and it is the duty of a mother to nurture and care for her children. She should teach her children to respect, love as well as to do their duties.
- Women are emotional and this is the reason why at a funeral it is women who wail.
- Men are regarded as strong individuals and that is why they are given hard tasks. It is men who dig, clear fields and hunt.
- Men are breadwinners, it is their responsibility to provide for the family.
- Men are leaders they are believed to be the head of the family. They are decision makers.
- Men are believed to be independent. In a family they can even make decisions without consulting the wife who in turn is expected to support her husband.

2. Judaism

- Women are inferior to men (Genesis 2 vs 27). They depend on men economically.
- Women are homemakers. She is a keeper of the household and determines the character and atmosphere of the household and the future of the children.
- Women nurture their children in Jewish teachings and enforcing laws, rituals and ceremonies that preserve Jewish identity.
- Men are the head of the family and they make decisions and provide for the family.

3. Christianity

- Women are regarded as weaker vessels. They are to focus on the upbringing of children.
- Women are docile and submissive. They are under their husbands and are to depend on their husbands.
- Males are providers, they support their families through working.
- Men are leaders and the head of the family.

4. Islam

- Women are regarded as properties owned by men. They are considered inferior to men. They are considered to be the absolute property of males such as fathers, brothers and husbands. They depend on males financially.
- Women are submissive and sex objects. If a Muslim wife refuses the sexual advances of her husband, she is accursed for the night and her husband is not obliged to support her. Islam requires the Muslim woman to obey her husband.
- Women are deficient in gratitude and her character is likened to a crooked rib because she was created from a man's rib. Therefore, it is a great sacrifice and condescension on the man's part to share his life with the woman.
- Men are providers for women.
- Women in Islam can be beaten in the case of insubordination.

Activity 9.1 Group work

In groups, discuss on moral values you uphold in your community and how they are upheld. Present your findings to the class.

Activity 9.2 ICT skills

If you have access to the necessary equipment, each group is encouraged to make its presentation a Power Point making use of pictures or anything that makes your presentation interesting.

Exercise 9.1

Femininity is a social construction.

- | | |
|---|-----|
| (a) What is femininity? | [2] |
| (b) List any four feminine attributes in Indigenous religion. | [2] |
| (c) Describe how Indigenous religion shapes societal attitudes on femininity and masculinity. | [8] |

UNIT 9.2 RELIGIOUS BELIEFS, SEXUALITY AND BEHAVIOUR CHANGE

Definition of sexuality

Sexuality is defined as the way that an individual perceives him or herself as a sexual being as expressed through sexual attitudes and desires. It includes gender identity that is the core sense that one is a female or male and comes with its roles on how one should behave. Sexuality is a key aspect of being human and a core component of gender relations and individual identity that is experienced in thoughts, fantasies, desires, beliefs, attitudes, values, behaviours, practices, roles and relationships. It also includes sexual orientation that is heterosexual.

Religious beliefs and sexuality

Beliefs and attitudes about sexuality are not in-born things, but they are acquired as a person grows and matures. Sexuality involves the way that a person views himself or herself as a sexual being through sexual preferences and actions. Religion plays a large role in shaping attitudes about sexuality as some religions prescribe acceptable sexual behaviour. Traditionally, female sexuality has been narrowly defined either in only biological terms or in response to male sexuality.

Indigenous religion values *unhu* and as such some form of sexuality accepted in the Western world are not

accepted. It is an anathema for one to engage in lesbianism and homosexuality. As such, it is a taboo to be identified with the kind of sexuality that is not African. On the contrary heterosexual is the only acceptable form of sexuality. Indigenous religion believes that lesbianism and homosexuality are against the spirit of *unhu* or *ubuntu* and it angers ancestors and this can result in calamities such as drought, pestilence and famine. Judaism and Christianity connect female sexuality with sin. This emanates from the biblical teaching which traces that sin began with women and it resulted in the death penalty by God. Genesis 3 blamed Eve and gave her full responsibility for the introduction of sin into the world. This has affected the way female sexuality is perceived in Judaism and Christianity. It is clear that sexuality has been profoundly affected by the religion particularly female sexuality.

Furthermore, bisexual, asexual, lesbianism and homosexuality are all condemned by Christianity, Judaism and Islam. Religions condemn these forms of sexuality. This is because these forms of sexuality are against procreation and continuance of the human race. Sex is a sacred duty and is for marriage. Procreation is the sole purpose of sex. Premarital sex is forbidden. A young woman is to maintain her virginity for marriage. This is the reason why virginity tests are practised to maintain social norms regarding premarital sex. Sex only occurs in marriage. A young woman's virginity is an economically and socially valuable asset. It is accompanied by a token in form of a cow known as *mombe yechimanda*. If a woman was not found a virgin it brought shame to the family. The husband's family could even negotiate for a decrease on the bride price for she would have proved not to be a chastity wife. The girl would lose respect. Hence Indigenous religion plays a special role of reducing non-marital sex behaviours.

Activity 9.3 Role play

Enter into groups and demonstrate on gender roles in a family setup. Each member is to participate.

Exercise 9.2

Religion plays a large role in shaping attitudes about sexuality.

- | | |
|--|-----|
| (a) What is sexuality? | [2] |
| (b) List any four types of sexuality. | [4] |
| (c) Describe religious beliefs on sexuality. | [8] |

UNIT 9.3 RELIGIOUS BELIEFS AND CHRONIC CONDITIONS

Definition of chronic conditions

Chronic means a condition that is persistent and comes with time and generally lasts for more than three months. Religions have showed mixed feelings towards people with chronic conditions. Conditions with chronic illness due to diseases such as HIV and AIDS remain a challenge to treat and are associated with high health care. Examples of chronic conditions include; cancer, epilepsy, Blood Pressure, heartache, Arthritis, Diabetes, Asthma, HIV and AIDS among others.

An individual's religion may be one such factor that can influence the experience of chronic illness. The role of religious beliefs during critical illness cannot be underestimated as religion provide ways of coping with illness and in some cases, religion can be of no help to chronic conditions. This includes the following:

- lead to tolerance of the disease.
- enhance relaxation or reduces stress associated with illness.
- help to reduce the negative consequences of chronic health conditions through prayer.
- spiritual support is conveyed by care from congregations, religious counselling and forgiveness practices, and assistance from pastors and hospital chaplains.

Indigenous religion and chronic conditions

Causes of chronic conditions in Indigenous religion have a supernatural origin, they do not come naturally. Diseases are not just a physical condition; they are also a religious matter. Good health comes after one is spiritually upright as a means to please other mystical forces that may cause illness. Chronic conditions in Indigenous religion can be avoided by having a good relationship with spirits who control people's lives. Indigenous religion followers have different beliefs on people with chronic conditions. These are;

- Chronic conditions are caused by breaching natural laws. Restoration of this law through confession and performance of rituals and in most cases payment of fines will help to restore, maintain and correct human disorder.
- Failure to fulfil human obligations can result in chronic conditions.
- Human actions and activities that breach stipulated moral codes in society result in chronic conditions. For example, unfaithfulness in a marriage.
- Chronic conditions can be as a result of the disturbance in the relationship between man and his social environment or from forces directed by witches, wizards, sorcerers, evil spirits or angered ancestors because of infraction of totemic principles.
- People do not just suffer from chronic conditions by chance, it is believed to have its origin in a primary supernatural cause.
- If a person becomes ill with chronic conditions it implies that the spiritual world will have removed their protective powers as punishment. Corrective rituals should be carried out to appease these spirits to get the protection once again.
- Consulting a diviner for the cause of an illness is the beginning of a healing process and the restoration of health in an individual.

Judaism

- Chronic conditions are as a result of punishment for disobedience of God's command.
- Diseases are viewed as a result of sinful behaviour or ethical shortcomings.
- The wellbeing of an individual is a gift from God, so He is the one who cures and heals the sick.
- At times chronic conditions are viewed as a sign to test one's faith for example Exodus 4 vs 6-8
- Proper nutrition is viewed as primary for health. Certain prohibitions are given on diet and failure to abide by such laws could result in one suffering from chronic diseases.

Islam

- Chronic conditions can either be a blessing or curse among Muslims.
- As a blessing, falling ill might be Allah's blessing in disguise preventing one to pursue a dangerous path that can prove harmful to one's life.
- Muslims believe that Allah is just, therefore whatever situation a believer finds himself in, he knows there is goodness and wisdom embedded in it.
- Diseases may befall on an individual because of disobedience. Through this way it can be a punishment for disobedience.

Christianity

- Diseases are a result of an individual's sin or parent's sins. Chronic conditions come as punishment.
- As a way of testing one's faith, God might allow one to suffer from a disease. Despite the situation one finds himself or herself in, it should not shake one's faith. God alone has power to heal the sickness.
- The Second Advent will bring with it an end to diseases, so chronic conditions are temporary.

Positive influence of religious beliefs

- Religious beliefs enable followers to maintain a good relationship with the deities.
- Religious beliefs give an understanding as to the cause of the disease and seek assistance on the healing process.
- Religious beliefs provide with it solutions to chronic conditions.

Negative influence of religious beliefs

- Religious beliefs pave way for discrimination in society, for example if it is because of sin or disobedience.
- Some chronic conditions only require traditional herbs to cure and some might have no cure resulting in death.
- People might have mixed feelings on people with chronic conditions. Instead of showing sympathy others feel that justice was done on such people.
- Some African Initiated Churches forbid their members to visit clinics and hospitals for treatment of chronic illness thereby causing death of people and continuous spread of chronic diseases.

Interesting facts

1. Moral values distinguish the right from the wrong. They shape a good citizen and gives identity to an individual.
2. Sexuality in Zimbabwe is deeply embedded within its religious and traditional systems.
3. Through an individual's behaviour, people are able to judge the society from where a person is coming from.

Summary of the chapter

- This chapter has looked at moral values as extremely important in a human life for it gives identity to an individual, society and community. They define what is good, right and acceptable.
- Sexuality in Zimbabwe emphasises on heterosexuality. Premarital sex is forbidden. From childhood children are socialised according to the traditional female and male roles.
- *Unhu* or *Ubuntu* means personhood. A person does not exist in an island there is need for connection, community and mutual caring for all.
- Morals and values help to keep society alive and in harmony with *unhu* or *ubuntu*. *Unhu* or *ubuntu* covers topics such as truth, justice, beauty, dignity, love, respect and integrity.
- Institutions such as family, marriage, school and community are sources of morals and values. Masculinity and femininity are social constructs.
- A chronic condition according to Indigenous religion has its cause embedded in the removal of protective powers by ancestors.
- Religion has mixed feelings on people with chronic conditions. Chronic conditions are caused by different factors as viewed by different religions.
- Religious beliefs carry with it positive and negative influences on people with chronic conditions.

Glossary of terms

Bisexual	– sexually attracted to both men and women.
Chronic conditions	– it is a human health condition or disease that is persistent or otherwise long lasting in its effects or a disease that comes with time.
Feminine	– having qualities or an appearance traditionally associated with women.
Gender	– the state of being male or female.
Heterosexual	– sexual feeling or behaviour directed towards a person or persons of the opposite sex.

Homosexuality	– sexual attraction or the tendency to direct sexual desire toward another of the same sex.
Lesbianism	– the preference that a woman shows for sexual relationships with women.
Masculine	– possession of the qualities traditionally associated with men.
Moral values	– the standards of good and evil which govern an individual's behaviour and choices.
Unhu/Ubuntu	– it is a Nguni word meaning being human.

Revision Exercises

Structured Questions

1. Moral values have a major influence on a person's behaviour and attitude to life.

- (a) What is moral value? [2]
- (b) List six virtues in Indigenous religion. [6]
- (c) Explain the importance of moral values. [12]

2. The Shona people value traditional beliefs regarding sexuality.

- (a) What is sexuality? [2]
- (b) List types of sexuality. [4]
- (c) Explain the gender roles of the following members in a family:
 - (i) Mother.
 - (ii) Father.
 - (iii) Brother.
 - (iv) Sister. [12]

3. Unhu or ubuntu is the core of human values.

- (a) Define *ubuntu* or *unhu*. [2]
- (b) Identify ways which threaten *ubuntu*. [6]
- (c) Explain the importance of *unhu* or *ubuntu* in Indigenous religion. [12]

4. Diseases are not just a physical condition; they are also a religious matter.

- (a) What is a chronic condition? [2]
- (b) Give six examples of chronic conditions common in Indigenous religion. [4]
- (c) Describe indigenous religious beliefs on chronic conditions. [6]
- (d) What actions are taken in dealing with chronic conditions in your community? [8]

Essay Questions

1. Discuss how Indigenous religion's morals and values shape the Zimbabwean identity. [25]
2. Explain how Indigenous religion beliefs shape sexual views on sexuality. [25]
3. Discuss institutions that are sources of morals and values and how they shape Zimbabwean identity. [25]
4. Describe the contributions of Indigenous religion to *ubuntu* or *unhu*. [25]
5. Explain religious beliefs about chronic conditions. [25]

Chapter

10

RELIGION AND DISABILITY

Chapter objectives

By the end of this chapter, you should be able to:

- identify religious perceptions about disability.
- explain religious perceptions about disability.
- explain the severity of different types of disabilities.

Introduction

Cases of disability are a common feature among communities the world over. This chapter deals with disability from a religious perspective. The chapter looks at various forms of disabilities ranging from blindness to hearing impairments and others. The causes of disability in various religious traditions like Indigenous religion, Judaism, Christianity and Islam which view disability differently are going to be outlined. The thrust of the chapter is to identify and explain religious perceptions about disability. The chapter concludes by discussing how religions marginalise people living with disabilities as well as exploring the severity of cases of disability.

UNIT 10.1 RELIGION AND PERCEPTIONS ABOUT DISABILITY

Disability is an umbrella term, covering various forms of impairments or activity limitations and some restrictions in participating in some activities. Disability is an impairment that can be cognitive, it can be intellectual, physical, mental, visual, sensory or a combination of impairments. An impairment can occur in a person's body structure making it malfunction or dysfunctional and may leave the affected person disabled.

1. Visual challenges

Visual disability involves malfunction of the eyes leading to blindness. This can be complete or partial loss of vision but still affecting a person in many ways. Vision impairment can be mild or severe, depending on whether there is a vision decline in one or both eyes. Usually, it is very difficult to restore sight once vision is completely lost. Causes of blindness range from injuries, eye diseases, age related causes or having been bewitched in some religions, some believe that blindness is a curse from the ancestors.



Fig. 10.1 Visual impairment can be mild or severe

2. Hearing impairment

This refers to partial to permanent inability to hear sounds. Usually, persons affected by hearing challenges suffer from speech defects. Loss of hearing can occur in one or both ears. The affected person cannot hear and understand speech from other persons, neither can the deaf hear and interpret sounds. Hearing and speech defects can be mild to moderate and severe cases. Causes can be aging, regular exposure to very loud sounds, ear infection, earwax build-up or a ruptured eardrum. Some religions attribute deaf and dumb to effects of demons on a person.

3. Physical disability

The physically challenged have a limitation in movement or might be affected in terms of their stamina. This might be due to an amputation, muscular dystrophy, spinal injury, arthritis or other causes such as accidents, meningitis or any prolonged illness that can cause paralysis. The affected person may have challenges in walking (the lame), sitting or sleeping. A crippled person may find it hard to use hands, legs or some other body parts.



Fig. 10.2 Physical disability may result in challenges in walking

4. Mental disorder

This is a form of disability in which the affected person loses his or her mental faculties. The person suffers sudden and dramatic shift in mood and loses the ability to think clearly. There is a sudden and unusual change in behaviour. This condition may be mild, moderate to severe in some individuals. Most causes of the condition range from dementia, anxiety, head injuries or trauma.

Perceptions about disability in Indigenous religion

In Indigenous religion, disability is believed to be a curse from the ancestors. Believers consider any form of disability as punishment for disobedience or failure to follow orders from the ancestral world made through the spirit mediums. Some communities view disability in Indigenous religion as being caused by broken taboos, where the affected might have gone against activities that are forbidden or sacred. In some instances, some forms of disability affect persons who break oaths made with solemnity to the world of the spirits and the spirits affect them mentally. To some extent, the disabled in Indigenous religion are believed to have been bewitched, causing physical disabilities and even sterility. Disability is also viewed as something which happens as a result of incest in Indigenous religion.

In Indigenous religion, disability can be viewed in both positive and negative ways.

Positive perceptions about disability in Indigenous religion

- There is the belief that, because of their condition, the disabled are highly protected by the Supreme Being. Any form of exclusion will result in receiving punishment from God. Marginalisation of people with disabilities is against the spirit of unhu or ubuntu and taking care of people with such conditions results in blessings coming from ancestors and the Supreme Being.
- Disabled people can also contribute positively to the society hence the adage *bofu rakareva hondo* (the blind warned about the coming war) or *vamwe vakaudzwa hondo nemurwere wepfungwa* (others were told about the coming war by a mentally challenged person).
- Any form of ill-treatment of disabled persons attract severe punishment from God and so, the disabled are generally given maximum care. Insulting a disabled person is considered a social anathema. This is the reason why the Shona say, *Seka urema wafa* which literally means if you laugh

at a disabled person you may also become disabled.

- The disabled are given a lot of consideration in various spheres of life and have their rights given utmost priority.

Negative perceptions about disability in Indigenous religion

- The disabled in Indigenous religion are often stigmatised. They are called all sorts of names due to their conditions. Names like *chirema* for the lame, *bofu* for the blind, *benzi* for the mentally challenged and *Murungudunhu* for albinos are derogatory names which label people living with disabilities as sub-human beings.
- Since certain forms of disability are believed to be a result of disobedience, or a curse on the part of the victim, the disabled in Indigenous religion may be labelled as evil and deserving the affliction. This is evidenced by the way people ignore the plight of the disabled person. Caring for the disabled for some may result in one attracting the same curse that would be affecting the disabled.
- Some of the disabled, especially the mentally afflicted, are feared as monsters likely to cause harm to people. They are avoided and some are put in chains. No interaction is made with people with mental problems.
- In Indigenous religion, some disabled people such as lepers, can be isolated and marginalised due to the belief that the condition affecting them is contagious. In Zimbabwe, people with such conditions are kept at Mutoko centre and various places as well. The interaction with other people is limited. This makes them feel detached from the society and make them unhuman because of ill-treatment.
- Some people who are disabled are not wanted by their family members when they are performing rituals because they are seen as the source of disgrace and misfortune to the family.

Perceptions about disability in Judaism

In Judaism, there are varying perceptions about disability. Forms of disability can be viewed either as a curse or a test, as a blessing or as punishment from God. A special consideration is given to the belief in a divine source of all afflictions. The attitude of the Jews towards the disabled is shaped by their understanding of biblical records, especially in Leviticus 21:17-20 where the disabled are despised and prohibited from participating in crucial rituals such as sacrifices. According to Exodus 4:11, it is God who made the disabled persons and as such, Jews view disability as a gift from God, not because of sin, but just a diverse form of His creation.

Positive perceptions about disability in Judaism

- In Judaism, the disabled are a social responsibility. The whole community should take responsibility for the welfare of the disabled. Disability is considered a problem for the whole community which requires collective effort.
- Jews view disability as part of God's creation. People with disabilities should be accepted with their conditions. Disability is not treated as one's own making but as part of God's diverse creation.
- Despite their conditions, the disabled can display and showcase great talent.

Negative perceptions about disability in Judaism

- Jews view disability as a curse from God. It is because of this belief that people with disabilities are neglected like those with leprosy, mentally ill and those paralysed.
- Some Jews may consider the disabled as victims of God's wrath for sins committed. Jews do not want to be associated with sinners because associating with sinners may also result in one being contaminated and thereby liable to God's wrath also.
- The disabled are despised, to the extent that they do not participate in ceremonial worship of the Lord. This is supported by Leviticus 21:16-21 which reads, "*The Lord spoke further to Moses: Speak to*

Aaron and say: No man of your offspring throughout the ages who has a blemish (mum) shall be qualified to offer the food of his God. No one at all who has a blemish shall be qualified: no man who is blind, or lame, or has a limb too short or too long, no man who has a broken leg or a broken arm, or who is a hunchback, or a dwarf, or who has a growth in his eye, or who has a boil-scar, or scurvy, or crushed testes". This shows that Judaism does select people who participate in ritual action basing on being able or disabled.

Perceptions about disability in Christianity

According to Matthew 9:2, Jesus healed a paralytic by saying, *"Take heart, my son, your sins are forgiven."* Mere forgiveness of sins by Jesus resulted in the complete healing of the paralysed man. Christians are of the view that disability can be caused by sins preying on an individual leading to psychosomatic ailments that can cause physical and mental limitations. *"It was not that this man sinned, or his parents, but that the works of God might be made manifest in him."* (John 9:3).

To Christians, disability is a creation of God so that His power to heal is manifested to man. There is also a view by Christians that disability is a punishment from God for sins committed or for lack of faith in God as is the case with the father of the epileptic boy in Matthew 9:22 and verse 25. Mental challenges are attributed to demon attacks in Christianity, as in the case of the demoniac with legions in Luke 8:29.

Positive perceptions about disability in Christianity

- Christians view disability as the work of God so that His power is manifested in the healing of the disabled as in Isaiah 35:5-6 which says, *"Then the eyes of the blind shall be opened; and the ears of the deaf unstopped; then shall the lame leap like a hart; and the tongue of the dumb sing for joy."* Disability provides a platform for God to demonstrate that he is omnipotent.
- Christianity provides maximum care for people living with disabilities. They derive their inspiration from Jesus who is their role model in caring for the disabled. Jesus cared for the blind, lame, paralysed, mentally challenged and lepers to just mention a few by healing them. In contemporary Christian set up, there are some designated places like Henry Murray School of the deaf and Capota Mission in Zimuto which belong to the Reformed church in Zimbabwe.
- There are Christian institutions set aside for the rehabilitation and education of the disabled, for example, Capota Mission for the blind, Morgenster Mission for the deaf and mute.
- Some Christians view disability as a means of purification and a way of grace from the Lord.
- People with disability can also participate in ministry. There are a number of disabled people who are ministers of the gospel of God in Christianity. For instance, the late Ezekiel Guti Junior was disabled but he ministered the gospel of God. This clearly shows the part which disabled people play in Christianity.

Negative perceptions about disability in Christianity

- Some of the Christians perceive disability as punishment from God for sins committed and so, despise the disabled. This results in stigma and discrimination of people living with disabilities.
- The disabled, such as the blind, the mentally challenged or the lepers, are considered social outcasts and looked down upon by some Christians. Bartimaeus, the blind man of Jericho, was rebuked for calling Jesus' name, for those around, did not want their master to be bothered by a mere blind man. (Mark 10:48).
- In other cases, the disabled are treated with stigmatisation and marginalisation, depending on the severity of their conditions. They are not allowed to take positions within the church because of their condition.

Disability perceptions in Islam

To Muslims, disability is a test for a person affected by it and also for the entire society. Muslims are expected

to treat persons with disabilities with respect as revealed to Prophet Muhammad by Allah. The belief is that the physically disabled are spiritually abled. It is, therefore, the duty of every Muslim to take good care of the disabled. Caring for the disabled in Islam is considered a real blessing. However, according to the Quran 47:23, Allah can punish individual Muslims for sin, resulting in disability. To that end, the disabled can be viewed as victims of sin in Islam and a curse from Allah.

Positive perceptions about disability in Islam

- In Islam, it is a communal obligation to assist the disabled (Quran 2:177). It is the duty of every member of the community to assist towards the welfare of the disabled. The welfare of the disabled is not only limited to close relatives of the disabled person but to the whole community.
- Even if no material assistance is offered, just giving attention to the disabled is an Islamic expectation. This helps in making the disabled feel loved and part of the *ummar*, meaning Islamic community.
- Muslims are expected to view the disabled as equal members of the society who must be given equal treatment and equal opportunities such as access to education and health. It is considered a sin to discriminate and stigmatise disabled persons to the extent of limiting them by unequal treatment like other abled persons. Allah is against inequality because paradise belongs to all people, the abled and the disabled.
- Paying attention to the needs of the disabled in Islam is viewed as a form of righteousness. Helping people living with disabilities helps in erasing sins in Islam. This shows that Islam is a practical religion based on good works than faith alone.
- Muslims consider that being disabled does not lessen their value before Allah. A disabled person maintains his or her personal value as the creation of Allah despite having some constraints physically and psychologically.
- Mosques are designed in such a way that they cater for the needs of the people living with disabilities. Furthermore, disabled people are exempted from making some movements which may be difficult to do when performing rituals like performing a wudu as well as prostrating.



Fig. 10.4 A disabled Muslim praying like other abled Muslims

Negative perceptions about disability in Islam

- Some modern Muslims ignore the welfare and needs of the handicapped as more attention now focuses on sustaining themselves and their families.
- The disabled suffer mockery and social discrimination. (Quran 49:11). Like in any other society, people living with disabilities are a laughing stock. They are mocked because of their conditions.
- Usually, the disabled are viewed as victims of sin and are ridiculed for their sinful behaviour.
- Many disabled persons in Islam suffer from lack of attention to worship Allah as some Islamic cultures have flawed understanding of disability. They do not worship Allah in the mosque because they always need assistance to visit the mosque.

Activity 10.1 Research work

Visit the disabled in your locality. Kindly find out the possible causes of their conditions and provide feedback to the class.

Exercise 10.1

Answer the following questions with True or False.

1. Disability is caused by witchcraft in Indigenous religion.
2. Being lame is not a physical disability.
3. Curses from ancestors cause disability in Indigenous religion.
4. God punishes people with disability in Indigenous religion.
5. Lepers live within the community in Indigenous religion.
6. Physically disabled people are spiritually abled people in Islam.
7. Disability is a gift from God in Judaism.
8. Christianity does not support the welfare of the disabled in Zimbabwe.

UNIT 10.2 RELIGION AND MARGINALISATION OF PERSONS LIVING WITH DISABILITIES

There are so many perceptions and attitudes in various religions about disability and the disabled. In some religions, disability is considered a curse from a deity while in others, it is believed to be a blessing. In many cases religion is an accomplice in marginalising people living with disabilities.

Marginalisation is a term which refers to a process where a certain group of people is made to feel isolated and unimportant in society or community in which they live. It leads to exclusion and being ignored by the society. This subsection deals with the different types of severity of disabilities and conclude with how religions marginalise people with disabilities.

Different types of disability

Treatment of persons with disability vary from one society to the other, from one religion to another. Severity of disability ranges from mild to more serious conditions. The degrees of severity of disability include profound, moderate and severe cases of disability.

Moderate cases of disability

These are cases of disability where persons living with disability have the capacity to carry out a few activities. Moderate cases of disability might later on result in persons affected being able to fend for themselves through handicraft. They can receive some form of training in some income-generating activities and become self-reliant. The disabled persons in this category do not feel heavily marginalised as in severe cases of disability.

Severe cases of disability

Severe impairment is an impairment or a combination of impairments that have a strong bearing on one's ability to perform basic activities. Examples of these severe cases of disability include muscular dystrophy, where the disabled have impaired limbs and hands and suffers incapacitation in terms of mobility. Other severe cases of disability include special senses and speech disorders which inhibit verbal communication on the part of the disabled. Mental disorders are another form of a severe type of disability where the disabled have challenges in memory loss and the reasoning capacity severely affected. The disabled, in this case, do not pose problems for themselves, but for caregivers as well. Paralysis is a severe physical disability which renders the disabled person a merely assisted person in almost every respect.

The persons with severe cases of disability require personal assistance, guidance and supervision, twenty-

four hours a day. Such persons should not be marginalised solely on the basis of their inability to fend for themselves. In severe disability, the person's daily activities or participation in various social activities is restricted. Persons with severe cases of disability suffer isolation and feel marginalised because they rely on outright assistance and where this assistance is not regularly provided, they feel subdued and neglected.

How religions marginalise people living with disabilities

Religions all over the world marginalise people living with disabilities because of labels attached to disabilities. Disability is associated with curses and sins which lead to the pushing of people living with disabilities to the periphery.

1. Indigenous religion

People living with disabilities are marginalised in Indigenous religion as they are hidden at home. Their movement in society is limited because most indigenous beliefs tend to characterise disability as affliction. For example, lepers are excluded from society as they live in secluded places like at Mutoko centre. People with albinism are regarded as a "wild white" person which shows their marginalisation. Many people do not want to share plates and cups let alone sharing food and drink with people with disabilities. They are stigmatised. The mentally challenged people are also marginalised as they are not allowed to take part in social activities like farming.

Furthermore, there is proven correlation between disability and material deprivation, marginalisation and denial of the humanity of disabled persons. People living with disabilities are frequently treated as evil and have to be ritually, morally, and physically cleansed of their affliction before they can be reintegrated into human society. People with albinism experience marginalisation in Indigenous religion as they are excluded from society by being treated as the "other" and they are ignored. In most cases people living with disabilities are concealed from the general public. For example, the albinos, blind and lame children are hidden by their families from society because they are regarded as a source of shame and embarrassment to their families. They cannot also participate in religious ceremonies like rain asking ceremonies and *Incwala*.

In addition, the disabled cannot inherit a family name in Indigenous religion as their condition is associated with shame, they cannot also become traditional leaders like being a chief or a village head. The disabled cannot also become ancestors when they die even if they meet all the qualifications of being an ancestor they are discriminated because of their condition. They cannot become warriors or even the chief's advisors as well being able to sit in the king's court. Lastly some indigenous people do not want their daughter to marry a disabled son-in-law while others do not want their sons to marry disabled daughters-in-law.

2. Judaism

People living with disabilities have always been a part of Jewish religious community. In keeping with a deep ethical commitment to protect those who could easily be marginalised, the Torah forbids insulting the deaf or placing a stumbling block before the blind (Leviticus 19:14). Other texts on disability raise harder questions for some readers. Just two chapters later, the Torah excludes a priest with certain kinds of physical conditions from serving at the altar (Leviticus 21).

Marginalisation of people with disabilities in Jewish religion is in form of exemption from rituals and other religious obligations that are supposed to be done. It should be noted that the Jewish culture is mainly oral in terms of transmission; emphasises speaking and hearing as the primary mode for teaching and learning the Torah, as well as other forms of communication. Because the rabbis assumed that a person who could neither hear nor speak was unable to communicate, they exempted them from virtually all Jewish rituals and obligations. Inability to speak is tantamount to an inability to learn.

The Torah gives striking voice in the marginalisation of people with disabilities. Leviticus 21, which provides

an extensive list of blemishes that disqualify a priest from offering sacrifices at the altar, *"The Lord spoke further to Moses: Speak to Aaron and say: No man of your offspring throughout the ages who has a blemish (mum) shall be qualified to offer the food of his God. No one at all who has a blemish shall be qualified: no man who is blind, or lame, or has a limb too short or too long, no man who has a broken leg or a broken arm, or who is a hunchback, or a dwarf, or who has a growth in his eye, or who has a boil-scar, or scurvy, or crushed testes"*. This is the bases of marginalisation of people with disabilities in Judaism.

3. Christianity

Christianity has also been found marginalising people living with disabilities. Although the Christian community has been healing people living with disability, they have failed to accept the conditions of people with disabilities to a lesser extent. The church has failed to recognise conditions of people with disabilities. They are viewed as other human beings and not as proper human beings created in the image of God. This marginalisation is caused by the belief that disability is a natural manifestation of evil.

Christians believe that disabilities are caused by sin in one's individual life or by the sins committed by their parents. It is because of these beliefs that people living with disabilities feel alienated, marginalised, embarrassed and in some cases, offended by the treatment which they get from the Christian environment. In some Christian denominations like the African Initiated Churches and other protestant churches, a person with a history of disability cannot become a religious leader or personnel in form of pastor or priest. These churches are shunned by people living with disabilities because of the structural marginalisation of people with disabilities.

4. Islam

Although Islam is a religion which is motivated by equality of all people regardless of race, creed, gender and ability, just like other religions disability is a condition connected to spiritual deficiency. Disability is associated with one's individual sin and it leads to spiritual anxiety in the private sphere and alienation from religious association in the public sphere.

People with disabilities are isolated from the public sphere because of their physical and mental challenges in Muslim communities. People living with disabilities are often implicated in religious interpretations of sacred texts and contexts. This results in stigmatisation and marginalisation of people living with disabilities in many Muslim communities.

Activity 10.3 Debate

Debate the following issue, "Should society and various religions discriminate against the disabled." One group provides motion to the topic whilst the other group opposes it.

Exercise 10.2

1. Discuss how different religions portray people with different disabilities.

[25]

Interesting facts

1. The disabled persons continue to experience some forms of marginalisation despite concerted efforts by religions to provide care and support to persons living with disability.

Summary of the chapter

- The chapter has focused on various forms of disability, showing some analysis of possible causes of disability.
- Perceptions about disability were discussed in relation to various religions such as Christianity, Islam, Judaism and Indigenous religion.
- Religion and marginalisation of persons living with disability were also discussed, focusing on the degree of severity of different types of disabilities.
- Visual impairment can be partial or complete.
- In Indigenous religion, any form of ill-treatment of the disabled attracts punishment from the Supreme Being.
- The physically disabled are spiritually abled and can take part in Islamic rituals.
- In Judaism, the disabled are despised and are prohibited from taking part in crucial sacrifices at altars.
- It is the responsibility of the entire community to take care of the disabled, according to Judaism.
- To Christians, disability is a creation by God so that His power to heal is manifested to men.

Glossary of terms

Affliction	– a state of mental or bodily pain, distress, grief or misery.
Disability	– an impairment that may be cognitive, mental, physical, sensory or a combination of these.
Incapacitation	– state of being disabled or unable to move or function.
Manifested	– formally revealed as apparent to the visual senses.
Marginalisation	– treatment of a person, group or a concept as insignificant.
Perception	– the way in which something is regarded, understood or interpreted
Purification	– the removal of all forms of uncleanness.
Psychosomatic	– a physical or illness related to the interaction of the body and the mind.
Rehabilitation	– an attempt to restore functional ability to those with physical impairments or disabilities.
Stigmatisation	– something that is unfairly disregarded by many people as being bad or having something to be ashamed of.

Revision Exercises

Structured Questions

1. There are different causes of disabilities.

- (a) Define the term disability. [2]
- (b) List any four forms of disabilities. [4]
- (c) Explain three forms of disabilities. [6]
- (d) Describe four causes of disability. [8]

2. Disability in Indigenous religion is believed to be a curse from a deity.

- (a) What is a curse? [2]
- (b) List any four causes of disability in Indigenous religion. [4]
- (c) Explain three causes of disability in Indigenous religion. [6]
- (d) Suggest four ways the disabled can be assisted in Indigenous religion. [8]

3. In Judaism, there are varying perceptions about disability.

- (a) What is a religious perception? [2]
- (b) State four possible causes of disability in Judaism. [4]
- (c) Explain three causes of disability in Judaism. [6]
- (d) Examine four challenges faced by the disabled in Judaism. [8]

4. Severity of disability ranges from mild to more serious cases.

- (a) Define the term, 'severity of disability'. [2]
- (b) State four examples of moderate cases of disability. [4]
- (c) Explain three cases of severe disability. [6]
- (d) Suggest four ways of reducing stigmatisation of persons with severe cases of disability. [8]

Essay Questions

- 1. Explain the concept of disability in Indigenous religion. [25]
- 2. Discuss positive and negative perceptions about disability in Islam. [25]
- 3. Discuss various views about disability in Christianity. [25]
- 4. Identify five severe cases of disability and explain the severity of each case of disability. [25]

Chapter

11

RELIGION AND THE NATURAL ENVIRONMENT

Chapter objectives

By the end of this chapter, you should be able to:

- describe the attitudes of Judaism to the natural environment.
- outline methods of preserving the environment in Judaism.
- describe the attitudes of Islam to the natural environment.
- outline methods of preserving the natural environment in Islam.

Introduction

Environment refers to the air, water and land in which people, animals and plants live. Religion plays an important role in the understanding of the natural environment by creating attitudes which help in the protection of the natural environment. In this chapter, religious attitudes of Judaism and Islam towards the natural environment will be discussed. To add on, this chapter will also explain methods of preserving the natural environment in Judaism and Islam. Similarities and differences in the attitudes and preservation of the natural environment have been articulated in this chapter. This is because religion is an important tool for the preservation and conservation of the natural environment especially within the context of this modern era which is characterised by several environmental challenges like global warming, degradation, climate change, pollution and extinction of some species.

UNIT 11.1 JUDAISM AND THE NATURAL ENVIRONMENT

The natural environment encompasses all living and non-living things occurring naturally, meaning in this case not artificial. The environment encompasses the interaction of all living species, climate, weather and natural resources that affect human survival and economic development. These include all vegetation, microorganisms, soil, rocks, atmosphere, and natural events. The natural environment plays a great role in the existence of life on earth and it helps human beings, animals and other living things to grow and develop naturally.

It is the most important topic that everyone must know how to protect our environment to keep it safe forever as well as ensure the nature's balance on this planet to continue the existence of life. The source of environment protection is found in the prohibition in the biblical command that soldiers at war should not cut down fruit trees to use their wood in besieging an enemy. (Deut. 20:19-20). This verse is the basis of understanding the attitude of Judaism towards the environment.

Judaism's attitude towards the natural environmental

Having a positive attitude towards the environment is the most fundamental concept of Judaism based on

the belief that God is the creator of the universe. As such only God has absolute ownership over Creation (Gen. 1-2, Psalm 24:1, I Chron. 29:10-16). Judaism's understanding of the environment is theocentric not anthropocentric. Human beings have restricted freedom in the utilisation of the environment because it does not belong to them. In Genesis, God is the owner of all Creation.

(a) None wastage of resources

For Jews, the Torah states clearly that "in the beginning God created the heavens and the earth" so the formation of the earth is a matter of divine concern and must also be a matter of divine concern. The Torah prohibits the wasteful consumption of anything. Because of Jewish sacred texts that teach that humankind has an obligation to improve the world for future generations. Therefore, families are encouraged to reduce their waste and make smart choices, investing in companies that do not pollute the environment.

(b) Laws on the environment

Judaism has a legislative framework derived from the Torah. The Jewish law forbids harming ourselves (Leviticus 19:28) and the natural environment. Disposal of waste and noxious products from industrial production must be kept far from human habitation because it threatens the natural environment.

(c) Caring for the environment

There is need to care for the environment in order to preserve that which God has created. In the story of Noah, God brings a flood upon the earth but only after every single species of animal is kept safe inside the Ark. The story is telling us of our divine duty to protect all living creatures (biodiversity).

Methods of preserving the natural environment in Judaism

Judaism calls for the protection and generation of new resources for future generations. This religious tradition values concept of preserving the environment for example planting a tree, the rabbis teach that if a man is planting a tree and the Messiah appears, he should finish planting the tree before going to greet him. Even in times of war trees were not to be cut down. The Jewish nation in Israel felt an eternal bond to the Land of Israel, and therefore a responsibility to protect their environment.

The following are some of the laws of the environment from the Torah.

1. Use of greenbelts to protect the environment

A city must have a greenbelt surrounding it limiting urban sprawl. Urban sprawling refers to the unrestricted overlapping of a town into non-residential areas like forests. Judaism prevents this by having forests or plantations around towns and it is a crime to encroach into the greenbelt or forests.

2. Protection of trees during wars

A fruit tree cannot be destroyed when setting a siege to a city. During wars, Judaism prohibits the cutting down of fruit trees as a way of protecting the natural environment. Any unwarranted destroying of nature should be avoided.

3. Regulating grazing areas to limit environmental degradation

The Rabbis severely limited the grazing of goats and sheep in parts of Israel where they caused environmental damage. Israel is located in a desert and grazing areas were of special significance and they were protected. Overgrazing of pastures which results in environmental degradation is prohibited. Judaism protected the environment by preventing overgrazing.

4. Appointment of the minister of environment by Jewish kings

King Solomon appointed a minister to limit the harvesting of wood in the forests of Israel. Cutting down of trees should be limited as wanton destruction of trees for fuel purposes results in desertification. This shows

that Kings were concerned with the environment. The appointment of an environment minister shows that Judaism is a green religion which protects the natural environment.

5. Laws which prevents water pollution

The Mishnah deals with laws of water and air pollution, limiting the rights of both rural and civic residents. It is against Jewish law to smoke, dispose sewage into water bodies, littering in public places and raise dust. This Jewish law is known as halvah which limits pollution. According to halvah furnaces were forbidden in Jerusalem because the smoke causes air pollution within the city. Controlling pollution is one of the religious mandates of Judaism.

6. Existence of environmental organisations which promote awareness

There are many Jewish organisations that are working to build awareness of the Torah's message concerning the responsibility to the environment.

7. Sabbath as a mechanism of protecting the environment

The Sabbath law is a way of living a sustainable life. People limit the use of resources as people do not cook or shop on this day, this helps to save the environment. The sabbatical year helps to redress the power of economic imbalances in human society and creation.

8. Prohibition of wasting natural resources

The Torah prohibits the wasteful use of anything. When people waste resources, they are breaking the law of Deuteronomy 20: 19-20 "Do not destroy". This applies even to eating and drinking or in the kind of clothes that one wears. There are a number of laws on the disposal of waste. Waste should be disposed of properly. For example, industrial waste must be kept far from human habitation (Deuteronomy 23: 13-15).

9. Protection of endangered species and other animals

The Torah prohibit the extinction of species and causing undue pain to non-human creatures. Judaism cares for other creatures as it calls for compassion towards animals. According to Deuteronomy 22:6, one should send away the mother bird before taking eggs from the nest and it is prohibited to kill the mother animal and its child on the same day. This shows that Judaism protects endangered species and animals.

10. Jewish holidays on the environment

The Jewish home is one in which a model is found for relating to the environment, in a less coldly instrumental way, and even the holidays and other observances are done with an environment concern.

11. Clean water

Jews believe that water is an important natural resource for human survival, water has a special place in Jewish tradition, playing a role in nearly every major story in the Bible. Isaac's wife was chosen for him at a well; the baby Moses was saved after floating down a river; the Israelites were freed when the red sea parted; Miriam will forever be remembered by her gift of water to the Jewish people in the desert. Clean, fresh water supplies and mineral resources are natural resources which should be preserved. Jewish tradition advocates prevention of water pollution.

Activity 11.1 Group work

Explain the natural environment. Note the similarities and differences that the different groups have come up with.

Activity 11.2 Discussion

In groups, discuss the Jewish attitudes towards the natural environment.

Activity 11.3 Research work

Using biblical evidence from the Old Testament show the methods used by the Jews to conserve the environment.

Exercise 11.1

1. Describe the Jewish ways of preserving the environment.

[25]

UNIT 11.2 ISLAM AND THE NATURAL ENVIRONMENT

Environment protection is an important aspect of Islam. Being stewards of the Earth is the responsibility of Muslims to care for the environment in a positive way. Muslims are encouraged to reflect on the relationship between living organisms and their environment and to maintain the ecological balance created by Allah. Protection of the environment is essential to Islamic beliefs and mankind has the responsibility to ensure safe custody of the environment.

Islamic attitude towards the natural environment

Muslims believe that Allah is the creator of the universe. Environmental protection is an important aspect of Islam. All Muslims are encouraged to take care of the environment in a proactive manner. They believe that there is a definite purpose behind the creation of different species, be it animals or plants. Protection of the environment is of great importance. The humans have the responsibility of taking care of the natural environment.

- The Muslims prohibit over-exploitation of the natural environment. *"O children of Adam! ... eat and drink: but waste not by excess, for Allah loves not the wasters."* (Surah 7:31)
- There is also a view that the devastation caused by deforestation in many countries causes soil erosion and kills many of the biodiversity of the earth.
- Another Islamic view on the natural resources was brilliantly put forward that one should partake of it gladly so long as you are the benefactor, not a despoiler; a cultivator, not a destroyer.
- Disrupting the natural order and balance is not only discouraged in Islam, but also sinful and worthy of punishment.
- According to Islamic thought, benefits from the environment should not be limited to some people. Instead it should be the source of life for all people at all times.
- All human beings as well as animals and wildlife enjoy the right to share the earth's resources.
- A major objective of Islamic teachings and prophetic traditions is to build and maintain a healthy and clean environment which is devoid of any source of pollution and misuse. Muhammad taught that one should not relieve himself in a source of water or on a path or in a place of shade of a



Fig. 11.3 A Muslim woman appreciating nature

living creature. These values highlight Islam's stress on avoiding pollution of critical resources and importance of cleanliness.

- Islam, as a way of life, expects human beings to conserve the environment for several reasons which may be summarised as follows:
- The environment, is Allah's creation. The creation of this earth and all its natural resources is a sign of His wisdom, mercy, power and His other attributes and therefore serves to develop human awareness and understanding of this creator.
- Muslims should seek to protect and preserve the environment because by so doing they protect Allah's creatures which pray to Him and praise Him.
- The environment contains Allah's creatures which the Muslim scholars consider to also deserve protection.
- Also, among the reasons why Islam seeks to protect and preserve the environment is that Islam, as a way of life, is established on the concept of good.

Methods of conserving the natural environment in Islam

Environmental conservation is one of the basic tenets of Islam. Immediate steps are required to protect natural resources. Conserving the natural environment is a religious duty of every Muslim. Humans are seen as trustees of what Allah has created. All that he has given must be preserved and delivered back to Allah in the best manner possible.

(a) Conservation

Conservation by reducing, reusing, and recycling waste. The Quran says, "but waste not by excess: for Allah loveth not the wasters" Quran 6:141. The principle of conservation is illustrated by the following rule, which says that even when taking a bath for prayer we should sparingly use water.

(b) Planting of trees

Planting trees is done. It is seen as a classical Islamic tradition as an act of continuous charity and a good deed. The prophet said that if one plants a tree then whatever is eventually eaten from it whether by humans or animals counts for the planter of trees as an act of charity. Muslims are encouraged to cultivate barren lands and for such a task, a good reward is prepared for them in the hereafter. An example of the positive attitude towards the conservation of the environment and nature is found in the Prophet Muhammad's (peace be upon him) declaration: "If any Believer plants a tree or sows a field, and a human, bird or animal eats from it; it shall be reckoned as charity from him." He also said: "If anyone plants a tree, neither human being nor any of God's creatures will eat from it without it being reckoned as charity from him."

(c) Condemnation of deforestation

Islam is against the cutting or destruction of plants and trees unnecessarily as is evident in the following Hadith: "He who cuts a lote-tree [without justification], Allah will send him to Hellfire." The devastation caused by deforestation in many countries causes soil erosion and kills many of the biodiversity of the earth.

(d) Utilisation of resources

In Islam the utilisation of these resources is the right and privilege of all people and all species. Hence, man should take every precaution to ensure the interests and rights of all others since they are equal partners on earth. Similarly, he should not regard such as restricted to one generation above all other generations.

(e) Avoiding degradation

It is also obligatory in Islamic law, whatever is indispensable to fulfill the imperative obligation of preserving life. Any action that obstructs or impairs the biological and social functions of this element, whether by

destroying it or by polluting it with any substance that would make it an unsuitable environment for living things or otherwise impair its function as the basis of life; any such action necessarily leads to the impairment or ruin of life itself.

(f) Avoiding pollution

Since the atmosphere performs all these biological and social functions, its conservation, pure and unpolluted, is an essential aspect of the conservation of life itself which is one of the fundamental objectives of Islamic law. Again, whatever is indispensable to fulfil this imperative obligation is itself obligatory. Therefore, any activity which pollutes it and ruins or impairs its function is an attempt to thwart and obstruct God's wisdom toward His creation. Islam urges its followers to keep the streets clean and free from any harm, and such work is considered as a part of faith. The spoilers of streets roads and parks will face a severe punishment. The prophet said that cleanliness is half of faith.

(g) Establishment of environmentally protected areas

Cutting down of trees in these areas as well as killing of animals is prohibited. The Holy Prophet is believed to be the first one to establish these protected areas. He declared an area outside Medina as a protected area. (Hadith No. 27920).

Activity 11.4 Group discussion

In groups discuss the Islamic teachings that can help protect the natural environment in your society.

Activity 11.5 ICT project-based learning

Use Adobe Photoshop or any other graphic designing software program to design a flyer with information on the negative effects of destroying the natural environment among the youths. Come up with a hashtag denouncing the destruction of the natural environment.

Exercise 11.2

Answer the following questions with True or False.

1. The environment is important in Islam.
2. Muslims allow the over exploitation of resources.
3. Conservation is an environmental protection method in Islam.
4. Cutting down of trees is prohibited in Islam.
5. Human beings are more important than animals in Islam.

Interesting facts

1. God is the creator of the whole universe.
2. The human beings have a duty and responsibility of taking care of the natural environment.
3. They will be punished in the hereafter for destroying the natural environment, it is regarded as a sin.

Summary of the chapter

- All the people have the responsibility of defending and protecting the natural environment because it is beneficial to us.
- The environment has been created by God for use by the human beings.
- It is the duty of the human beings to take great care of the natural environment.
- Many methods have been put forward by the Jews to try and care and protect the environment.
- The Jewish religion has many laws that help protect the environment.

- In Islam, the prophet Muhammad and even the Sharia law also supported the protection of the natural resources and it is a sin to destroy the natural environment.
- Judaism and Islam believe that one will be punished for destroying the natural environment in the afterlife.
- Excess use of the resources is forbidden in Judaism and Islam.
- Environmental conservation is one of the most important aspects of being a religious person.
- Taking care of the environment is seen as a way of worshipping and honouring the Supreme Being in both Islam and Judaism.

Glossary of terms

Attitude	– way of carrying oneself.
Ban	– to forbid or to prohibit.
Conservation	– careful preservation and protection of something; especially planned management of a natural resource to prevent exploitation, destruction or neglect.
Greenbelt	– an area of open land around with fields or parks around a town or a city, on which building of houses or factories is not allowed by law.
Mishna	– the laws of water and air pollution, limiting the rights of both rural and civic residents.
Natural resources	– these are resources supplied by nature.
Rabbi	– teacher of the Jewish law.
Sabbath law	– the rule of not doing any work on the seventh day of the week.
Trustee	– a person to whom property is legally committed in trust to be applied for the benefit of specified individual or public uses.

Revision Exercises

Structured Questions

1. Environmental protection is an important aspect in Islam.

- What is the natural environment in Islam? [2]
- List four components of the environment. [4]
- Explain three ways of environmental preservation in Islam. [6]
- Illustrate how the advice from Muhammad contributed to the protection of the natural environment [8]

2. Judaism values the environment.

- Define the natural environment in Judaism. [2]
- State any four features of the environment that are used by believers in Judaism. [4]
- Describe three ways of environmental preservation in Judaism. [4]
- Illustrate how the Torah contributed to the protection of the natural environment. [8]

3. The environment is of concern in Judaism.

- What is the Jewish understanding of the natural environment? [2]
- State any four ways natural resources are used in Judaism. [4]
- Explain any three teachings about the environment in Judaism. [6]
- Identify any four ways of preserving the environment in Judaism. [8]

4. The environment is respected in Islam.

- (a) What is the Islamic understanding of the natural environment? [2]
- (b) State any four ways natural resources are used in Islam. [4]
- (c) Explain any three teachings of preserving the environment in Islam. [6]
- (d) Identify any four ways of preserving the natural environment in Islam. [8]

5. The Supreme Being is the creator of the universe.

- (a) Define Supreme Being. [2]
- (b) List four components of the natural environment. [4]
- (c) How is water viewed in Judaism? [6]
- (d) Describe how Muslims view wildlife. [8]

Essay Questions

- 1. Explain the attitude of Judaism towards the natural environment. [25]
- 2. Explain the methods used by the Muslims to conserve the natural environment. [25]
- 3. Discuss the attitude of Muslims towards the natural environment. [25]
- 4. Write explanatory notes on how religions you have studied conserve the natural environment. [25]
- 5. Describe the different views of Judaism and Islam on the different components of the natural environment. [25]

Chapter

12

RELIGION, RIGHTS AND SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY

Chapter objectives

By the end of this chapter, you should be able to:

- recognise the rights of the elderly.
- identify the rights of persons with disabilities.
- identify the benefits associated with freedom of worship.
- state the disadvantages associated with freedom of worship.

Introduction

Every human has basic rights and freedoms from birth until death. The elderly and the disabled have rights too. This chapter deals with rights of the elderly and rights of the disabled as part of social responsibility as well as religious obligation. In the process, the role of religious attitudes and perceptions towards the elderly and people living with disabilities will be explained. The chapter concludes by exploring the concept of freedom of worship by looking at the advantages and disadvantages of the freedom of worship.

UNIT 12.1 RIGHTS OF THE ELDERLY

The elderly in Zimbabwe are people who are seventy years of age and above. Elders are considered to be inherently less valuable to society. They face increasing barriers to their participation, become more dependent on others and lose some or all of their personal autonomy.

These threats to their dignity can make them more susceptible to neglect, abuse and violation of their rights. In Zimbabwe, the elderly people have the following rights such as:

(a) Freedom from discrimination

Each elderly person has the right to be free from discrimination, insults, or maltreatment. They should be treated equally.



Fig. 12.1 Elderly people in Zimbabwe

(b) Freedom from abuse, neglect and exploitation

The elderly people have the right to be treated with dignity and respect and to live without exploitation, abuse or neglect.

(c) Right to dignity

Elderly people should be able to live in dignity and the integrity of their persons shall be protected by the law.

(d) Right to maintenance

The elderly people are to receive reasonable care and assistance from their families, community support and the state such as adequate food, shelter, water and clothing.

(e) Right to have adequate health care

The elderly people have the right to a standard of living with adequate facilities for their well-being. They receive health care and medical assistance from the state.

(f) Right to have material assistance

Elderly people are to receive financial support by way of social security and welfare.

Religion and the elderly

The phenomenon of an ageing population is found in all religious communities. In this modern world, the elderly people are being increasingly marginalised and treated as a burden to society. Religion acts as a panacea to the welfare of the elderly by caring and loving them. In most religions, the elderly people are regarded as more religious people than the young. There is an interconnection between religion and old age.

Indigenous religion values the wisdom of the elderly people and they are the key figures in Indigenous religion. Elders are supposed to be respected, cared for as well as being given protection. Abuse of the elderly people in Indigenous religion leads to the anger of ancestors. As such, Indigenous religion values the old. It is the duty of every one who is able to fulfil the needs of the old people. It is part of social responsibility in Indigenous religion. Furthermore, being an elderly person is one of the qualifications for one to become an ancestor. One cannot make that transition from the present life to the next life of ancestorhood without being an elder. However, some religions lead to stigma and discrimination of the elderly basing on religious myths. For example, in Indigenous religion elderliness is associated with witchcraft. Religion should provide comfort to those who are looked down upon in society.

In Judaism, caring for the elderly is a religious duty. It is part of the laws given by God to the Hebrews. The elderly people are housed at their children or grandchildren's home so as to provide an opportunity for the grandchildren to have continuing interaction with them and possibly to help in their upkeep. The Torah specifically instructs us to "honour the elderly" (Leviticus 19:32). Judaism teaches us to honour even an old person who no longer possesses their full mental faculties.

Christianity teaches that for one to have a long life he or she should respect his or her father and mother. Christianity stresses the importance of according due respect and honour to the parents and elders. It is the Christian responsibility to care for the elderly. Christianity base its perception and attitude towards the elderly on Isaiah 46:4 which says, *"Even to your old age and grey hairs I am he, I am he who will sustain you. I have made you and I will carry you; I will sustain you and I will rescue."* This shows the importance of the elderly in Christian communities. Matthew 15:4-9 further supports the idea that it is a Christian responsibility to support their parents who include the elderly.

Islam also put emphasis on taking care of the needs of the elderly. The elderly in Islam are given special attention. One of the five pillars of Islam, almsgiving (*zakat*) also caters for the needs and welfare of the elderly. Neglecting the elderly is a violation of Muslim brotherhood and helping the widow helps one in having a close relationship with Allah. In Islam the elderly people are cared for because a man is an honoured creature and has an honourable status, Muslim society is a society of mutual compassion and coherence and an elderly has a high status before Allah if he adheres to the laws of Allah. Respecting an elderly is an example of a true Muslim. The elderly people are exempted from fasting during Ramadan and even going for a pilgrimage (*Hajj*).

Religion advocates for the rights of the elderly. There is no religion which does not value elderly people. Neglecting the elderly result in one being unfortunate in this life and the life to come. Therefore, the elderly people are supported by religion as valuable people in society.

Organisations for the Elderly in Zimbabwe

There are organisations that represent and advocate for the rights and well-being of the elderly people. These include:

(a) The National Age Network of Zimbabwe (NANZ)

- It focuses on older men and women.
- It also aims to promote intergenerational solidarity by raising awareness of ageing with young people.
- It offers activities that older people are involved.
- It funds programmes in the areas of livelihood, health and welfare of the elderly.

(b) Help Age Zimbabwe (HAZ)

- It is an organisation that works with the older persons in Zimbabwe.
- It seeks to improve the overall standard of living and health care for older people regardless of race, gender or religion.
- It provides developmental support programs and community-based initiatives in the areas of urban destitution, relief, aid, health institutional care, water provision, training, networking, housing and income generating projects. These projects are to make older persons as self-sufficient as possible.
- Their work on HIV and AIDS aims to raise awareness of the crucial role older people play as caregivers.
- It collaborates with community leaders, local authorities, government ministries, partner agencies and Non-governmental Organisations (NGOs) and makes sure that older people are included in emergency programmes by the Government and humanitarian organisations.

(c) Zimbabwe Older Persons Organisation

- The organisation is actively engaged in identifying the elderly in need and providing support for their well-being.
- It promotes the rights of older persons.

(d) Department of Social Service

- It offers free healthcare for the elderly.
- It pilots projects which cater for cash transfers to destitute elderly.

(e) National Social Security Authority of Zimbabwe (NSSA)

- It provides for retirement pensions in old age to formally employed workers.

Activity 12.1 Discussion

Using the Constitution of Zimbabwe, discuss the constitutional rights of the elderly.

Activity 12.2 Group work

Work in groups and discuss on the importance of respecting elders. List down your points and read out to the class.

Exercise 12.1

Elders are considered important in society.

- (a) What is an elder? [2]
- (b) List any four places where the elderly people are kept in Zimbabwe. [4]
- (c) Explain the roles of the elderly in your society. [6]

UNIT 12.2 RIGHTS OF PERSONS WITH DISABILITIES

A disabled person means a person with a physical, mental or sensory disability, including a visual, hearing or speech functional disability which leads to physical, cultural or social barriers that inhibit them from participating at an equal level with other members of society in activeness, undertakings or fields of employment that are open to other members of society.

Disability exists in Zimbabwe mainly due to diseases, war, conflict, malnutrition, accidents, abnormal births, hereditary characteristics and many others. The Disabled Persons Act is the primary law that addresses disability in Zimbabwe. This act provides for the welfare and rehabilitation of persons with disabilities. In Zimbabwe people with disabilities have the following rights;

(a) Right to education

The disabled are to be provided with special facilities for their education. Such schools are to provide appropriate reading materials for visually impaired or for those with hearing impairments. Basic facilities such as toilets are to be constructed in schools in such a way that even wheelchairs can be accommodated. They are to have state funded education and training.

(b) Right to adequate health care

Disabled persons are to be given access to medical, psychological and functional treatment.

(c) Right to be protected from discrimination

At workplaces the creation, classification or abolition of jobs and posts in a discriminatory manner is prohibited. Remuneration for performance of the same work should be equal. Fair consideration is to be given for all opportunities.

(d) Right to have access to public premises, services and amenities

Disabled persons are not to be denied access or admission into any premises where members of the public are ordinarily allowed. Also, they are not to be denied services that members of the society are ordinarily provided. Provision of suitable amenities such as bathrooms, access ramps, wider doorways and hallways for people who use wheelchairs should be put into consideration.

(e) Right to enable them to become self-reliant

Disability does not mean inability. Disabled people should realise their full potential. They should be

empowered individuals with rights to participate in political and social life and in their individual development. Danhiko project offers educational and vocational training institutions for persons with disabilities.

(f) Right to participate in social, creative and recreational activities

Persons with disability are to live with their families and participate in social, creative or recreational activities.

(g) Right to be protected from all forms of exploitation and abuse

The state has a duty to eliminate and prevent discriminatory actions against people with disability and to ensure that policies and laws take the welfare of persons living with disabilities into consideration. In Zimbabwe there are organisations that represent and advocate for disabled people. These are;

The National Council of Disabled People of Zimbabwe (NCDPZ)

- Promotes the full integration of disabled persons into society.
- Promotes active participation of disabled persons in the planning, implementation and decision making processes that affect their own lives.
- Develop and support grassroots disabled persons in both rural and urban areas to speak out of their interests and their concerns.
- Creates a society where all disabled people enjoy equal opportunities.

Zimbabwe Down Syndrome Association (ZDSA)

- Enhances the livelihoods of persons with Down syndrome and their families.
- Advocates and lobby for the rights of persons with Down syndrome in the rural areas where they are abused, discriminated and stigmatised.

Disability, HIV and AIDS Trust (DHAT)

- Promotes the rights and capacity building of persons with disabilities having cervical cancer, TB, infected and affected by HIV and AIDS.
- It aims at achieving inclusion and full participation of people with disabilities.
- Addresses issues of disability's rights and livelihood.

Zimbabwe Association of the Visually Handicapped (ZAHV)

- It caters for people with visual impairment.

Zimbabwe Women in Development (ZWIDE)

- Advocates for rights of women with disabilities.

Albino Association of Zimbabwe

- Looks out for the welfare of persons with Albinism and ensures that they are economically empowered.

Activity 12.3 Educational tour

Organise a visit to a school of disabilities and plan as a class on how you can source some donations for the disabled.

Activity 12.4 Practical exercise

At your school look around and see what is lacking to provide special facilities for the disabled. Make a campaign to assist in the development of the structures which accomodate people with disabilities.

Exercise 12.2

1. Describe the rights of people with disabilities.

[25]

UNIT 12.3 RIGHTS OF FREEDOM OF WORSHIP

In Zimbabwe, everyone has the right to freedom of religion or belief whether in public or in private and whether alone or together with others. No one may be compelled to take an oath that is contrary to their religion or belief. Parents and guardians of minor children have the right to determine in accordance with their convictions, the moral and religious upbringing of their children. The Zimbabwean government ensures that all citizens have the liberty to enjoy any religious affiliation they prefer via the constitution.

Benefits of freedom of worship

The right to freedom of worship has brought with it several benefits to the entire Zimbabwean community. These are:

1. Peace and security

It promotes discipline, an ability to distinguish between good and bad. People live and coexist with their differences. Religion has a set of principles to guide one throughout his or her life. In Zimbabwe there are no religious conflict and no clashes arising due to different religions. Zimbabwe has many religions, the major ones being Christianity, Islam, Judaism and Indigenous religion all which live in peace. Followers of each religion are free to worship to their God in the way they want. There are no reports of societal abuse or discrimination based on religious affiliation, belief and practice.

2. Encourages unity

Reduces violence and conflicts through unity, cooperation, development and promotion of ethical values. A National Day of Prayer is set aside in Zimbabwe when denominations come together to pray. On the 25th of May 2012 the leadership and members of the Apostolic and Zionist churches gathered at Harare Grounds to pray for the nation. Organisations such as the Zimbabwe Council of churches, the Evangelical Fellowship of Zimbabwe, the Zimbabwe Christian Alliance and the Zimbabwe Catholic Bishops Conference bring different denominations together and work together. Also, at weddings, two churches can unite to join the two in a holy matrimony and this unity is also noted at funerals. Mourners at a funeral attend putting on their uniforms and all pastors present can take party at the burial service to show unity.

3. Protects other freedoms

People are free to respond to God and act on religious commitment according to their understandings of his command. The Seventh Day Adventist and other apostolic sects are free to observe the Sabbath as the day of worship. People are allowed to pray anywhere on their sacred places be it on the crossroads or under a tree. The Roman Catholics worship in a building whilst the white garment churches worship under trees and open spaces.

4. Religious institutions

There is an increase in the number of religious institutions such as schools and universities. For example, Gokomere High School is for the Catholics. The Salvation Army has four secondary boarding schools and four social service institutions in Zimbabwe for example the Bumhudzo Home for the elderly in Chitungwiza. The Seventh Day Adventist Church has boarding and day schools in the country and Solusi University in Bulawayo.

5. Employment opportunities

Many people are employed in mission institutions as classroom practitioners, office workers and ancillary staff. They are also headquarters for different religions, for example, the Jewish head offices in Harare. Such institutions offer employment. Pastors of different denominations earn a living through giving their services in churches.

6. Provides a sense of purpose and identity

People live their lives based on their foundation provided by their religion. Religion provides its devotees with lessons, guidelines, values, morals and principles that need to be observed in order to achieve and obtain promises, comforts or rewards. The Zion Christian Church members are easily identified with the badges, the white garment churches are identified with their white robes. During funerals it is the fellow brethren who lead burial services.

7. Fosters respect

It promotes a sense of community and shared values. The Varembe people do not eat meat killed by someone who does not share the same beliefs with them so there are butcheries meant for people of such beliefs. People respect each other in religion. The followers of Masowe address one another with a title *madzimai* if one is a female and *madzibaba* for a male person.

Disadvantages of freedom of worship

Freedom of worship brings with it problems. These include:

Creates division – people tend to stick to those who have similar religious beliefs with them and avoid those who are different hence dividing communities. For example, Muslims and Christians are divided along differences in religious beliefs while intra division is seen in the Johanne Masowe apostolic church which has several sects like Johanne Masowe wechishanu, Johanne Masowe Jerusalema, Johanne Masowe Esnai, Johanne Masowe wenguvo Tsvuku (Mitchell) and Vadzidzi VaJesu led by the late madzidzibaba Wimbo.

Promotes discrimination – people from different religions might look upon individuals with different religious beliefs as inferior or subordinate to them. For example, believers in Pentecostal churches boast of having the gift of the Holy Spirit and regard those in mainline churches as churches which do not have the Holy Spirit. This can create discrimination and hostility among people within communities.

People might use religion to justify wrong doings – some individuals and organisations use religion to justify their wrong doings. For example, the denial of religious followers to seek medical attention in Johanne Masowe under the pretext of freedom of worship endanger human lives. This may result in followers of that church changing their religion to the other one which allows people to seek medical attention.

Cultural decay or erosion – religion such as Christianity views Indigenous religion as a religion which encourages ancestor worship instead of worshipping God. This leads to indigenous cultural decay as people shun their religion in preference of Christianity. Furthermore, African identity is lost because of freedom of worship as people try to change their identities to make them fit into the new religion adopted.

Opposing beliefs – Freedom of worship leads to the growing of opposing beliefs within the same religion enjoying freedom of worship. For example, different interpretations of scripture in Christianity results in different religious doctrines.

Activity 12.5 Debate

Debate on the benefits of freedom of worship in Zimbabwe.

Activity 12.6 Research work

Research on different churches you have in your community and take note of how the believers feel on having religious liberty.

Exercise 12.3

Everyone has the right to freedom of worship.

- | | |
|--|-----|
| (a) What is freedom of worship? | [2] |
| (b) List any four religions practiced in Zimbabwe. | [4] |
| (c) Describe any three benefits of freedom of worship. | [6] |
| (d) Explain the disadvantages of freedom of worship. | [8] |

Interesting facts

The Disabled Persons Act is the primary law that addresses disability in Zimbabwe. This Act provides for the welfare and rehabilitation of persons with disability.

Summary of the chapter

- The elderly people have their rights such as to have freedom of choice, to have dignity, to have adequate health care among others.
- Disability does not mean inability. The disabled should be self-reliant and realise their full potential.
- The disabled have a right to state funded education and training. The state should provide special facilities to cater for the disabled's education.
- The chapter lastly identified the advantages and disadvantages of freedom of worship. In Zimbabwe everyone has the right to freedom of religion and belief.
- A different interpretation of scripture leads to having different beliefs.
- People's freedom is protected by religious liberty for people respond to God according to their understanding.
- Organisations such as The National Council of Disabled People of Zimbabwe (NCDPZ), Zimbabwe Down Syndrome Association (ZDSA), Zimbabwe Parents of Handicapped Children Association (ZPHCA) and Zimbabwe Association of the Visually Handicapped (ZAHV) are there to protect the rights of the disabled.
- Disability exists in Zimbabwe mainly due to diseases, war, conflicts, malnutrition, accidents, abnormal births, hereditary characteristics and many others.

Glossary of terms

Amenities	– circumstance that is welcome and makes life easier or more pleasant.
Autonomy	– freedom to act or function independently.
Cultural decay	– it is when a culture no longer holds any value and is slowly cast aside in favour of new trends.
Disability	– a physical or mental condition which makes it difficult or impossible for the person concerned to adequately fulfil his or her normal role in society.
Disabled Peoples Act	– it is the primary law that addresses disability in Zimbabwe providing for their welfare and rehabilitation.
Discrimination	– distinct treatment of an individual or group to their disadvantage; treatment or consideration based on class or category rather than individual merit.
Elderly	– a person who is seventy years of age and above.
Exploitation	– taking advantage of someone as a result of his or her situation.
Freedom of religion	– the right to choose a religion without interference by the government.

Maltreatment	– treating someone in a harmful or cruel manner.
Rehabilitation	– to go through a process to recover.
Rights	– these are entitlements one has by virtue of being a human.

Revision Exercises

Structured Questions

1. The elderly are the custodians of our culture.

- (a) Define the term rights? [2]
- (b) List any four rights of the elderly in Zimbabwe. [4]
- (c) Explain any three of the rights you have mentioned above. [6]
- (d) Give the importance of the elderly in Zimbabwe. [8]

2. Disability does not mean inability.

- (a) What is disability? [2]
- (b) Name any four organisations that protect and provide welfare for the disabled in Zimbabwe. [4]
- (c) State any six causes of disability in Zimbabwe. [6]
- (d) Suggest any four ways in which Zimbabweans can help people living with disability. [8]

3. Freedom of worship has its benefits on people.

- (a) What is freedom of worship? [2]
- (b) Give four advantages of freedom of worship. [4]
- (c) State six disadvantages of freedom of worship. [6]
- (d) Suggest any four ways freedom of worship has benefited people in Zimbabwe. [8]

4. Organisations for the disabled protects the rights of the disabled.

- (a) What are the rights of the disabled? [2]
- (b) Identify four organisations that cater for the welfare of the disabled. [4]
- (c) Explain how the organisations you have mentioned help to protect the rights of the disabled. [6]
- (d) Suggest any four ways in which Zimbabweans can help the elderly. [8]

5. The elderly people have a right to adequate health care.

- (a) Explain briefly the right to adequate health care of the elderly. [2]
- (b) State any four rights of the elderly. [4]
- (c) How do the people in your community treat the elderly? [6]
- (d) Discuss any four organisations that protect the rights of the elderly in Zimbabwe. [8]

Essay Questions

- 6. Write explanatory notes on the rights of the elderly. [25]
- 7. Explain the rights of persons with disabilities. [25]
- 8. Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of freedom of worship. [25]
- 9. Describe the measures the government can take to guarantee rights of persons with disabilities. [25]
- 10. State the importance of recognising the rights of the elderly. [25]

EXAMINATION II

PAPER 1

Structured Questions

Time: 2 hours 30 minutes

Answer **five** questions.

Choose at least **one** question from each section.

Each question carries 20 marks.

SECTION A: INDIGENOUS RELIGION

1. The family is always regarded as the first stage of socialisation.

- (a) What is a family? [2]
- (b) Mention any four types of families. [4]
- (c) State three characteristic features of a family. [6]
- (d) Explain four ways in which families depend on each other. [8]

2. Indigenous religion helps in perpetuating informal education.

- (a) Define informal education. [2]
- (b) List four ways in which Indigenous religion facilitate the education of children. [4]
- (c) State the roles played by educators in Indigenous religion. [6]
- (d) Explain four positive impact of religion in informal education. [8]

3. People with disabilities have been treated differently from one community to another in Indigenous religion.

- (a) What is disability? [2]
- (b) Give four examples of disability in Indigenous religion. [4]
- (c) State three ways in which disability is perceived in Indigenous religion. [6]
- (d) Suggest four ways in which the disabled people are treated in Indigenous religion. [8]

SECTION B: JUDAISM

4. Judaism emphasises the need to preserve our natural resources.

- (a) Define the term, 'natural resources'. [2]
- (b) State four examples of natural resources. [4]
- (c) Explain three attitudes of Judaism towards natural resources. [6]
- (d) Outline four Jewish methods of environmental preservation. [8]

5. Disability is something considered as a gift or a curse from God.

- (a) Define a curse. [2]
- (b) Identify any four causes of disability in Judaism. [4]
- (c) State three causes of disability according to Judaism. [6]
- (d) Outline Jewish methods of environmental preservation. [8]

SECTION C: CHRISTIANITY

6. Christianity has contributed a lot to the growth of education in Zimbabwe.

- (a) What is Christianity? [2]
- (b) Mention any four religious denominations in Christianity. [4]
- (c) State three educational institutions that are being run by Christian denominations. [6]
- (d) Explain four positive impact of Christianity on education in Zimbabwe. [8]

7. Christians believe chronic conditions attack people because of their sins.

- (a) What are chronic conditions? [2]
- (b) State four examples of chronic conditions in Christianity. [4]
- (c) Explain three causes of chronic conditions in Christianity. [6]
- (d) Outline four ways in which people with chronic conditions are treated in Christianity. [8]

8. Christians view humans as obligated to act justly towards nature and the environment.

- (a) Define nature. [2]
- (b) State four aspects of nature and the environment. [4]
- (c) Explain three ways humans misuse natural resources. [6]
- (d) Describe four ways Christians can preserve nature and the environment. [8]

SECTION D: ISLAM

9. Muslims have over the years, engaged in environmental awareness campaigns.

- (a) Explain the term, 'environmental awareness campaign'. [2]
- (b) List four sayings and proverbs from the Prophet Muhammad about protection of the natural environment. [4]
- (c) State three attitudes of Muslims to the environment. [6]
- (d) Explain four environmental preservation measures in Islam. [8]

10. Allah can give disability as a test to the victim.

- (a) What is a test? [2]
- (b) Give four forms of disability according to Islam. [4]
- (c) Describe three forms of disability in Islam. [6]
- (d) Explain four Islamic perceptions of disability. [8]

PAPER 2: ESSAY QUESTIONS

2 hours

Answer **four** questions.

Choose **one** question from each section.

SECTION A: INDIGENOUS RELIGION

1. Explain the role of Indigenous religion in fostering African identity. [25]
2. Discuss the impact of Indigenous religion on informal education in Zimbabwe. [25]
3. Describe the link between Indigenous religion and societal beliefs on sexuality. [25]

SECTION B: JUDAISM

4. Explain Jewish religious perceptions about disability. [25]
5. Discuss the perceptions of the Jews towards the natural environment. [25]
6. Explain Jewish religious beliefs on chronic conditions. [25]

SECTION C: CHRISTIANITY

7. Illustrate how Christians preserve the natural environment. [25]
8. Describe the positive and negative impact of Christianity on formal education in Zimbabwe. [25]
9. Explain the measures taken by Christianity in promoting the rights of the disabled people. [25]

SECTION D: ISLAM

10. Discuss the part played by Muslims towards the promotion of education in Zimbabwe. [25]
11. What has the Islamic religion done to instil the spirit of inter-dependency among families? [25]
12. Discuss various measures that have been taken by Muslims to protect the environment. [25]

Chapter

13

RELIGION AND CONFLICT MANAGEMENT

Chapter objectives

By the end of this chapter, you should be able to:

- identify causes of conflict at community level.
- explain religious causes of conflict at community level.
- identify religious efforts at managing conflict at community level.
- identify the impact of conflict.

Introduction

Conflict is endemic in every society. The severity of conflict may differ from one society to the other. In this chapter, various causes of conflict at family and at community level will be identified and explained. The chapter also explains religious efforts that are used with the objective of managing conflict and minimising the impact of conflict at community level. This is because religion has the power to influence decisions which result in peace building and community development.

UNIT 13.1 LEVELS OF CONFLICT IN THE COMMUNITY

Conflict can be defined in different ways. It can be defined as disagreements between two people over an important issue. It can also be an argument over a pertinent issue, where people exhibit diametrically opposed views. The friction or discord that arises in a conflict can be due to beliefs or actions that are resisted by the opposing group of people. In a conflict, agreements tend to be difficult to accomplish.

A community refers to a small or large social unit that has something in common in terms of norms, values, religion and identity. Conflicts begin at family level which may affect the wider community at large. Conflict can begin at family level where a husband may have a disagreement with his wife, where parents can be opposed to the views of their children. People living in the same community may differ in a number of issues such as religion, political differences, social disagreements, economic differences or a combination of them all which result in the brewing of conflict. There are generally, five levels of conflict which include intrapersonal conflict, where an individual is being stressed by certain things and struggling to solve sticking issues by themselves. In this case, the individual does not seek the assistance of someone else to solve their challenges but try on their own to work out solutions to their problems.

1. Intrapersonal conflict

This is conflict which is found within an individual person. It is the first level of conflict.

2. Interpersonal conflict

Interpersonal conflict is a conflict between individuals. Two people may disagree over an issue. Such disagreements are difficult to reconcile as both individuals tend to pull in their own direction.

3. Intra-group conflict

Intra-group conflict arises in a group of persons with a defined structure. There tend to emerge differences in opinion that may result in diametrically opposed viewpoints usually difficult to reconcile. This is usually common in groups that are hierarchical. Differences in status can create divergence in views and the result is conflict.

4. Intergroup conflict

In the case of intergroup conflict, different groups, usually pursuing similar or different goals, can raise conflicts. Competition between such groups can create conflict particularly in situations where one group appears to outclass another in terms of performance and levels of success. Groups tend to outdo one another and fail to share views and ideas, hence, conflict.

5. Intra-organisational conflict

This is the fifth level of conflict which is the intra-organisational conflict. Here, members of an organisation tend to disagree over various issues that have to do with positions of the members within that organisation. Generally, the top leadership impose their will on subordinates, leading to stiff resistance thereby creating conflict.

Causes of conflict at community level

(a) Competition for scarce resources

In situations where resources are scarce, conflict arises. People living in the same community usually have disagreements over distribution of resources such as land for crop farming and pasture and the general utilisation of other natural resources such as water, firewood and even wild animals. Community leadership often fight battles with community members over the control and use of resources, particularly where there is scramble for scarce resources.

(b) Differences in expectations

Communities are made up of people of varying ideologies, beliefs and expectations. Differences among these factors contribute to misunderstanding and friction among community members. Normally, the community leadership have their own expectations which are then resisted by their subjects, thereby creating conflict.

(c) Poor communication

Community leaders who do not convene regular meetings with their people often create chasms between them and the people they lead. Meetings are necessary platforms for communication and airing views and sentiments. Where this is not the case, community members get divided over sticky issues and so, conflict arises. If community members feel that their leaders are failing to pay due attention to their grievances, friction develops.

(d) Class dominance

Societies are made up of classes. Social status of individuals and groups of people in a community result in individual and group differences. In normal cases, the affluent always try to impose their will on the disadvantaged members of the community and that creates resistance and conflict.

(e) Political differences

Communities are made up of people with different political affiliations. There is an element of fanaticism in politics and affiliates, usually do not agree in terms of their political persuasions which create conflict. In some cases, political differences may lead to violent confrontations and divisions in one community.

(f) Unemployment

The youth, who normally constitute the majority in any given community, lack per-occupational tasks resulting in social unrest which leads to conflict. They normally roam around the community and vending their frustration that emanates from being unemployed on elders in the community. Values and norms of the community are disregarded by the unemployed youth who are often at loggerheads with the elders of the community on ethics and other societal expectations. The variance create conflict as the youth get pre-occupied in drugs, alcohol and sexual abuse.

(g) Religious differences

Conflicts are also caused by religious differences whereby people of diverging religious persuasions vary on beliefs and practices. Religious beliefs cultivate fundamentalism which results in strong religious differences thereby creating conflict. In some cases, religious differences may lead to fighting, destruction of property, loss of life and divisions within the community.

Activity 13.1 Discussion

In groups, discuss major instances of conflict among people living in your community.

Activity 13.2 Drawing

In groups, try to identify various reasons for conflicts in your community. As individuals, draw pie charts showing the extent of the causes of such conflicts and try to justify the differences in the causes highlighted by the pie charts.

Exercise 13.1

Answer the following questions with True or False.

1. A community has the same values, norms, religion and identity.
2. Differences at family level do not create conflict.
3. There are five levels of conflict.
4. Good communication skills result in conflict.
5. Politics and religion are the fundamental factors which cause conflict in many communities.
6. Unemployment does not result in social unrest which breed conflict.

UNIT 13.2 RELIGIOUS CAUSES OF CONFLICT

Religious conflict is conflict which starts and escalates because of differences in religious beliefs and practices. It should be noted that communities have people of varying religious beliefs and practices. Differences in such beliefs and practices create differences in religious views. The operation of Judaism, Christianity, Islam and Indigenous religion has ushered in religious conflicts in the religious landscape of various communities. Religious conflicts have hampered national development as well as encouraged suspicion, reprisal attacks, disunity, acrimony and rancour among the adherents of these religions. Each group of believers tend to defend their faith, disregarding the others. Even in communities where one religion such as Christianity is dominant, the denominations that branch out may differ in their liturgical systems resulting in conflict.

Religious causes of conflict at community level

(a) Differences in belief systems

Where religious groups in a community differ in terms of key doctrines, there tend to be conflict. Believers do not want to compromise their beliefs, as a result, believers fight to the end, in defence of their faith. This explains why in Islam, Muslims fight Holy Wars (Jihad) and also Christians embark on crusades, all this is done to defend what they believe in. Some believers go to the extent of sacrificing their lives and dying as martyrs, faithfully expecting to attain eternal life, having died defending their faith. Conflict in such cases is of high magnitude as holy wars, by their nature, are difficult to stop. The Jihads in West African Muslim States usually take long to stop. A good example is the September 11, 2001 attack by the Al-Qaeda. Muslims prefer to die as martyrs and such levels of conflict are of high magnitude. Usually, countries at war attract sympathisers who quickly cheer in to rescue their ally. This may result in conflict of high magnitude, leading to world war.

(b) Religious identity

Religions are known due to their emblems, symbols and physical structures such as temples, synagogues, mosques or shrines. Any form of infringement on identities by another religion may create fierce resistance and violent protests. Religious groups keep their boundaries and any attempt by another religious group to encroach into such boundaries create severe conflict that may cause bloodshed. This is exemplified with the Budiriro religious conflict which happened in 2014 where the police were beaten by Madzibaba Ishmael and his followers for approaching the shrine with shoes.

(c) Infidels

Attempts by various religious groups to expand their territories and increase their numbers through unscrupulous means may attract stiff resistance. Some religious groups clash with others when there is a deliberate attempt to sway the beliefs of other religions in order to achieve religious capture. Trying to hoodwink infidels – people of divergent faith, may result in conflict.

(d) Religious extremism

Some believers are die-hards. They tend to go to the extreme ends in terms of their beliefs. Even in situations where they happen to follow blind and unreasoned religious practices, they fight to the extreme end to defend what they believe in and are very difficult to convince otherwise. In such scenarios, conflict is bound to exist.

(e) Discrimination

Religious organisations enjoying huge following usually look down upon emerging religious groups. Because of their status and popularity, they often clash with smaller church groups especially in situations where they want to impose their dominance on religious minority groups.

(f) Labelling

This is when one religion or religious group labels the other as practicing unorthodox religious systems. One religion may label and attack the other one in terms of their shrines, regalia or as practicing Satanism. Groups on the receiving end of such attacks tend to resist in one way or the other resulting in conflict. For example, the religious conflict between Prophet Walter Magaya and the African Initiated Church in 2015 whereby Prophet Magaya attacked members of the Johanne Masowe of the apostolic sect for using marine spirits and the sect responded attacking Prophet Magaya for using power from snake. Religions follow diverse religious practices. In multi-religious communities, there are differences in religious observances such as observing the Sabbath, Ramadan, Easter and others. In such cases, conflict arises as different groups

observe holy days differently. Some religious groups may not find essence in some shrines or sanctuaries and other places considered holy. When religious groups disregard the holiness of certain sacred places and trample upon them, conflict arises.

Activity 13.3 Research work

Carry out a research on the causes of conflict in the locality and give feedback to the whole class.

Activity 13.4 Debate

Divide the class into two groups. One group should gather information to support the topic, the other group seeks to oppose it. Topic; "Is it worthwhile for different religions to disagree with other religions on religious matters?"

Exercise 13.2

Religious conflict is affecting many communities.

- | | |
|--|-----|
| (a) What is a religious conflict? | [2] |
| (b) State any four causes of religious conflict. | [4] |
| (c) Explain the role of religion in breeding conflict. | [8] |

UNIT 13.3 ROLE OF RELIGION IN CONFLICT MANAGEMENT

Religion can do more to try and quell various forms of conflict. While it can be argued that conflict is inevitable, a lot can be done to lessen, if not eradicate religious conflict. The following are some of the roles of religion in conflict management:

(a) Religious tolerance

It is mandatory upon various religious groups to preach the message of tolerance towards other religions with diverse religious views. Intolerance breeds hate in communities where there is religious pluralism. Mere recognition of the existence of other religious groups is key in promoting acceptance and peace.

(b) Accommodating others

It has already been alluded to that communities are made up of people with diverse cultural, religious, tribal and racial backgrounds. It is therefore, the duty of religious groups to incorporate this divergence and accommodate people with diverse backgrounds. It is this understanding of differences among people in communities that can foster the spirit of togetherness and living together in harmony.

(c) Respect for others

It is important for religious groups to have a big role in fostering respect for other people with different religious observances instead of adopting a rather confrontational approach to their beliefs and practices. Communities should respect sacred places, shrines and other religious observances and some holidays for different religions.

(d) Compromise

Religious groups can manage conflict by preaching the gospel of compromising. A big brother attitude among religious groups can only further exacerbate the situation. It should learn to forego its unheralded claim of supremacy and accept emerging and upcoming religious groups to avoid conflict. There are church groups like the Prophetic Healing and Deliverance Ministries led by Walter Magaya that attract huge gatherings. They have to co-operate with other emerging church groups and do not interfere in their operations.

(e) Communication

It is important for various organisations and religious institutions to regularly meet to try and iron out any differences they might have, in a peaceful and harmonious way. Lack of communication can lead to conflict. Religious groups can organise prayer meetings where they embrace each other for the good of the communities in which they are all living.

Conflict management

Conflict management strategies seek to move conflict parties away from certain positions towards positive outcomes. The only alternative is for the parties concerned to regulate and manage conflict so that it can be prevented from escalation. On the contrary, conflict resolution involves a variety of approaches aimed at stopping conflicts through the constructive solving of problems, distinct from conflict management or conflict transformation. Conflict resolution is a set of principles geared towards encouraging warring parties to seek peace.

(a) Dialogue

Dialogue is a strategy used in conflict management which involves the talking together or a talk between people or groups with the intention of exchanging ideas for better appreciation and understanding of each other amidst diverse religious viewpoints. Dialogue is not a mere conversation that takes place between persons, but it means an exchange of ideas or views or opinions between groups. The two parties should be able to listen to one another. For example, a religious conflict in the Apostolic Faith Mission church requires the talking of two parties, the Reverend Madziyire group and the Reverend Chiyangwa group. Dialogue takes place between two or more persons or groups who share different views. In dialogue, there is a communication between groups that is aimed at explaining and enlightening each other so that both parties can reach a common understanding.

(b) Mediation

In situations where conflicts are rampant, communities can engage high profile personalities to play the mediatory role so that people with almost irreconcilable differences can try to find each other and work together. Mediation is important in fostering the spirit of tolerance and acceptance. A good example is that of Father Fidelis Mukonori of the Roman Catholic Church who mediated on the conflict between the former and the late president Robert Mugabe and the army generals in November 2017.



Fig. 13.3 Father Fidelis Mukonori (second from left) mediating the dialogue in Zimbabwe

(c) Conformity

Religion can play an important role in managing conflict through encouraging communities to conform to the laws of the land. In every community, there are some constitutional provisions that must be adhered to and any deviation from such constitutional requirements is met with the full wrath of the law. Mere observance of the law helps bring peace and avoidance of whatever conflicting interests there may be. A good example is when the Apostolic Church members fought the police, refusing to vacate areas of worship. The late Madzibaba Wimbo, as a religious practitioner, had to intervene to stop further clashes between the police and the Vapositori as this was against the law.

(d) Peace campaigns by churches

Churches conduct peace campaigns in which they advocate for peace. For example, in June 2017 the heal Zimbabwe which is a group of Christians composed of the Catholic Commission of Justice and Peace, Prayer Network of Zimbabwe, Zimbabwe Pastors' Fellowship, Christian Leaders Forum, Ecumenical Church Leaders' Forum, Zimbabwe Christian Alliance and Zimbabwe Divine Destiny conducted a peace campaign where they were lobbying for a conflict and violent free 2018 elections. The role of the church is to encourage peace and cultivate the spirit of peace among citizens which is important for nation building.

Obstacles to conflict management

1. Syncretism

Syncretism means mixing one's religious beliefs with the beliefs of other religions. Every religion holds its beliefs and practices dearly and no religion will like to be syncretic. For fear of syncretism, no religion wants to enter into dialogue with other religions so that it can avoid any form of influence by other religions. This often leads to church divisions or sects.

2. Reluctance to compromise

Compromise refers to an agreement made between two people or groups in which each side gives up some of the things they want so that both sides finally reach a compromise. Because of fundamental differences, it is difficult to compromise as religions do not want to give into some religious beliefs and adopt some of the beliefs of other religions. To do this may lead to compromise of one's faith which is forbidden by the religions. In this case, conflict management will not thrive in an environment where there is arrogance among the adherents of the conflicting religions.

3. Retaliation

Religious conflicts leave an indelible mark and great suffering. Believers will be having inflicted wounds which lead to agitation for retaliation by the aggrieved religious groups against their opponents whom they regard as enemies of their faiths. In that situation, dialogue is misunderstood by the aggrieved parties as a means of depriving them an opportunity to retaliate against their perceived enemies.

UNIT 13.4 IMPACT OF CONFLICT

Since conflict is almost common in every society, its prevalence may have both positive and negative impact on the society. However, if left unresolved, conflict may have disastrous consequences that are detrimental to community development. The following are some notable results of conflict in a community, both positive and negative.

Positive impact of conflict

- People may not always agree on everything. Differences that emerge in a community may be the engine that drives divergent views forward for the good of the community.
- Conflict may be a drive towards ridding off cruel leaders who rule with an iron fist at the expense of development.
- Those who succumb to defeat in a conflicting environment, can facilitate a peaceful state of affairs in community.
- Sometimes freedom can be attained through revolutionary means. A community under conflict may give room to people to try to redeem themselves and become masters of their own destiny.
- Conflict is good in areas where there is demand for democracy, instead of relying on a dictatorial leadership which does not give room for divergent thinking.

Negative impact of conflict at community level

- Normally conflict is associated with hate speech and violence which is not good for development.
- People in a conflicting environment have no sense of commonality and lose focus on community progress.
- A community of people with diametrically opposed viewpoints is characterised by hardships and suffering of its members.
- Where there is conflict, social cohesion is non-existent. Relations among families and friends become sour.
- Confrontations and violence leave people injured physically and emotionally. The situation is made worse if expenses are incurred as the injured seek treatment as a result of conflict.
- Conflict may result in infrastructural destruction, where houses, church buildings or shrines, are destroyed making it costly to re-construct.
- Areas marred with conflict are usually deserted, remain desolate and underdeveloped. Community members are forced to disperse.
- Children, the disabled and the aged receive the full wrath of the effects of a conflict in a conflict-infested community because they are the most vulnerable groups.

Negative impact of conflict at family level

- Family members can get injured, especially where conflict turns violent.
- Conflict among family members can result in separation, with family members living apart from one another.
- Divorce cases arise in families where there is conflict, leaving children without parental care and support.
- In families where there is conflict, members tend to develop anti-social behaviour patterns like heavy drinking of alcohol or drug abuse.
- Families may live in fear of sudden attack from enemies, real and perceived.

Negative impact of conflict at national level

- Conflict at national level can cause widespread migration, people seeking greener pastures in countries that are politically and socially stable.
- Citizens face hardships and there is marked suffering due to conflict which is detrimental to development of a country.
- People who flee their country of origin due to conflict live in other countries as refugees at refugee camps characterised by poor living conditions.
- Violent clashes leave infrastructure destroyed, making it difficult and expensive to restore and rebuild.
- In a conflicting nation, service delivery is at its lowest ebb leaving citizens neglected.
- Conflict usually attract calamities like disease outbreaks such as cholera and typhoid due to poor service delivery and lack of co-operation from the powers that be.
- Conflict scare away investors in any nation thereby leading to economic challenges.
- Conflict may lead to civil wars.

Activity 13.5 Educational tour

Organise a visit to a local community leadership to try and establish causes of conflict in the area and possible measures that can be put in place in order to reduce the negative effects of conflict.

Exercise 13.4

1. Describe the role of religion in conflict management.

[25]

Interesting facts

1. In every community throughout the world, conflicts are an inevitable phenomenon.

Summary of chapter

- This chapter has explored the causes of conflict at community level.
- Explanations on religious causes of conflict at community level were given.
- A number of religious efforts aimed at managing conflict at community level were identified.
- Both positive and negative consequences of conflict at community level were discussed in detail.
- Religious conflict may result in severe confrontations leading to wars and destruction of property.
- Conflict can be the engine that drives divergent views forward, for the good of the community.
- Relations among families and friends sour where there is conflict.
- There is destruction of infrastructure in areas of conflict.
- Children suffer the brand of a divorce due to conflict in a family
- Conflict is detrimental to economic growth of a nation.

Glossary of terms

At loggerheads	– strongly disagreeing.
Community	– a group of people living in the same area.
Conflict	– a serious disagreement or argument.
Desolate	– a place which is uninhabited.
Detrimental	– tending to cause harm.
Diametrically opposed	– being at extreme opposite.
Exacerbate	– worsening a situation or a problem.
Inevitable	– certain to happen, unavoidable.
Infringement	– the action of breaking the terms of the law.
Unorthodox	– contrary to what is usually accepted.

Revision Exercises

Structured Questions

1. Conflict is inevitable in every community.

- (a) What is conflict? [2]
- (b) Identify any four examples of conflict in a community. [4]
- (c) Explain three examples of conflict at community level. [6]
- (d) Suggest four ways of solving conflict at community level. [8]

2. There are religious causes of conflict at community level.

- (a) Define the word community. [2]
- (b) Identify any four causes of religious conflicts in a community. [4]
- (c) Explain three causes of religious conflict in a community. [6]

(d) State four community leaders and suggest what they can do to solve conflicts at community level.
[8]

3. There are various causes of conflict at community level.

- (a) Define conflict. [2]
- (b) Outline four causes of conflict at community level. [4]
- (c) Mention three forms of conflict in a community. [6]
- (d) Suggest four positive impact of conflict in a community. [8]

Essay Questions

- 1. Explain causes of conflicts in a community. [25]
- 2. Explain the impact of conflicts on a community. [25]
- 3. Discuss the role of religion in compacting conflicts at community level. [25]
- 4. Describe any five religious causes of conflict. [25]
- 5. Write explanatory notes on the negative consequences of conflict at community level. [25]

Chapter

14

RELIGION AND ENTERPRISE

Chapter objectives

By the end of this chapter, you should be able to:

- explain the various forms of enterprise.
- describe the positive impact of religion on technology use and enterprise.

Introduction

There are various forms of enterprise and technology. Religion has positive and negative impact on technology and enterprise. An assessment of the negative impact of religion on technology and enterprise can be done. There are various religious teachings that encourage enterprise and technology.

UNIT 14.1 RELIGION AND ENTERPRISE

Enterprise can be defined as doing business. It can be a project or undertaking. Some would want to refer to it as buying and selling. Enterprise can also mean other purposeful endeavour. An example of enterprise is someone taking an initiative to start a business. Religion and enterprise are inseparable as many religious people are found enterprising.

Religion and enterprise have throughout history interacted in ways that influence socio-cultural evolution. There are many enterprises that are religious based. These include;



Fig. 14.1 Muslims at pilgrimage

Religious tourism is at the centre of some countries' economy as they rely on religious tourism. Examples of religious tourism include Islamic Hajj and Vatican tourism. The hotels and markets of important religious places are a source of income to the locals as many people travel and stay at the sacred places. In Zimbabwe Apostolic Faith Mission (AFM) Rufaro Holy place is a hive of activity when people visit the place in April for religious purposes. Businesses like the bread industry benefit a lot.

Food processing – this industry is also religious based. This has to do with **Halaal**. Halaal products comprise of \$ 2 trillion industries.

The **kosher** industry has as of 2003 certified more than 100 000 businesses which totals approximately US 165 billion in sales.

Types of enterprise

- Micro enterprise
- Small enterprise
- Medium enterprise
- Macro enterprise

Forms of enterprise

Public cooperation - in this form the shares are traded publicly and a large number holds the share.

These are usually owned by the government for example the Grain Marketing Board, Air Zimbabwe and the National Railways of Zimbabwe.

Sole trader – this involves a person taking up business on his or her own and single ownership. It does not involve any legal formalities. Little capital is required to start the business. All profits and all loss accrue to the owner.

Partnership – is a relationship between partners who have agreed to share profits of a business. They share the capital, property, ideas, profits and losses. They use one trade name.

Public limited company - it operates as a separate entity from its owners. It is run and owned by the shareholders. The directors form a board that leads. The number of directors is determined by the size of the company.

Private limited company - it is a business that limits the owner's liability to their shares and there is a limited number of shareholders. The shares are not allowed to be publicly traded.

Positive impact of religion on enterprise

There is a positive impact of religion on enterprise. If people are religious, it will have a positive impact on their businesses. It is common knowledge that religious people are good business people, they usually have good business ethics. A business conducted with commendable business ethics will thrive.

- A business owner may need to lean on their religion to deal with hurdles of their business. Religion may impact their business as a whole.
- How can an entrepreneur do their business or the rules they follow, their ethics, and guidelines, can be attributed to their religion, so religion is of paramount significance on how business people conduct themselves.
- Many religions view that business is a trust from the Supreme Being and people must follow the principles set by the Supreme Being in terms of how to run their businesses.
- In all religions, there is need for fair dealings when conducting businesses.
- Encourages unity among the workers.
- Respect for the people involved in business.
- Humility – this has to do with humbleness character. All religions encourage their adherents to be humble and to know that they are all creation of a deity and this would result in good business dealings.
- Trust – when conducting business this aspect is of great importance, this applies to all people involved in enterprise, the producers, the employees and even customers. This trust encourages business to grow and most religions encourage trust and if people are religious, they will in turn be trustworthy. For example, a person may pay for goods not in stock trusting to get them as required but if there is no trust, they will not be free to pay beforehand and sometimes this is disadvantageous to the supplier.
- Encourages honesty – all religions studied for this curriculum have shown beyond doubt that they all teach about honesty and if businesses are based on this religious aspect, they will indeed become

very successful business. If businesses are honest clients will have confidence in them and this is of great significance when conducting business.

- Fair salaries encouraged – religion helps employers with guidelines on how to treat their employees or workers. For example, in Christianity it is written in the New Testament that they should be given their rightful wages, unjust salaries are discouraged and if one follows these religious practices the workforce will do its best for the good of the company.
- Religion creates employment for a lot of people who sell various things at church conferences. For example, the annual Apostolic Faith Mission at Rufaro creates business and employment opportunities for many people who sell clothes, food and other items.
- Religion creates employment for a lot of people who sell various items. These include instruments such as shakers and drums, Bibles and Hymn books among others.
- Religion may also encourage tourism which is known as Religious Tourism. People from various parts of the world visit various religious places for assistance.

Negative impact of religion on enterprise

- Time is lost observing sacred days. Religion affects business operations as a believer is obliged to rest on days of religious significance like the Sabbath. Business time is lost through observance of certain sacred days and festival periods.
- Money is lost when businesses close to observe religious activities. When the business is closed for religious reasons, revenue is lost. This has a bearing on the net profit that is accrued over the year. Religion negatively impact on enterprise by affecting revenue inflows.
- There is no compensation for the resources lost whilst attending to religious ceremonies. Many religious followers believe that compensation comes from the Supreme Being through blessings. By attending religious ceremonies no compensation is offered on the loss encountered except having hope in receiving blessings from God.
- The profits are lost because of the offerings, tithes and zakat among others. Christianity and Judaism require a believer to pay 10% tithes from the profit gained from a business activity. This is the same in Islam where 2, 5% to 10% goes towards almsgiving (Zakat). These monthly contributions make the business unviable as money is not invested but is given as a free offering.

Activity 14.1 Group work

In groups, assess the religious impact on technology. Compare the points that you got. And then present to the class.

Activity 14.2 Research work

Find out from your religion how they use technology in the different day to day religious activities then present your findings to the class.

Exercise 14.1

Religion and enterprise are inseparable.

- | | |
|---|-----|
| (a) What is enterprise? | [2] |
| (b) List any four forms of religious enterprise. | [4] |
| (c) Explain how religion negatively affects enterprise. | [8] |

UNIT 14.2 TECHNOLOGY USE AND ENTERPRISE

Nowadays it is very important for any viable business to use technology in business ventures. An enterprise that cannot link itself to technological advances will be tantamount to failing. They need to be technologically advanced. For example, in order to advertise itself an enterprise should advertise itself through the internet and that's information technology, or use of machinery that increase production and reduce human labour all this aid the growth of an enterprise.

Positive impact of religion on technology use

Advances in technology have a way of changing the world around us. Technology has contributed immensely in the development of religions across the globe.

1. It facilitates communication of religious events and activities

Technology enables members of a religion to effectively communicate. For example, the use of emails in notifying followers of religious activities. Emails can be sent to individuals or groups of people who need to be aware of the same information. This has helped in the carrying out of different religious activities and it is of paramount significance. Furthermore, smartphones and texting have also impacted on religious communication. A text number is given to close religious associates. This has been used in many religions as communication is very necessary. Texting is non-disruptive and takes less time than a phone call. Smartphones have helped in the religious activities of many religions as communication has now been made much easier.

2. Planning of religious activities

Technology has also helped in planning of religious activities by enabling meetings to take place conveniently. For example, video conferencing is used to hold meetings among different religious leaders in different parts of the world. People in different locations can meet and conduct a religious meeting without any transport costs. This has aided in the spread of information easily and has helped in the growth of different religions in various places.

3. Spreading of religious beliefs

Religious marketing has been made easy by technology. There are social network sites like the Facebook LinkedIn, Instagram which have helped in the spread of religious doctrines and messages. Religious doctrines are spread to many people. Transport is another technological component that has impacted positively on religion. There are high speed trains and aircraft which have helped in religious activities as people can travel far and wide to spread religion. In Zimbabwe for example, because of transport technology many places have now been reached and the gospel has reached many parts of the country which were inaccessible many years ago. Radios, televisions, have also helped and many religions make use of them to spread their religions and to reach out to adherents. Technology has helped in the printing of reading materials. People now have a variety of religious books to choose from and this has helped in the transmission, spread and development of religion.

4. Provision of spiritual comfort to believers

Radios provide a way for people to be connected to their faith. There are religious programmes that are aired on the radio and many people have the chance to be connected to their faith cheaply and even in the comfort of their homes.

5. Speeding of evangelism

The television has allowed pastors, preachers and religious leaders to reach a much wider audience in a more immense way. Televangelism is now very common because of technology.

6. Promoting religious tolerance

Technology has helped in cultivating religious tolerance. People can now download religious literature and information from anywhere, read and debate on religious issues from all around the world on line. This has cultivated an appreciation of diversity in religious beliefs.

Activity 14.3 Research work

Research on the various forms of enterprise from the commercial department at your school. Discuss your research findings with classmates.

Activity 14.4 Group work

In groups, look for religious teachings that encourage enterprise from the four religions that you are currently studying then present findings to the class.

Exercise 14.2

Technology has impacted on religion.

- | | |
|---|-----|
| (a) What is technology? | [2] |
| (b) List any four forms of technology. | [4] |
| (c) Describe the role of social media in modern day religious activities. | [6] |

Interesting facts

1. Business people as trustees should follow the rules and regulations of God.
2. Members of different religions are taught to refrain from using prohibited ways of wealth creation.
3. Prohibited ways of creating wealth include; fraud, theft and corruption.
4. Technology is making it easier for people to study religion and feel connected to their faith.

Summary of chapter

- The chapter looked at the definitions of the terms technology and enterprise.
- There are different forms of technology and enterprise.
- The positive and negative impact of religion on technology and enterprise have also been looked at.
- For enterprise to be successful there is need for the application of various religious principles such as humility trust among many others.
- If religions and business are carried out side by side the business will be successful.
- Employer-worker relations will be greatly improved and in turn lead to the good of the company.
- Technology has aided in the development of religion.
- Many have been converted to many religions because of technology.
- Communication has been made very easy, it is a very important tool in the spread of religion.

Glossary of terms

Email	– electronic letter.
Endeavour	– an attempt with a lot of effort, to strive to reach a goal.
Enterprise	– doing or conducting business.
Haalal	– refers to what is permitted or lawful in traditional Islamic law especially food and drink.
Hajj	– Islamic religious pilgrimage to Mecca.
Impact	– it is an influence or an effect.
Kosher	– Jewish food that is allowed to be eaten.

Technology	– a device or material with electronic instructions created by a person's mind that is built.
Zakat	– the giving of 2.5% of one's wealth to the poor.

Revision Exercises

Structured Questions

1. There are many forms of enterprise.

- (a) Define enterprise. [2]
- (b) List **four** forms of enterprise. [4]
- (c) Describe how religion can promote enterprise. [6]
- (d) Explain the **four** forms of enterprise mentioned above. [8]

2. Religion and technology are related.

- (a) Define **technology**. [2]
- (b) List **four** forms of technology. [4]
- (c) Describe how religion has been developed by technological use. [6]
- (d) Describe the **four** forms of technology mentioned above. [8]

3. There are advantages of religion on enterprise.

- (a) Define business. [2]
- (b) List **four** advantages of religion on enterprise. [4]
- (c) Describe the disadvantages of religion on enterprise. [6]
- (d) Explain the **four** advantages of religion on enterprise. [8]

4. Religion can also have disadvantages on enterprise.

- (a) Define religion. [2]
- (b) Give **four** disadvantages of religion on enterprise. [4]
- (c) How can one try to solve the above mentioned challenges? [6]
- (d) Describe any **four** business ethics. [8]

Essay Questions

- 5. Write explanatory notes on the religious impact on enterprise and technology. [25]
- 6. Describe the relationship between religion and technology. [25]
- 7. Discuss the positive and negative impact of religion on enterprise. [25]
- 8. Explain the various forms of enterprise. [25]
- 9. Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of religion on enterprise. [25]

Chapter

15

RELIGION AND THE LIBERATION STRUGGLE

Chapter objectives

By the end of this chapter, you should be able to:

- identify the Indigenous religion religious practitioners who participated in Chimurenga 2.
- explain the roles of Indigenous religion practitioners who participated in Chimurenga 2.
- identify the Christian religious practitioners who participated in Chimurenga 2.
- explain the roles of Christian practitioners who participated in Chimurenga 2.

Introduction

The liberation struggle is one of the cherished experiences in the history of Zimbabwe. This chapter focuses on Indigenous religion practitioners who participated in the second liberation struggle as well as Christian practitioners who played an influential role in the liberation struggle. This chapter appreciate the role of religion in the liberation of the oppressed by discussing the contributions of Indigenous religion and Christianity.

UNIT 15.1 ROLE OF INDIGENOUS RELIGION IN CHIMURENGA 2

The success of the liberation struggle lies in the contribution of both indigenous religious practitioners as well as Christian religious practitioners. They both supported the movement through organising, sheltering the freedom fighters and offering psychological, emotional and religious support. Thomas Mapfumo's Chimurenga songs educated people on the reasons for the struggle hence his songs lifted the fighters' spirit in the quest for Zimbabwe's independence

The second Chimurenga was a struggle fought between the Africans and the white Rhodesian government which culminated in the independence of Zimbabwe in 1980. The war started in the early 1960s and ended in 1980 after the signing of the Lancaster House Agreement.



Fig. 15.1 Freedom fighters

The word Chimurenga refers to a violent uprising or revolt. In Ndebele, it is called Umvukela. The black Africans wanted to get political independence, access to economic resources and land. Religion has had a mitigating influence over the political leadership. During the struggle, religion was used as a rallying point for the liberation struggle. The Indigenous religious practitioners during the second Chimurenga include the following:

1. Mediums

A medium is a link between the human world and the spirit world. There were a lot of mediums who played an important role in the liberation struggle as they were consulted by freedom fighters. They acted as personal advisors of the freedom fighters. Below are the functions carried out by mediums.

(i) Mediums gave directions to freedom fighters

Firstly, Mazviona Kawananzaruwa is a female spirit medium and she was a host to the spirit of Nehanda. The medium knew very much about war and was consulted by Urimbo and his guerrillas. She assisted the freedom fighters with directions in a very difficult forest. They were given instructions on food to eat, routes to take, what part of the forest was not allowed to stay in or sleep in and where they were not allowed to fight.

Furthermore, Nehanda Nyakasikana is the most decorated medium of the spirit of Mbuya Nehanda who played a role in liberating Zimbabwe as freedom fighters consulted her and she gave them advice on how to fight the war.

(ii) They taught freedom fighters to interpret religious symbolism and signs

The guerrillas were taught to interpret many signs in the forest which would allow them to live safely and to know when the enemies were near. For example, seeing a fish eagle bird meant the presence of ancestors and the shrill chat of that bird meant the presence of enemies. Symbolism played a crucial role in ensuring the success of the liberation struggle.

(iii) Giving spiritual guidance to freedom fighters

Freedom fighters required spiritual support for the success of the war of liberation. For example, Mbuya Matadzisei Tangwena is a medium who played an important role in the liberation struggle. She was responsible for providing spiritual guidance. Chatunga was a spirit medium who operated in the Zvimba area. Freedom fighters consulted him on the proceedings of the war. He gave encouragement to the fighters and gave portions that were meant for protection, cover their backs and perceive the action of the enemy.

To add on, Nyabapa and Beperere are spirit mediums who operated in Mavhuradonha area where they advised freedom fighters on certain prohibitions not to anger the ancestors who in turn would protect them. They gave advices on when to attack and how to do so. In Manicaland, Muchatera is male spirit medium who operated from Dewedzo in Manicaland and was a medium of the spirit of Chaminuka. With his help and guidance freedom fighters fought the war courageously.

(iv) Provision of material support

Freedom fighters required material support in form of food and shelter. They were assisted with mediums with this material support. For example, Mbuya Tangwena provided food for the people going and returning from Mozambique. Mbuya Tangwena took care of the children who sought refuge at her farm after their parents had either been arrested or fled to Mozambique for the liberation struggle. She assisted thousands of guerrillas to cross into Mozambique and hide from the marauding Rhodesian security forces. In 1975, she assisted President Robert Mugabe and Comrade Edgar Tekere to cross into Mozambique to take over command of the liberation struggle. Sekuru Chipfeni who stayed in Musengezi at Chimoio village in Muzarabani was a spirit medium who provided shelter for freedom fighters during the struggle.

(v) Foretelling

Mediums had a gift of foresight which helped people to be aware of the coming war. For example, Pondai Enos is a male spirit medium who was intimately associated with the objectives and activities of the ZANLA (Zimbabwe National Liberation Army) guerrillas as his predictions helped in the success of the liberation struggle. Chiodzamamera, Chipfeni, Chidyamauyu, Chiwawa and Chinengabere are some other spirit mediums who met and announced the coming of the war. They operated in the Dande area in Mazoe and Centenary. The spirit mediums gave fighters portions to confuse the white soldiers. They predicted on what was to happen and to avoid disaster they would change routes for the guerrillas to avoid being ambushed.

(vi) Influencing people to join the liberation struggle

Many young men and women were influenced by spirit mediums to be freedom fighters. For example, in Mt Darwin there was Gusa Muparavara a medium who influenced the people during the struggle to join and fight white settlers. Following his command, the people followed the guerrillas' instructions and together they fought the war.

2. Chiefs

A chief is a leader with a highest rank in a territory. Chiefs played a pivotal role in the success of the liberation struggle. Some of the notable chiefs who were active in the liberation struggle include Chief Svosve, Chief Kadungure Mapondera, Chief Mashayamombe, Chief Chingaira Makoni and Chief Rekai Tangwena. Some of the roles played by chiefs include:

(i) Organising war with mediums

Chiefs worked together with spirit mediums in organising war by uniting people to fight white settlers. For example, Chief Mapondera and Chief Svosve organised war against the whites in Mashonaland East. They were assisted with spirit mediums.

(ii) Providing material support to freedom fighters

Freedom fighters required material things like food, shelter and medicine which they were given by mediums. For example, Chief Rekayi Tangwena provided freedom fighters with food. Chief Chingaira Makoni also supported freedom fighters with food and shelter.

(iii) Leading in the liberation struggle

Chiefs were also leaders during the war of liberation especially during the first Chimurenga. In Matebeleland chiefs like Ndiweni and Sithole were leaders of the first Chimurenga. In Mashonaland areas, Chief Kadungure Mapondera led black resistance army against white people in Guruve and Mount Darwin. To add on Chief Rekayi Tangwena led the resistance of the Tangwena people against forced resettlement from Manicaland to Chivi in the Mhandamabwe area.

3. Traditional healers or herbalists

Herbalists or healers were important during the liberation struggle as they offered medicinal help to the freedom fighters. They diagnosed the cause of illness among freedom fighters and offered the right prescription to the freedom fighters who were ill and injured. Those with stomach problems were given herbs like *Ndorani* and they removed poison from freedom fighters bitten by snake. One example is that of Sekuru Maparadze and Tangai who operated in Nyajena in Masvingo. They also helped in the performing of rituals which the freedom fighters required for them to be protected by ancestors.

Activity 15.1 Research Assignment

Research on people who fought in the liberation struggle in your community. Compile a report on their experience during the struggle.

Activity 15.2 Group work

In groups, choose one indigenous religious practitioner and write his or her contribution in the Chimurenga 2. Read out your findings to the class.

Exercise 15.1

1. Why was the Second Chimurenga fought? [1]
2. Outline two roles of Indigenous religion in the liberation struggle. [2]
3. Name any four mediums who were active during the Second Chimurenga. [4]
4. Why were healers important during the Second Chimurenga? Give two reasons. [2]

UNIT 15.2 ROLE OF CHRISTIANITY IN THE LIBERATION STRUGGLE

Some Christian practitioners participated in the Chimurenga struggle directly and indirectly.

1. The Catholic Church

The church through the Moto spoke out against oppression of the people. Their board provided the freedom fighters with food, clothing and transport.

2. Bishop Dodge

He was of the American Methodist Church Bishop and was involved in the liberation struggle of the Zimbabwean people. He preached the gospel of political and spiritual freedom. Bishop Dodge voiced the concerns of the African people in Rhodesia at the very time the political parties were banned and their leaders silenced in detention. He also led the church in a denunciation of the Unilateral Declaration of Independence (UDI). He was against the government's practise of detaining people without trial. When deported because of being against the Smith regime, he empowered and encouraged the church to continue to fight for justice, peace and freedom. He stimulated hundreds of Zimbabwe church people to take the torch in quest for independence. The American Methodist Church was committed to the struggle of the black people who were oppressed in their own land.

3. Bishop Donald Lamont

He was of the Roman Catholic Church and was one of the influential missionaries against the Smith regime. He called the Smith regime with its oppressive laws the real terrorists. In 1976 he was deported for not reporting the presence of the freedom fighters and was found guilty. Like Bishop Dodge, he fought for the independence in Zimbabwe.

4. Bishop Muzorewa

He was of the United Methodist Church and followed under the footsteps of Bishop Dodge so there was no going back of the church's involvement in the

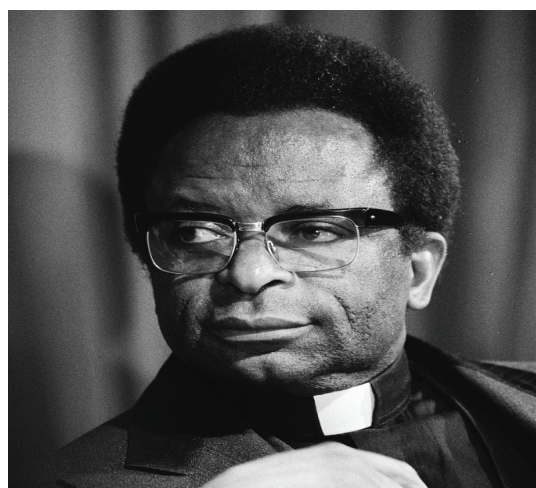


Fig. 15.2 Bishop Abel Muzorewa

liberation struggle. He pursued the issues of fighting against injustices in Rhodesia. He joined hands with the Catholic and Protestant church leaders to reject the new constitutional proposals of the Smith regime. He was elected the African National Council (ANC) leader which saw Zimbabwe winning its country back and he became the first black Prime Minister in this country.

5. Samuel Mutendi

He criticised the oppression of the blacks by the whites. This shows that Samuel Mutendi of the Zion Christian Church championed social justice. He also protested for the poor and disadvantaged when he castigated the brutality and inhuman treatment of blacks by whites in farms and industries.

6. Johane Masowe and Johane Marange

Both taught their followers not to work for the whites but to learn to depend on themselves. They were against the oppression of the black people.



Fig. 15.3 Samuel Mutendi

7. Reverend Canaan Banana

He was against the Unilateral Declaration of Independence and expressed that the church was to stand for justice. He encouraged the church to minister to the freedom fighters who in his opinion were fighting for equality, respect of human dignity and the sacred values of social justice.

8. Bishop Arthur Kanodereka

He stayed in Mount Darwin and he helped fighters to cross over to Mozambique for military training. Among the people he assisted was Teurai Ropa Nhongo who after the war was known as Mujuru. Occasionally he travelled to meet with commanders such as Josiah Tongogara in Mozambique. He assisted freedom fighters with clothes and money since he was running a butchery. His office was used as a venue for political meetings.

9. Bishop Naison Makwehe

He was stationed at Chibero mission and provided transport for freedom fighters. He also sheltered freedom fighters and provided them with supplies. Freedom fighters would often request watches or radios and sometimes they asked to use telephones belonging to the church.

10. Bishop Patrick Chakaipa

He played an important role during the second Chimurenga. He is known to have blessed the flag of Zimbabwe long before independence.

Activity 15.3 Discussion

In pairs identify Christian practitioners who participated in Chimurenga 2. Discuss their roles.

Activity 15.4 Debate

Christian practitioners played an important role in Zimbabwe's quest for liberation. Debate this statement in your class with one group arguing for and another group arguing against the assertion.

Exercise 15.2

Christians contributed to the colonisation of Zimbabwe as well as its liberation.

- (a) What is a Christian? [2]
(b) List four Christians who contributed to the second Chimurenga. [4]
(c) Describe the role of Christian practitioners in the second Chimurenga. [8]

Interesting facts

1. Religious practitioners played an important role in giving moral, spiritual and psychological support to freedom fighters during the second Chimurenga. It was through their guidance that the war was fought and won.

Summary of the chapter

- The second Chimurenga was a struggle fought between the Africans and white Rhodesian government which culminated in the independence of Zimbabwe in 1980.
- Mbuya Nehanda and Chaminuka among the others are some of the religious practitioners who gave religious approval to the start of the uprising.
- Chiodzamamera, Chipfeni, Chidyamauyu, Chiwawa and Chinengabere are the spirit mediums who met and announced the coming of the war.
- The struggle also saw the approval and support from Christian institutions such as the Catholic Church, American Methodist Church and United Methodist church.
- The indigenous religious practitioners gave moral and spiritual support to the liberation struggle. They preached of a God who would liberate the Africans from the oppressive laws of Smith regime.
- The spirit of Nehanda gave guidance to the nation.
- Reverend Canaan Banana was against the Unilateral Declaration of Independence and expressed that the church was to stand for justice.
- Bishop Arthur Kanodereka stayed in Mount Darwin and he helped fighters to cross over to Mozambique for military training. Among the people he assisted was Teurai Ropa Nhongo who after the war was known as Mujuru.
- Freedom fighters were to follow advices given by the spirit mediums in order to see the success of the struggle.

Glossary of terms

Chimurenga	– a Shona word which means to fight or struggle.
Detention	– imprisonment of someone guilty or suspected of a crime.
Guerrillas	– freedom fighters during the liberation struggle
Freedom fighters	– a person who takes part in a revolutionary struggle to achieve a political goal, especially in order to overthrow their government.
Independence	– it is the state of a country gaining political freedom from being governed by another country.
Oppression	– a situation in which people are governed in an unfair and cruel way and prevented from having opportunities and freedom.
Racial discrimination	– it is an unfair treatment or having a bias against someone on the basis of their race.
Religious practitioner	– is a leader, expert and specialist in religious matter.
Spirit medium	– communicated between the spirits of the dead and living human being.
Unilateral Declaration of Independence	– a statement adopted by the cabinet of Rhodesia stating that Rhodesia regarded itself as an independent sovereign state.

Revision Exercises

1. Freedom fighters fought for their independence during Chimurenga 2.

- (a) Define the term Chimurenga. [2]
- (b) State four Indigenous religion religious practitioners who participated in Chimurenga 2. [4]
- (c) Explain the roles of any three religious practitioners mentioned above. [6]
- (d) Discuss the significance of the spirit mediums during the struggle. [8]

2. Christian practitioners were against oppression of people.

- (a) What is a religious practitioner? [2]
- (b) Identify four Christian practitioners who supported the freedom fighters during Chimurenga 2. [4]
- (c) State the roles played by any three Christian practitioners in the liberation struggle. [6]
- (d) Explain how Christianity addresses the oppression of the poor in Zimbabwe. [8]

3. Spirit mediums guided the guerrillas during the struggle.

- (a) What is a spirit medium? [2]
- (b) State four spirit mediums who participated during the liberation struggle. [4]
- (c) List six ways the spirit mediums helped freedom fighters. [6]
- (d) Explain the importance of spirit mediums during the struggle. [8]

4. Religion played an important role in the liberation struggle.

- (a) Identify two religions that participated in the Second Chimurenga. [2]
- (b) Name four Christian churches which took part in the liberation struggle. [4]
- (c) Explain roles played by the two religions which were involved in the liberation struggle. [6]
- (d) Explain four contributions of religion during the second Chimurenga. [8]

Essay Questions

- 1. To what extent did roles of Indigenous religion practitioners help in the Liberation struggle? [25]
- 2. Discuss the roles of Christian practitioners in the Liberation struggle. [25]
- 3. Write explanatory notes on how the victory of Chimurenga is attributed to traditional religion. [25]
- 4. Describe the roles played by spirit mediums during the liberation struggle. [25]

EXAMINATION III

PAPER 1: STRUCTURED QUESTIONS

2 hours 30 minutes

Answer **five** questions.

Choose at least **one** question from each section.

SECTION A: INDIGENOUS RELIGION

1. In Indigenous religion, conflicts can be solved at family level.

- (a) Define conflict. [2]
- (b) Identify four forms of conflict at family level. [4]
- (c) Mention three possible causes of conflict at family level. [6]
- (d) Describe four ways of solving conflict at family level. [8]

2. In Indigenous religion, it is of paramount importance to care for the elderly.

- (a) What is an elderly in Indigenous religion? [2]
- (b) State four rights of the elderly. [4]
- (c) Mention three responsibilities of citizens in Indigenous religion. [6]
- (d) Explain four advantages of freedom of worship in Indigenous religion. [8]

3. Indigenous Religious practitioners were mostly spirit mediums.

- (a) Define a spirit medium. [2]
- (b) Mention four spirit mediums active during the second Chimurenga. [4]
- (c) State the roles played by three indigenous religious practitioners during the liberation struggle. [6]
- (d) Suggest four reasons why it was necessary to involve spirit mediums during the second Chimurenga. [8]

SECTION B: JUDAISM

4. In Jewish religion, people are obliged to give 10% of their earnings to the poor.

- (a) What are earnings? [2]
- (b) List four methods of getting earnings according to Judaism. [4]
- (c) Describe three ways of getting profits in a Jewish enterprise. [6]
- (d) Describe four advantages of religion on enterprise. [8]

5. Judaism is one of the religions that can be used to achieve a conflict free environment.

- (a) Explain the term, 'conflict free environment'. [2]
- (b) State four ways Judaism can be used to achieve a conflict free environment. [4]
- (c) Explain three methods of achieving a conflict free environment. [6]
- (d) Describe four benefits derived from a conflict free environment. [8]

6. The mandate to worship as one wishes, is key in Judaism.

- (a) Define freedom of worship. [2]
- (b) List four advantages of freedom of worship in Judaism. [4]
- (c) Explain three advantages of freedom of worship. [6]
- (d) Suggest four disadvantages of freedom of worship in Judaism. [8]

SECTION C: CHRISTIANITY

7. Religion and technology are a product of human nature.

- (a) What is technology? [2]
- (b) Mention four forms of technology used in Christianity. [4]
- (c) Explain three forms of technology in Christianity. [6]
- (d) Assess four advantages of technology in Christianity. [8]

8. Christian churches supported the struggle for independence in Zimbabwe.

- (a) What is independence? [2]
- (b) State four church groups that fully supported the struggle for independence. [4]
- (c) Name three African Instituted churches that supported the war of liberation in Zimbabwe. [6]
- (d) Explain four roles played by Christian churches during the second war of liberation in Zimbabwe. [8]

SECTION D: ISLAM

9. In Islam, children have rights to equal treatment before the law.

- (a) What are children's rights? [2]
- (b) List four rights of children in Islam. [4]
- (c) Explain three rights of children in Islam. [6]
- (d) Describe four benefits of children, derived from exercising their rights in Islam. [8]

10. In Islam, Muslims must acquire their wealth in rightful ways.

- (a) What is a Muslim? [2]
- (b) Mention four basic principles of Islamic enterprise. [4]
- (c) Explain three basic principles of Islamic enterprise. [6]
- (d) Describe four bad business practices in Islam. [8]

11. In Islam, conflict arises as a result of Muslims trying to defend their faith.

- (a) What is conflict? [2]
- (b) Identify four causes of conflict in Islam. [4]
- (c) Explain any three causes of conflict in Islam. [6]
- (d) Explain four effects of conflict in Islam. [8]

PAPER 2: ESSAY QUESTIONS **2 hours**

Answer **four** questions.

Choose **one** question from each section.

SECTION A: INDIGENOUS RELIGION

1. Explain any five methods of wealth creation in Indigenous religion. [25]
2. Describe the role of Indigenous religion in conflict management at community level. [25]
3. Discuss the roles of religious practitioners in Indigenous religion during the second war of liberation.[25]

SECTION B: JUDAISM

4. Write explanatory notes on the significance of ethics in Jewish enterprise. [25]
5. Describe the role of Judaism in conflict management. [25]
6. Explain the advantages and disadvantages of freedom of worship in Judaism. [25]

SECTION C: CHRISTIANITY

7. Outline the key roles of Christian religious practitioners who participated in the second liberation war in Zimbabwe. [25]
8. Explain the role of Christianity in shaping leadership styles. [25]
9. Describe the impact of technology on Christianity in Zimbabwe. [25]

SECTION D: ISLAM

10. Discuss the role of Islam in conflict management. [25]
11. Explain major business principles linked to Islam. [25]
12. Describe the efforts of the Islamic religion towards the promotion of the rights of children and women in Islam. [25]

Index

A

Adhan 59, 66
Afflictions 39, 115, 121
Almsgiving 80, 85, 133, 155
Ancestor 2, 6, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 178, 90, 91, 103,
108, 109, 111, 113, 114, 118, 119, 132,
137, 160, 162
Ancestor hood 132
Apostolic sect 3, 46, 52, 53, 55, 136, 146
Aqiqah 59, 60, 71

B

Baptism 43, 44, 45, 46, 50, 53, 54, 56, 57
Betrothal 33
Bishop 50, 53, 93, 93, 136, 162, 164
Bride veiling 33

C

Catholic Church 2, 3, 9, 46, 148, 162, 164
Child nurturing 92
Christian denomination 5, 7, 8, 9, 44, 46, 49, 57, 120,
140
Christian Martyrs 56
Christian membership 6, 7
Chronic condition 101, 109, 110, 111, 112, 140, 141,
142
Circumcision 7, 13, 14, 31, 32, 41, 60, 71, 75
Colonisation 6, 164
Commemoration 33, 34, 80, 82
Communal sharing 79
Communalism 103
Conflict 134, 136, 138, 143, 144, 151, 167, 168, 169
Conflict management 143, 147, 148, 169
Conservation 123, 124, 127, 128, 129
Covenant 31, 32, 38, 39, 40, 41, 92
Cultural changes 85
Cultural decay 137, 138
Curriculum 5, 6, 9, 66, 84, 87, 155

D

Daily rituals 3
Decalogue 39, 41
Dialogue 40, 148, 149
Domestic violence 98, 106

E

Ecological balance 18, 126
Education 14, 37, 40, 56, 66, 68, 70, 84, 89, 94, 96,
97, 98, 116, 117, 134, 135, 138, 140, 142,
151
Enterprise 89, 96, 153, 155, 156, 157, 158, 167, 168,
169
Eucharist 43, 46, 57, 74
Evangelism 4, 51, 52, 149, 157

F

Fellowship 78, 79, 82, 136, 149
Feminine 89, 91, 99, 105, 106, 107, 111
Festivals 17, 67, 90
Freedom of worship 131, 136, 137, 138, 139, 167,
169
Fundamentalist 85

G

Gabbai 37, 41
Gender equality 96, 99
Gender roles 89, 90, 91-95, 99, 100, 108, 111
Graveyard 15, 25
Guerrillas 160, 161, 165

H

Hajj 69, 133, 153, 158
Herbalists 161
Holy wars 8, 146
Human rights 96

I

Imam 59, 60, 62, 65, 67, 71, 72, 74, 80, 82, 94, 95
Independence 6, 82, 159, 160, 162, 163, 164, 165,
166, 167
Indigenous Knowledge Systems 77
Informal education 84, 86, 87, 88, 140, 142
Inter-dependency 76, 77, 78, 79, 80, 82, 83, 142

K

Kohein 37, 41
Krawa 55, 56, 136

L

Liberation struggle 26, 73, 159, 160, 161, 162, 163,
164, 165, 166, 167

M

Marginalisation 114, 118, 119, 120
Masculine 89, 91, 99, 111
Masungiro 12
Mecca 59, 63, 64, 66, 68, 69, 70, 71, 72, 158
Medina 69, 70, 71, 72, 128
Mediums 22, 90, 91, 114, 160, 161, 162, 164, 165, 166, 167
Menstrual purification 34, 36
Morals 14, 23, 86, 91, 101, 102, 103, 104, 111, 112, 137
Mosque 4, 8, 60, 63, 65-72, 74, 95, 117, 118, 146
Mourning 16, 17, 35, 36, 49, 62, 64
Muezzin 65, 66, 67, 70, 71
Mutual compassion 133
Myths 2, 11, 19, 20, 29, 43, 105, 132

N

Naming ritual 13, 44, 60
Nikkah ceremony 60, 61

P

Perceptions 113, 114, 115, 116, 117, 118, 131, 141, 142
Pilgrimage 39, 55, 56, 58, 69, 71, 133, 153, 158
Preservation 123, 129, 140, 141
Prophet 6, 36, 38, 40, 50, 56, 60, 63, 65, 66, 69, 71, 92, 93, 98, 117, 126, 127, 129, 141, 146
Psychosomatic 116, 121

R

Rabbi 9, 32, 33, 36, 37, 41, 42, 73, 92, 97, 120, 124, 129
Racial discrimination 165
Rain maker 23, 90
Rain making ritual 17, 23
Rehabilitation 138, 139, 116, 121
Religious beliefs 2, 5, 6, 101, 103, 108, 109, 110, 111, 112, 113
Religious differences 145
Religious extremism 146
Religious feast 80
Religious identity 41, 43, 146
Religious institutions 136, 148
Religious Practitioner 2, 11, 21, 22, 24, 28, 29, 20, 32, 36, 38, 41, 42, 50, 52, 53, 57, 58, 59, 60, 65, 71, 72, 73, 74, 75, 103, 148, 159, 160,

162, 164, 165, 167, 169

S

Sacred mountain 25, 26
Seclusion 12, 13, 14, 45, 124
Sexuality 101, 108, 110, 111, 112, 142
Social responsibility 13, 81, 82, 85, 115, 131, 132
Spiritual support 109, 160, 164
Stigmatisation 120
Synagogue 3, 4, 31, 33, 34, 37, 38, 39, 41, 92, 97, 146
Syncretism 149

T

Taboo 2, 9, 13, 22, 25, 26, 27, 28, 56, 76, 87, 103, 105, 108, 114
Tahneek 59
Technology 153, 155-158, 168, 169
Temple 31, 32, 33, 35, 37-42, 91, 146
Torah 31-34, 36, 37, 73, 92, 119, 120, 124, 125
Traditional healer 22, 23, 28, 97, 161

U

Umbilical Cord 12, 13
Unhu 76, 78, 81, 82, 86, 87, 88, 101, 102, 104, 108, 111, 112, 115

V

Vadare 48, 53
Values 8, 42, 55, 68, 76, 81, 84, 86, 87, 89, 91, 92
Vasondos 52, 53

W

Wilderness 54, 79, 82
Women empowerment 89, 96, 97, 98, 99, 100
Wudu 67, 68, 71, 117

Z

ZamZam 70

A practical Approach to Family and Religious Studies | Form 1 – 4

Updated Curriculum

A Practical Approach to Family and Religious Studies

FORM
1



Ladislau Kutekwa

Prosper Mataruse

Washington Chikunda

Updated Curriculum

A Practical Approach to Family and Religious Studies

FORM
2



Prosper Mataruse
Egnes Muchoza-Chinya

Flintstone Muchichwa
Tinashe Mutsengiwa

Updated Curriculum

A Practical Approach to Family and Religious Studies

FORM
3



Godfrey Muzondo

Chipo Takabvirakare

Sidhuna Patience

Zivave Wilson

Updated Curriculum

A Practical Approach to Family and Religious Studies

FORM
4



Wilson Zivave